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Culture mechanics

culture mechanics *noun*
Status: proposed theoretical term
Field: moral psychology (psychology of morality), social psychology, cultural psychology, organizational psychology, organization studies, sociology of morality, sociology of culture, cultural theory, distributed cognition

Short definition

Culture mechanics is a proposed framework for explaining how culture is installed in people, activated in particular situations, synchronized across groups, reproduced through institutions, and deliberately or accidentally changed.

It describes the human being as **homo duplex**, a creature with two functionally distinct processing units. The first is a powerful, general-purpose processor: the brain's main CPU. The second is a simpler social and affective processor called the **bigOther**. The bigOther does not reason in detail. It classifies thoughts, persons, actions, and situations by attaching culturally learned sentiments to them: honour or shame, loyalty or betrayal, sacredness or pollution, legitimacy or illegitimacy, belonging or exclusion.

Although the bigOther is comparatively primitive, it is connected at a decisive point. By changing how a person *feels* about what the main processor is thinking, it can redirect attention, motivation, judgment, and action before conscious reasoning notices what has happened. A proposed second output path can also condition whether rider-side conceptual retrieval, joining, and articulation continue, without making the bigOther the processor that performs those operations. It is programmed slowly with a **mythological lens** and activated quickly by social signals. In terminology adapted from Systems Leadership, a **mythology** is one socially evaluated narrative or story. Many mythologies, reinforced by symbols, rituals, institutional practices, rewards, punishments, and exemplary behaviour, shape the lens through which the bigOther maps real-world observations and events onto culturally learned values and feelings.

The **single-slot principle** proposes one local bigOther executing one operative mythological lens. That lens may braid several compatible cultural packages into a complex program; it is not a hierarchy of parallel bigOthers. An

incompatible governing worldview must be rejected, or the incumbent weave must be unbraided sufficiently for one successor to be rebraided and installed.

Stable installation means **complete slot occupancy** or, in a neutral architectural sense, **full capture**. A first-order program and a lifted second-order meta-program can each fully occupy the one slot. A lifted program does not govern less. The order-level distinction concerns what is shared: first-order mechanical solidarity shares concrete rules and answers; lifted mechanical solidarity shares the rules that generate, select, apply, and revise concrete answers. Plural lives and bounded subordinate jurisdictions can follow from that architecture, but do not define it. Whether either form of full capture is open and corrigible or closed and pathological is a separate question.

The bigOther also has a special capacity: it can couple with the bigOthers of other people. It encodes its classifications in words, stories, gestures, roles, titles, symbols, and sanctions that are intelligible within a shared symbolic order. Reciprocal signalling can synchronize many locally programmed individuals into an emergent social field. That field can present the collective in self-like form and, under sufficiently integrated conditions, become an **operative multi-mind-self**. Culture is the relatively stable evaluative programming and social coordination produced and reproduced through this loop.

An operative multi-mind-self need not erase the persons through whom it acts. Culture mechanics therefore distinguishes **differentiated unity**, in which a real *we* preserves different functions, judgments, relationships, and legitimate jurisdictions, from **subjecthood absorption (fusion)**, in which those personal standings are increasingly denied against the collective. Collective agency, synchronization, and fusion are related but independent properties.

For explanatory convenience, *multi-mind-self* may also be used as a broad family-level shorthand for a collective represented or encountered as one self. Strict analytical claims distinguish **multi-mind-self presentation** from the **operative multi-mind-self / multi-mind-self proper** and from a **fused multi-mind-self**. The shorthand alone licenses no inference to intention, ownership, responsibility, or fusion.

Some ideological symbols are **conformity signals**: their performance, absence, or refusal makes a person's relation to the installed program publicly legible. Such signals can turn private classification into monitoring, apparent consensus, recruitment, moralized exclusion, institutional coercion, or collective action. A conformity signal can also become a **targeting signal** when nonperformance exposes a sanctionable outsider; imposed marks and attributed labels can make the same target classification legible without requiring refusal.

In one sentence:

> **Culture mechanics is the study of how mythologies shape the mythological lens, how the bigOther uses that lens to give social feeling to observations and thoughts, and how networked bigOthers turn those feelings into collective order and action.**

Long definition

1. General meaning

Culture mechanics is an explanatory model of culture as a **distributed system of sentiment classification, social coordination, and symbolic reality-construction**.

The term *mechanics* expresses a specific ambition. Culture mechanics does not stop at naming or classifying phenomena such as conformity, indoctrination, collective effervescence, moral commitment, ideology, group identity, or crowd behaviour. It asks how these phenomena are produced:

- What are the functional components?
- What information or programming does each component contain?
- How is that programming learned?
- Which signals activate it?
- How does it influence thought and action?
- How are separate people coordinated or synchronized?
- How is the resulting culture stabilized by rituals and institutions?
- Under what conditions can it be inspected, resisted, or reprogrammed?

Culture mechanics therefore treats culture not merely as a collection of customs or beliefs, but as an operative system with inputs, internal state, evaluative rules, affective outputs, communication channels, feedback loops, and institutional memory. This entry begins with the individual source and coupling interface. The emergent field and its back-action upon epistemic judgment are developed in *Epistemic Agency under Mechanical Solidarity*.

2. Homo duplex: the dual-processing human

The model calls the human being **homo duplex** because human conduct results from the interaction of two functionally different processing units.

This is a deliberate extension of Émile Durkheim's term rather than a claim that Durkheim described precisely this architecture. In culture mechanics, the duality is between:

1. a powerful general-purpose processor; and
2. a simpler, culturally programmable sentiment-classification processor.

The two units are connected but not reducible to one another within this theory. This is a constitutive functional commitment, not a claim that two anatomical organs have been discovered. The bigOther must therefore not be silently redescribed as merely System 1, a generic heuristic, the superego, internalized norms, or an output of ordinary cognition. Those concepts may illuminate aspects of its operation, but none replaces the proposed second component without revising the theory itself.

A person's intelligence, knowledge, or technical competence does not by itself reveal how the person's bigOther is programmed. The main CPU may remain intelligent, computationally powerful, and capable of elementary verification while the bigOther changes which conclusions feel admissible, honourable, shameful, safe, or unthinkable. Conversely, a person's cultural programming does not determine the full extent of the person's intellectual capacities.

This relative independence explains why a highly intelligent person may be strongly governed by ideological or religious classifications, while a person of ordinary intelligence may preserve considerable moral and epistemic independence. The main processor determines much of what a person *can* think; the bigOther strongly influences which thoughts feel admirable, shameful, safe, dangerous, permissible, or unthinkable.

Durkheimian dualism and the Culture Mechanics decomposition Durkheim introduces the "old formula *homo duplex*" and the image of a "double center of gravity" in "The Dualism of Human Nature and Its Social Conditions" (1914; reproduced as Chapter 10 of *Émile Durkheim on Morality and Society*, pp. 149–163). His two poles are the individual, organism-rooted life of sensations and sensory appetites and the socially derived intellectual and moral life. The second pole includes not only collective sentiments and moral authority but also language, concepts, and theoretical and practical rational activity. Durkheim therefore does not divide the person into an unconscious social censor and a conscious individual reasoner.

His account also explains how the social pole becomes intrapersonal. Religious, moral, and intellectual conceptions formed in group life penetrate individual consciousness, become durably organized and personally inflected there, retain a socially derived authority, and are renewed through continuing collective life. His description of the person's social existence as "an extension of society" therefore names a locally individualized social formation rather than a literal detached fragment of one collective mind.

The closest Culture Mechanics relation is a decomposition rather than a one-to-one match:

Durkheimian element	Closest Culture Mechanics relation	Required boundary
Organism-rooted sensation and appetite	Elephant-side embodied, affective, and appetitive processing	This does not exhaust the main CPU or make Durkheim's first pole identical with Haidt's elephant.
Collectively formed language, concepts, and rational resources	Shared symbolic protocol and distributed reconstruction codebook, locally reconstructed and used by the rider/main CPU	The local bigOther does not perform grammar, conceptual reconstruction, or detailed reasoning.
Collective moral ideals retaining authority within the person	Installed mythological lens and local-bigOther classification, renewed by field back-action	The collar is one local execution interface, not the whole of Durkheim's social being.

Culture Mechanics consequently retains Durkheim's broad observation while splitting its functions more finely. The main CPU performs conceptual and rational operations through resources that are partly socially formed; the local bigOther rapidly classifies some of their objects and possible uses; and the shared protocol and distributed field help form, stabilize, and renew both. The proposed semantic-access mechanism adds that collar classification may condition whether some rider-side retrieval, joining, standing-query, or articulation operations continue. It does not turn the collar into a language or reasoning processor. Durkheim supplies the broad social-intellectual-moral

source claim, not the main-CPU/local-bigOther architecture, single-slot principle, reconstruction codebook, or collar-to-rider access mechanism.

3. First processing unit: the main CPU

The **main CPU** is the brain's powerful, flexible, general-purpose processing capacity. Its functions include:

- perception and memory;
- language and explicit thought;
- comparison and inference;
- imagination and counterfactual reasoning;
- planning and problem-solving;
- conscious deliberation;
- personal judgment;
- construction of explanations.

Most ordinary conceptions of intelligence focus on this processor. It can learn complex theories, solve technical problems, interpret evidence, and devise sophisticated strategies.

These remain main-CPU operations when their concepts, language, inferential resources, and standards have been socially formed. Social origin concerns the formation and public availability of cognitive resources; it does not relocate the detailed execution of thought into the local bigOther.

The main CPU does not, however, choose its direction in a cultural vacuum. Attention, motivation, felt relevance, moral urgency, and the acceptability of possible conclusions are influenced by the second processor.

4. Second processing unit: the bigOther

The **bigOther** is the comparatively primitive but strategically placed sentiment-classification processor. Culture mechanics distinguishes its functional operation, its phenomenological appearance, and the shared symbolic interface through which it couples with other local bigOthers.

Functional aspect The local bigOther executes the installed mythological lens. It does not usually produce a detailed argument. It assigns social and moral valence to observations, thoughts, persons, sources, roles, actions, symbols, and events:

```
observation, thought, person, source, role, action, symbol, or event
                              ↓
                    MYTHOLOGICAL LENS
            learned value-and-feeling mappings
                              ↓
                         BIGOTHER
                fast sentiment classification
                              ↓
honour / shame          loyalty / betrayal       sacred / profane
clean / polluted        legitimate / illicit     safe / threatening
admirable / contemptible                           belonging / exclusion
```

This mapping function corresponds to what **Systems Leadership** calls the **mythological lens**. Culture mechanics treats the lens as the installed evaluative program and the local bigOther as the comparatively simple processor that executes it. Its output can take the form of pride, guilt, shame, disgust, trust, fear, admiration, moral elevation, indignation, belonging, or anticipated exclusion. These outputs alter which thoughts receive attention, which possibilities are emotionally tolerable, and which actions feel obligatory.

The primary operation remains classification rather than retrieval, language, or reasoning. One proposed extension is that the resulting signal can condition whether the main CPU continues ordinary semantic-access operations such as conceptual selection, lexical retrieval, joining observations, maintaining a standing question, and stabilizing a formulation. The main CPU performs those operations; the local bigOther supplies the learned permission, honour, shame, threat, or taboo classification that may facilitate or interrupt them.

Phenomenological aspect The source of a classification need not be experienced as "my learned social programming." It may be encountered as an actually present Other—God, Destiny, Nation, History, the People, or the Cause—that sees, judges, addresses, commands, and can receive loyalty, service, protection, or sacrifice. Culture mechanics calls the felt objectivity of this encounter **bigOther-presence** and its second-person relational form **bigOther-as-Thou**.

When the installed program is jealous, this presence may itself be felt directly as jealous: as a *Thou* that claims the person, watches for disloyalty, refuses divided allegiance, and demands fidelity against rivals. The person need not experience this as "my program classified an alternative attachment as betrayal." It can be lived as "the Other is jealous and requires my loyalty."

William James's *The Varieties of Religious Experience* (1902) supplies an important phenomenological antecedent: persons can experience an unseen order or objective presence as more authoritative and conduct-directing than an explicit proposition. Martin Buber's *I and Thou* (1923) supplies the relational grammar of encountering another as a *Thou* rather than an object or *It*. Neither thinker proposed the culture-mechanical processor or its distributed field. Buber's eternal Thou in particular must not be reduced to a socially programmed classifier. The present terms borrow aspects of their phenomenology while assigning them a different functional explanation.

Kant's account of conscience supplies a further moral-phenomenological neighbour. In *The Metaphysics of Morals*, AA 6:438 and AA 6:439, one person conducts an inner court case while experiencing its judge as an observing and commanding other. Kant's **doubled personality** (*zwiefache Persönlichkeit*) is not the culture-mechanical homo-duplex architecture: Kant explains the division through autonomous practical reason, whereas Culture Mechanics proposes a culturally programmed local bigOther. The controlled comparison is developed below in "Kant's inner tribunal and doubled personality".

This account also leaves the metaphysical status of a reported presence open. Its claim is narrower: whatever else the presence may be, the person's local bigOther can mediate how it becomes socially classified and conduct-directing.

When the mythology represents an agent, several depths of relation and enactment must be distinguished:

Depth	Culture-mechanical description	Relation to fusion
Representation	"This culture tells stories about God, a god, the Nation, History, the People, or the Cause."	No fusion follows from representation.
Consultation or service	The person asks what the represented agent would judge or accepts obligations toward it.	Personal authorship can remain fully legitimate.
bigOther-as-Thou	The agent is experienced as present, addressing, watching, judging, or commanding the person.	An *I–Thou* relation still contains two poles; presence is not fusion by itself.
Distributed enactment	Several persons and institutions provide perception, memory, judgment, voice, resources, and action to the represented agent.	Enactment can remain differentiated or become absorptive.
Fused enactment	The collectively enacted agent becomes the authoritative subject and the person's independent authorship loses standing against it.	This is subjecthood absorption by definition.

The sequence is analytical rather than a necessary developmental ladder. A person can serve without reporting a presence, report a presence without joining a collective agent, or participate in collective enactment while retaining a legitimate conscience, judgment, and right of refusal. Conversely, an intensely agentified programme can make "the Other speaks and acts through me" the operative locus of authorship.

The phrase **agent-model** in this comparison means the culturally specified representation by which people anticipate what an agent perceives, remembers, wants, judges, and commands. It is part of the operative mythological lens; it is not another local bigOther. Nor does analysis of a humanly implemented God-model decide whether God exists independently of that implementation. Culture Mechanics can examine the representation, experience, and social enactment while leaving the theological or metaphysical referent open.

Shared symbolic protocol The spelling **bigOther** marks a deliberate adaptation of Jacques Lacan's *big Other*, the locus of language, law, roles, conventions, authority, and socially intelligible meaning. Culture mechanics does not identify Lacan's symbolic order with a processor inside the individual. It treats that shared order, in one functional translation, as the **on-the-wire protocol** through which local bigOthers become mutually legible:

```
state of A's local bigOther
              ↓ encoded as
words, stories, gestures, roles, titles, symbols, sanctions
              ↓ transmitted through
shared symbolic order / Lacanian big Other
              ↓ interpreted through
B's installed mythological lens
              ↓
B's sentiment classification and outward response
```

An alphabet is not a message, and Unicode or ASCII is not the state of the computer using it. They provide shared encodings through which different machines can exchange intelligible signals. Likewise, a letter such as `M` can denote a complete mathematical mapping, while `E` or `B` can denote an entire field. Flags, uniforms, titles, and words such as *betrayal* or *justice* can function as similarly compressed social tokens because participants have learned how to unpack them.

The protocol transmits public signals, not perfect copies of private states. Synchronization requires sufficiently compatible lenses and contexts; it does not require identical inner contents. A signal can therefore activate convergence, misunderstanding, indifference, or opposition.

The bigOther's power comes less from computational sophistication than from its **position in the control architecture**. It influences how a person feels about the main CPU's thoughts. The main CPU may subsequently use its much greater power to explain, implement, defend, or occasionally question the direction supplied by the bigOther.

Historical cause, live classification, and avowed reason A present cultural response can contain three causally distinct layers:

1. **Historical cause:** the remote social experience, institutional arrangement, selection process, conflict, or practical problem through which a rule and its affective weight arose.
2. **Live classification:** the attraction, horror, shame, sacredness, loyalty, or other sentiment currently executed when the operative lens encounters the object.
3. **Avowed reason:** the explanation a person or institution can presently state for that response.

These layers can coincide, but they need not. The original problem can disappear while an affectively alive prohibition remains; a later theology, science, or political doctrine can then supply a new explanation. Conversely, a person can repeat an inherited reason after its corresponding classification has become affectively dead.

Émile Durkheim supplies a particularly clear observation in "Les principes de 1789 et la sociologie" (1890; Mark Traugott's English translation appears in *Émile Durkheim on Morality and Society*, pp. 34–42). He writes that conscious prescriptions can be "the conscious outcome of an entire unconscious process" and that, without access to their remote causes, "we invent reasons for them, lacking the real ones which we do not see." His kin-marriage example separates a surviving horror from the religious or physiological explanations later offered for it.

This is testimony to the **phenomenon to be explained**, not proof of the present processor architecture. Implicit learning, habit, affective conditioning, predictive processing, strategic rationalization, and other unitary-mind accounts remain alternatives. A discriminating study should therefore vary or measure the three layers separately: alter an explicit reason while holding the social approval environment roughly constant; alter approval while holding the proposition constant; test whether affective reversal precedes or follows doctrinal revision; and compare people who avow the same reason but display different classifications.

5. The single-slot principle

Culture mechanics proposes that the bigOther occupies the equivalent of a computer's **single PCI slot**. There is one slot, one installed local bigOther, and one operative mythological lens at a time. The bigOther is the processor or card; the mythological lens is the executable evaluative program it runs.

A stable program produces **complete slot occupancy**. This document also calls that architectural condition **full capture**. Here *full* means that one operative weave governs the slot, not that the weave is false, totalitarian, or

uncorrectable. A **first-order full capture** shares binding concrete rules and answers. A **lifted full capture** shares binding rules that generate, select, apply, and revise concrete answers:

fixed meta-rules M + current knowledge or inputs K_t + situation C → binding first-order output R_t(C)

Here *fixed* means installed and binding at a given time, not eternal. Generator and outputs belong to the same operative weave. Both architectures occupy the slot completely; lifting changes the order at which binding sameness is located rather than producing an empty or half-programmed slot.

This neutral architectural **full capture** must not be confused with **Culture Program capture**, in which the authorities, metrics, appointments, correction routes, and reproduction machinery of an incumbent program are redirected until they install or reproduce an incompatible successor. A healthy lifted meta-order and a closed first-order program can each be full captures without either having captured a predecessor in that ecological sense. The successor-displacement construct and its evidence protocol are defined in *Culture Program Ecology*.

Four axes must therefore remain distinct: **slot occupancy** (full), **order level** (shared outputs or shared generator), **jurisdiction** (what the installed rules govern), and **corrigibility** (open or closed). A lifted meta-order can have universal jurisdiction at its own level over the creation, allocation, limitation, coordination, succession, and correction of first-order outputs and jurisdictions. Persons, offices, professions, institutions, communities, and contracting parties may remain plural and domain-limited beneath it. That pluralism is an important possible result of lifting, not its definition.

This **single-slot exclusivity** does not imply that the installed program is simple, culturally pure, or derived from only one source. A person may belong to several groups and encounter many religions, professions, political doctrines, familial obligations, and moral traditions. Compatible material can be assembled like software packages or libraries and braided into one operative lens. The slot restricts the number of independently operative evaluators, not the complexity or modularity of the installed weave.

Compatible packages are not separate bigOthers waiting for a higher process to rank them at runtime. Their objects, authorities, roles, and permissions already receive meaning through the one combined weave. **Paul's pride in supporting himself through work illustrates the point: Christianity and a work ethic need not compete for supremacy.** In 1 Corinthians 9:6–18, especially verses 15–18, Paul connects his boast with preaching without making use of his right to material support; 1 Thessalonians 2:9 and 2 Thessalonians 3:7–10 present labouring so as not to burden the community as an exemplary practice. A Christian mythology package and a *Berufsethos* can therefore reinforce one another within a single program. This is an illustration of compatibility, not population-level proof that every religious and professional package is compatible.

New cultural material consequently has three broad fates:

1. **Incumbent assimilation or rejection:** the installed lens interprets, neutralizes, reuses, or refuses the material in its own terms without surrendering its load-bearing classifications.
2. **Compatible integration:** a package whose important classifications and authority relations can coexist with the incumbent is braided into the one operative lens.
3. **Replacement under incompatibility:** a rival governing program cannot be installed beside the incumbent. The incumbent weave must be loosened and unbraided sufficiently for retained strands and new material to be rebraided into one successor lens.

Within the originating application developed here, **Christianity and the National Socialist worldview are deeply incompatible programming systems** at load-bearing classifications such as God and ultimate authority, the person and neighbour, race and nation, truth, obedience, sacrifice, violence, and loyalty. Nazi programming could not simply be installed beside an intact Christian program. Capture required a replacement process. A Nazi-governed successor could retain Christian words, scripture, symbols, rituals, offices, or a subjective Christian identity, but those strands would receive their operative meaning from the successor weave. The result would be one rebraided Nazi-Christian program, not two programs ordered by rank.

Deep cultural change is therefore unlike adding neutral information to memory. Reprogramming changes the weave that determines what new information means and how it feels. Incomplete replacement can produce contradiction, instability, or a tangled lens during loosening and rebraiding; it does not establish several independent bigOthers running in parallel. This helps explain why conversion, deradicalization, psychoanalysis, moral injury, ideological rupture, and profound changes of identity can be slow, conflictual, and emotionally painful.

Hard cases and possible defeat conditions Single-slot exclusivity cannot be protected merely by redescribing every apparent counterexample as "one complicated braid." Self-description, retained vocabulary, public ritual, or

several group memberships do not decide the architecture. The diagnostic question is:

> **When inherited authorities conflict over the same act, which rule or authority has final interpretive priority over what the retained material means?**

The following observations remain consistent with one slot:

- one tradition interprets the other's retained symbols and practices;
- outward conformity is strategic camouflage under legal or social coercion;
- selected strands have been integrated into one syncretic successor;
- a third rule governs how both inheritances are combined;
- or the person is in unstable, incomplete unbraiding and rebraiding.

A strong candidate counterexample requires substantially more:

1. two governing evaluators issue incompatible classifications in the same domain;
2. each remains independently final rather than being interpreted, authorized, or limited by the other or by a third rule;
3. each can generate its own affect, guilt, correction, and veto;
4. neither is merely reflective knowledge, role performance, strategic concealment, or a de-animated remnant; and
5. the configuration remains stable over time rather than resolving into hierarchy, integration, replacement, or breakdown.

Evidence of that pattern would count against strict single-slot exclusivity. The theory would then need either a principled account of parallel operative evaluators or revision of the one-slot commitment. Evidence for only labels, rituals, memories, or alternating contexts is insufficient because one weave can assign different outputs to different contexts. The detailed dual-religious- identification boundary case belongs to *Epistemic Agency under Mechanical Solidarity*, "Examples, cases, and boundary tests".

6. Systems Leadership: mythologies and the mythological lens

Systems Leadership: Creating Positive Organisations, by Ian Macdonald, Catherine Burke, and Karl Stewart, supplies the definitive practical account used by Culture Mechanics for how culture is deliberately implemented. Its method coordinates leadership behaviour, systems, symbols, mythologies, habits, organizational arrangements, and repeated experience rather than treating mythology as sufficient by itself. Culture Mechanics embeds that organizational and workplace account in a larger theory and develops selected extensions and refinements; readers seeking the exact implementation method should read the book.

> **Culture Mechanics condenses the Systems Leadership implementation stack into one memorable duality: systems are the skeleton; human carriers, mythology, meaning, affect, *Beseelung*, and embodied habits are the flesh and blood. The skeleton makes culture durable and repeatable; the living body makes it operative and alive.**

The full semantic anatomy and its boundaries belong to *Culture Program Ecology*.

Culture mechanics adopts the following terminological hierarchy:

Term	Definition in culture mechanics
Mythology	One socially evaluated story or narrative unit. It need not involve gods or supernatural events. It shows persons, roles, actions, conflicts, and consequences while indicating what deserves admiration, shame, loyalty, fear, trust, disgust, or condemnation.
Mythologies	The accumulated and partly interconnected body of such stories available to a person or group. They provide many examples of how the social world is supposed to be interpreted.
Mythological lens	The generalized mapping formed from those mythologies and reinforced by systems, symbols, rituals, sanctions, and observed conduct. It maps real-world observations and events onto culturally learned values and feelings.

Term	Definition in culture mechanics
bigOther	The local sentiment-classification processor that executes the installed mythological lens and applies its mappings quickly.

The lens is one executable weave but may be modular. Mythologies, practices, professional ethics, familial duties, and local customs can operate as mutually compatible packages within it. Their plurality is a plurality of constituent strands and context-sensitive mappings, not a plurality of local bigOthers.

This yields the central culture-mechanical sequence:

```
MYTHOLOGY
one evaluated story
                    ↓
MYTHOLOGIES
many mutually reinforcing stories
                    ↓
MYTHOLOGICAL LENS
generalized mappings from observations to values and feelings
                    ↓
BIGOTHER
fast execution of those mappings
                    ↓
ELEPHANT AND MAIN CPU
felt attraction, aversion, obligation, attention, and motivation
```

An individual mythology can teach:

- which kinds of persons and roles exist;
- what counts as a good group member;
- which authorities are legitimate;
- which conduct receives praise or condemnation;
- which sacrifices are honourable;
- what constitutes betrayal, pollution, injustice, or redemption;
- how the past explains the present;
- what the group expects of the individual;
- which future is desirable or disastrous.

A story acts as an evaluated simulation. Narrative transportation places the listener inside a conflict; a hero or villain demonstrates a possible response; consequences display what follows; praise or condemnation supplies the sentiment label; and the audience's reaction shows whether the classification is collectively shared. Each story is one training example. Many convergent stories allow the bigOther to generalize a lens that can classify new situations never described in any one story.

Relevant structures and moral appraisal Dushan Wegner's *Relevante Strukturen* (2019; ISBN 9783739405636) calls attention to the relations in which a person is embedded and to the larger structures that the person experiences as important. Culture Mechanics adopts **relevant structure** as a typed relational object rather than as a synonym for anything a person happens to value:

> A **relevant structure** is a represented relational arrangement or organized condition–such as a family, friendship, profession, institution, community, legal order, practice, person-in-relation, or anticipated shared future–that the installed mythological lens treats as carrying moral weight.

Not every desired object, isolated preference, or momentarily salient stimulus is therefore a relevant structure. The term emphasizes embedding, dependence, continuity, function, and vulnerability. A mythology can teach which structures exist, who or what belongs within them, how they depend upon one another, what counts as supporting or damaging them, whose claims have precedence when they conflict, and who has standing or jurisdiction to judge and act.

Wegner's memorable formulation that good strengthens relevant structures and evil weakens them is incorporated as the **relevant-structure appraisal hypothesis**:

> **People often experience an action, omission, continuation, or proposed change as good when they believe it strengthens, protects, repairs, or honourably serves a structure they experience as relevant, and as evil when they believe it weakens, corrupts, betrays, or destroys such a structure.**

This is a descriptive hypothesis about moral perception and mobilization, not a sufficient definition of moral truth and not a claim that every moral judgment uses this route. The analysis must keep five variables distinct:

Variable	Question
Felt relevance	How much moral weight does this person or operative culture assign to the represented structure?
Represented effect	What does the person believe the action will do to it?
Actual effect	What does the action do, including indirect, delayed, and transferred effects?
Generative centrality	How strongly does the structure actually produce capabilities or conditions upon which several downstream structures depend?
Normative standing	Is the structure, claimed effect, jurisdiction, or proposed sacrifice legitimate?

The Hanekamp–Wegner ecological application sharpens the change boundary: **"Deterioration is a moral evaluation of change."** A measurement or model may establish or predict change, but the classification *deterioration* additionally selects a reference state, relevant structure, represented weakening, normative standing, and interpreter. This is a Culture Mechanics bridge from Hanekamp's application to Wegner's appraisal hypothesis, not Wegner's own formulation or proof that the evaluation is arbitrary.

Generative centrality–also described more informally as *load-bearingness*–is therefore not another name for felt relevance. A structure may be causally central to the production of character, knowledge, cooperation, or institutional continuity while receiving little explicit moral attention. Conversely, an intensely felt-relevant structure may be weakly generative, replaceable, or destructive. A **cultural sublimation architecture** is a particularly important proposed case: it can recurrently produce capacities upon which families, professions, law, science, markets, and political institutions depend even when the operative culture does not represent that architecture itself as relevant. The concept and its limits are developed in *Mythology Construction*, "Sublimation and moral formation."

That document also distinguishes the larger architecture from a **lifted sublimation generator**: installed meta-rules select binding directions, affective actuation makes them motivationally effective, and formative practices turn them into durable character and capability. Generator efficacy does not by itself establish positive normative valence.

The mismatch is analytically consequential:

```
high generative centrality
+ low felt relevance
→ weak protection and transmission
→ vulnerability to neglect, ridicule, dismantling,
  or consumption of inherited cultural capital
```

This is a hypothesis about dependency and reproduction, not a presumption that every inherited arrangement is beneficial or that whatever calls itself civilizational must be preserved.

Wegner's emphasis on *Veränderung* also motivates the more limited **change-indexed moral-mobilization hypothesis**:

> **Moral classification often becomes especially salient and action-directing when a condition is represented as causing, accelerating, continuing, preventing, or culpably failing to prevent a change in a felt-relevant structure.**

This concerns represented counterfactual movement, not physical novelty. "The rule exists" can be rendered as "officials continue the rule," "participants decline to end it," or "the institution prevents transition to an alternative." Conversely, the absence of visible mobilization does not establish that the status quo is experienced as good: coercion, habituation, helplessness, low salience, concealed dissent, and the absence of a represented alternative are competing explanations. A direct test would hold material conditions constant while comparing a static-state description, an active-continuation description, and a prevented-alternative description. Failure of these descriptions to alter moral intensity or action readiness, especially across independently measured relevance, would weaken the hypothesis.

The mythological lens need not calculate complex consequences by itself. Ordinary cognition, testimony, institutions, and a mythology's causal stories can supply a represented effect model; the local bigOther then rapidly classifies the represented support or damage through the installed lens:

```
observed, proposed, continued, or prevented change
                          ↓
main CPU + received causal stories represent likely effects
                          ↓
operative lens supplies felt relevance, moral meaning,
precedence, standing, and jurisdiction
                          ↓
local bigOther classifies protection/injury, loyalty/betrayal,
repair/destruction, justice/injustice, honour/shame
                          ↓
attention, judgment, motivation, and action are redirected
```

"Strengthening" and "weakening" are multidimensional rather than one moral scalar. An oppressive institution may increase its continuity, capacity, reach, or internal cohesion while destroying truth-contact, corrigibility, personal standing, or legitimate exit and while transferring severe costs to other persons and structures. The appraisal hypothesis explains why participants may nevertheless experience its preservation as good; it does not vindicate that appraisal.

Several relevant structures can coexist within the one operative weave without implying several local bigOthers. Their relative weight, conflict rules, and jurisdictions are program content. A predominantly first-order solidarity may make a concrete hierarchy of structures binding as such. A lifted solidarity may make binding a procedure by which competing claims are evidenced, limited, adjudicated, appealed, and revised. This is an application of the order-level distinction, not its definition; in both cases the one slot remains fully occupied.

Systems Leadership adds an important qualification: explicit stories are not the only influences on the lens. The conduct of leaders, the design of systems, the use of symbols, institutional rewards and sanctions, and repeated experiences of belonging, success, humiliation, or exclusion can confirm or contradict the lessons conveyed by a mythology. These experiences may themselves later be narrated as new mythologies.

Culture Program Ecology formalizes the resulting implementation anatomy as a **systemic skeleton** joined to a **living cultural body**. Rules, offices, jurisdictions, incentives, feedback, accounting, correction, and succession make the program repeatable; human carriers, mythologies, meaning, sacredness, affect, moral formation, *Beseelung*, and embodied habits animate and interpret it. These are two aspects of one operative Culture Program, not two bigOthers or a new processor division.

The relationship is therefore not simply "a story causes a feeling." Rather:

```
stories + observed conduct + systems + symbols + repeated experience
                                ↓
              reinforce or contradict mythologies
                                ↓
                  shape the mythological lens
                                ↓
       lens maps a new observation onto value and feeling
```

Systems Leadership commonly describes the lens as evaluating behaviour, systems, and symbols along continua such as:

- honesty–dishonesty;
- trust–distrust;
- courage–cowardice;
- respect–disrespect for human dignity;
- fairness–unfairness;
- love or care–indifference.

Culture mechanics interprets these as important output dimensions of the programmed bigOther. They are not necessarily an exhaustive list of human moral sentiments, but they show concretely what the lens does: it converts a physical or social observation into an affectively consequential classification.

When people possess sufficiently similar mythological lenses, they tend to interpret the same conduct in similar ways.

Systems Leadership calls the resulting shared evaluative pattern culture. Culture mechanics adds that compatible local bigOthers can also exchange signals and synchronize, turning shared classification into distributed affect and coordinated action.

7. Programming, activation, and reprogramming

Culture mechanics distinguishes several operations that are easily confused:

Operation	Timescale	Function
Programming	Slow	Adds, reinforces, or revises mythologies and compatible packages and thereby installs, extends, or modifies the one mythological lens used by the bigOther.
Classification	Very fast	The bigOther applies the installed lens to a person, thought, action, symbol, or event.
Activation	Fast	A present signal activates an already learned mapping in the lens.
Synchronization	Fast	Reciprocal signals align the affective or behavioural states of several people.
Reinforcement	Repeated	Successful, praised, punished, or emotionally intense execution stabilizes mythologies and their mappings in the lens.
Reprogramming	Usually slow	Modifies the operative weave. Compatible change can extend or repair it; incompatible replacement requires sufficient unbraiding of the incumbent and rebraiding of one successor lens.
Unbraiding and rebraiding	Usually slow and conflictual	Loosens load-bearing bindings, preserves or detaches selected strands, crosses a potentially unstable interval, and installs one successor weave rather than a parallel evaluator.

Situated cultural scripts: executable local braids A **situated cultural script** is a distributed, role-, institution-, or situation-indexed braid that translates selected meanings, classifications, permissions, and authority relations of an operative cultural weave into expected perception, conduct, coordination, improvisation, and access to practical, relational, or material support. It is narrower in scope but more concretely specified than the general cultural braid.

The abstraction relation is:

Level	Culture-mechanical meaning
Operative cultural braid	The comparatively general organization of meanings, values, identities, authorities, and conflict rules within the one installed weave
Situated cultural script	A higher-resolution adapter specifying how selected parts of that order operate for people in a recurrent role, institution, relationship, or situation

Level	Culture-mechanical meaning
Local script variant	A historically or organizationally particular implementation of the more general script
Enactment	One concrete performance, modification, improvisation, or refusal of the script by actual participants

```
operative cultural weave C
+ institution or relationship I
+ role R
+ recurrent situation X
+ practical and material environment E
→ situated script S(C,I,R,X,E)
→ expected perception, conduct, coordination, and improvisation
```

The notation marks contextual specification, not deterministic execution or a calibrated function. A professional script, for example, may join a society's general meanings of work, service, competence, authority, and responsibility to formal offices, tacit routines, tools, colleague expectations, error-recovery practices, status, livelihood, and professional pride. Participants may interpret, perform, repair, exploit, or refuse it.

A script can be larger than any individual. It may be maintained across many persons, offices, artifacts, procedures, relationships, and resource flows, while particular people enter and leave its roles. The script is therefore neither a private plan nor necessarily a collective agent. It supplies a distributed pattern for action; agency still belongs to participating persons, institutions, or, where the independent functional threshold is met, an operative multi-mind-self.

Scripts cut across the culture-mechanical object types defined below. They can contain program units, symbols, implementation arrangements, expected local execution, and interfaces among several roles. They are not another processor or another governing bigOther. One fully occupied mythological lens can support many compatible familial, occupational, civic, religious, and technical scripts. Their scope, priority, and conflict rules belong to the one operative weave. Stable same-situation scripts that remain incompatibly final and mutually ungoverned would instead raise the existing single-slot defeat condition.

The term is adapted from Venkatesh Rao's "On the Unraveling of Scripts". Rao treats scripts as learned behavioural patterns that supply meaning and material support and treats their unraveling as a mutually reinforcing loss of both. The situated-braid definition, its placement between culture and enactment, the single-slot boundary, and the distinctions among local repair, cross-script cascade, and cultural unbraiding are Culture Mechanics developments.

Script viability asks whether the script continues to translate cultural meaning into intelligible and practically supportable conduct under its actual conditions. Viability is not truth, legitimacy, flourishing, corrigibility, *Beseelung*, or moral goodness. A false or oppressive script can remain highly viable, while a worthy script can fail for lack of skill, infrastructure, resources, institutional support, or workable interfaces.

Domain-transfer failure **Status:** project-developed competence-and-script transfer mechanism

Domain-transfer failure occurs when genuine competence, a viable script, or a reliable practice from a source environment is carried into a target environment and acted upon as though its load-bearing regularities remained valid, although a change in scale, counterpart, opponent, institution, interface, resource structure, feedback, time horizon, or constraint has invalidated that transfer.

```
demonstrated competence or viable script in environment A
+ untested assumption that A's load-bearing regularities persist
+ consequential enactment in materially different environment B
+ collision with a changed causal, institutional, or adversarial structure
→ domain-transfer failure
```

Past success and surface similarity establish a transfer hypothesis, not its validity. Before discriminating consequence, the configuration is a **domain-transfer risk**. The stronger failure classification requires evidence that the changed condition mattered to the result and that the imported competence, script, or practice was not adequately adapted. A failed attempt in a new setting may instead reflect ordinary noise, bad execution, insufficient resources, an unrelated bottleneck, or a locally valid experiment whose expected risk was properly bounded.

The audit identifies:

- what competence or script was genuinely demonstrated and under which source conditions;
- which regularities were assumed to transfer and which were independently tested;
- what changed in scale, counterpart, opposition, technology, interfaces, resources, incentives, feedback, or consequence;
- whether early anomalies changed the model and practice or were interpreted through the source environment's expectations; and
- whether a locally adapted comparator performs differently under the same target conditions.

Domain-transfer failure is not prominence-derived apparent competence: the source competence may be entirely real. It is not identical to script unraveling, although a badly transferred or no-longer-adapted script can unravel after repeated collision. Moral-scale transposition is a narrower relational subtype in which a moral grammar crosses a scale and knowledge topology without the conditions that made it responsible there. Domain-transfer failure can be sincere, negligent, overconfident, institutionally selected, or deliberately exploited; the morphology alone establishes none of those explanations or any person-level guilt.

Script unraveling is the process by which a situated script loses coherence or viability: inherited meanings cease to guide workable conduct, practical consequences cease confirming the script, roles and procedures contradict one another, participants improvise incompatible responses, or supporting institutions and resources fail. Meaning-side and practical-side failure can reinforce one another:

```
script supplies meaning, role, and expected conduct
                    ↓
participants enact and coordinate through the script
                    ↓
practice produces relational and material consequences
                    ↓
consequences confirm, correct, or discredit the script
                    ↺

loss on either side
→ weaker enactment, coordination, support, or credibility
→ further loss on the other side
→ possible accelerating script unraveling
```

Unraveling and cultural unbraiding are coupled but non-equivalent:

```
peripheral script unravels
→ local repair or script replacement within the incumbent cultural braid

load-bearing or mutually dependent scripts unravel
→ cross-script cascade
→ general meanings and authorities lose practical confirmation
→ possible cultural unbraiding

general cultural braid is unbraided
→ several dependent scripts lose common orientation
→ possible widespread script unraveling
```

The **load-bearingness** of a script is the extent to which the wider weave or other scripts depend upon its successful operation and visible confirmation. Failure of one peripheral routine therefore does not establish cultural collapse; failure across family formation, productive work, lawful succession, public truth-testing, or another highly connected script family may propagate much further. The direction and extent of propagation are empirical questions.

Scriptlessness in Rao's sense must not be translated as an empty PCI slot. It means that no viable action repertoire is available within the relevant domain. The local slot remains fully occupied, although its installed weave may be de-animated, tangled, closed, practically obsolete, or unable to generate an adequate situated response. Nor is script unraveling identical to Babelization: one widely shared script can fail while participants remain mutually intelligible, and locally viable scripts can coexist while their interfaces fall below the anti-Babel floor.

Applied to relevant structures, **relevance activation** foregrounds a concern and appraisal mapping already installed in the lens. **Relevance reprogramming** changes which relational arrangements carry moral weight, how strongly they matter, what support or damage means, or how conflicts among them are resolved. Repeated foregrounding may

reinforce and eventually help reprogram the lens, but a one-shot increase in salience does not by itself establish durable reprogramming.

The theory studies one endogenous formation path and one prospective purposive research route.

Endogenous mythology formation is the largely distributed and not centrally designed process through which changes in social structure, institutions, lived practice, and receiver dispositions generate pressures, needs, and aspirations; competing articulations are then selected, sacralized, embodied, and reproduced. It is the ordinary cultural-growth path. *Endogenous* describes causal provenance, not innocence, health, inevitability, or moral legitimacy.

Purposive mythology construction is the open research possibility that a person, office, organization, or coalition might adopt a proposed destination and deliberately intervene in the mythologies, causal classifications, symbols, roles, permissions, and supporting institutions through which a population interprets and acts. Any attempted constructor remains inside culture: the desired destination, available materials, authority, and perception of the problem have themselves been culturally formed, and the intervention becomes one more input into receiver, institutional, rival, and reality selection.

The detailed semantic definition, design audit, and workflow belong to *Mythology Construction*; the present section states only the distinction needed by the core causal cycle.

```
ENDOGENOUS FORMATION
changing conditions → diffuse mismatch → competing articulations
→ distributed selection → embodiment and reproduction

PROSPECTIVE PURPOSIVE CONSTRUCTION
chosen destination D*
→ diagnose receivers, incumbent order, and likely baseline trajectory
→ deliberately alter mythologies and supporting arrangements
→ prototype, observe, correct, defend, or retire
```

The prospective branch treats mythology as a privileged symbolic intervention surface because evaluated stories encode roles, causes, values, permissions, and consequences in a form close to the bigOther's learned operations. It is not the whole implementation surface. Leadership behaviour, systems, symbols, habits, rewards, sanctions, material conditions, and repeated experience may confirm, redirect, or defeat an intended mythology. An attempted purpose therefore does not imply control:

```
actual successor
= intended destination × receiver fit × incumbent resistance
× institutional selection × rival intervention
× unintended consequence × reality
```

The multiplicative notation marks joint constraint, not a measured equation.

A slogan, flag, gesture, uniform, accusation, facial expression, or news event normally does not transmit a complete mythological lens. It is a small trigger interpreted by an already programmed bigOther. The same signal can therefore produce opposite reactions in people with differently formed lenses. When the event is subsequently organized and retold as an evaluated story, it can also become a new mythology that reinforces or modifies the lens.

A **master signifier** is an especially dense activation signal. In the co-developed analogy adopted here, it is a **highly compressed protocol token** that indexes and activates an already installed complex of stories, classifications, authorities, identities, sentiments, and expected conduct. The token does not contain that whole complex any more than M contains every ordered pair of a mathematical mapping. Its power depends upon prior programming and a shared convention for expanding it. Longer stories, repeated practice, and institutional experience can change the program; the token usually calls the program already present.

The same distinction applies when a slogan, song, hero, ritual, work, or exemplary practice evokes a culturally shared sublimation. The carrier does not contain the sublimation process or the durable cultural arrangement that teaches it. It activates installed mappings connecting the represented practice to honour, shame, capability, contribution, belonging, or obligation. A rival or cynical mythology can activate a contrary classification; repeated stories, symbols, rewards, sanctions, systems, and observed conduct can reinforce that mapping and eventually reprogram the operative lens:

```
incumbent mythologies:
sublimated practice → honour, contribution, capability
```

```
                              ↓ rival reclassification
sublimated practice → exploitation, foolishness, conformity, futility
                              ↓ repeated cultural implementation
reinforcement or reprogramming of the mythological lens
                              ↓
local bigOther supplies changed sentiment and motivation
                              ↓
changed enactment, Beseelung, and intergenerational transmission
```

Wegner's compression and decompression vocabulary supplies a useful second view of this operation: a small token can stand in for a much larger installed complex. In the constitutive language of Culture Mechanics, however, the intrapersonal target is the programming of the mythological lens. A "decoder" is an analogy for recipient reconstruction through ordinary cognition, learned context, the installed lens, and local-bigOther classification–not a third processor. Prestigious examples, ridicule, rewards, and sanctions are programming and reinforcement channels rather than a substitute for the lens. *Beseelung* remains the independent degree to which the resulting program is affectively alive and conduct-directing, not a separate decoding faculty or necessarily a conscious willingness.

This activation capacity has a developmental precondition. The token can call an installed complex only where prior formation has built enough recipient-side conceptual, causal, evaluative, and practical structure to expand it. Operation-bootstrapped codebook formation names the recurrent experience, example, questioning, contrast, practice, and correction through which that capacity is locally reconstructed and socially calibrated. The codebook is distributed analytical shorthand for ordinary cognition, the installed mythological lens, local-bigOther classification, and the shared symbolic protocol, not another processor.

Activation and replacement must therefore not be confused. A signal can activate or reinforce material already compatible with the installed lens. It cannot by itself make an incompatible governing program co-occupy the slot. Such capture requires the incumbent's authority relations and classifications to be loosened, detached, or reinterpreted and a successor weave to be constructed.

8. Culture-mechanical objects, ideological programs, conformity signals, and targeting signals

This section develops a mini-theory of the objects through which cultural programs become personally operative and publicly legible. Its authoritative home is *Culture Mechanics* because the mechanism begins at the interface among an installed lens, the local bigOther that executes it, and a socially intelligible token. The mechanism can then scale into the mechanical-solidarity field developed in *Epistemic Agency under Mechanical Solidarity*. A symbol is not merely an individual possession: institutions may prescribe it, absence may communicate without deliberate intention, and its aggregate effect may exceed what any one participant intends.

Culture-mechanical object A **culture-mechanical object** is any program, carrier, implementation arrangement, processor state, or emergent collective organization whose relevant function is to install, activate, transmit, execute, synchronize, or enforce culturally learned social and evaluative classifications. The term is proposed by the present framework as a broad analytical umbrella. It does not make every member of the category the same kind of thing.

Culture-mechanical object	Meaning	Examples
Program complex	A large, internally structured package capable of programming an operative mythological lens	Religions, Marxism, National Socialism, liberal constitutional culture, nationalism, company cultures, activist movements, military ethos, professional cultures, state programmes
Program unit or content	Material from which a larger operative weave is constructed	Mythologies, narratives, causal stories, moral rules, roles, exemplars, sacred values, master signifiers

Culture-mechanical object	Meaning	Examples
Carrier or activation device	A token through which the program is communicated, activated, or made publicly legible	Flags, veils, blue neckerchiefs, imposed yellow stars, badges, certificates, slogans, linguistic forms, masks, salutes, songs, whistle signals
Implementation arrangement	A durable structure that rewards, sanctions, repeats, or institutionalizes the program	Schools, appointment systems, rituals, calendars, dress codes, promotion criteria, laws, media routines, organizational systems
Local execution	The installed program as executed by an individual sentiment classifier	A local bigOther applying its mythological lens
Collective formation	The emergent result of compatible local execution and reciprocal signalling	Mechanical solidarity and the distributed bigOther
Collective agent	A sufficiently integrated and continuous collective formation capable of judgment, intention, ownership, and action	An operative multi-mind-self

A culturally legible phrase, song, image, hero, or ritual that evokes a shared sublimation remains a **carrier or activation device**, an **ideological symbol**, a master-signifier-like token, or a fragment of mythology according to its actual function. The Wegner-facing expression **sublimation emblem** may be useful as explanatory shorthand for its compressed representative role, but it does not create a new culture-mechanical object type. Analysis must keep separate the sublimation process, its resulting character or practice, the cultural sublimation architecture that recurrently produces it, and the token that activates relevant programming.

In common contemporary political, organizational, and media usage, **narrative** is often a fuzzy synonym for **mythology**. Culture mechanics retains a precise boundary inside that overlap. *Narrative* is the broader term for an organized account of events, actors, causes, and consequences. A narrative becomes culture-mechanically mythological when it also carries socially learned evaluation, roles, causal interpretation, expected feeling, or permission–when it teaches not only what happened but what should feel admirable, shameful, legitimate, treacherous, threatening, redemptive, permitted, or forbidden. A merely chronological account need not be a mythology. A **causal story** is a narrative specialized around explaining why something happened and assigning agency or responsibility. The common political expression **"the narrative"** may refer more broadly to an authorized mythology, mythology family, or even the lens through which events are required to be interpreted; its precise level must be identified from context.

At the applied level, **narrative design** and **narrative construction** are therefore close practitioner-language synonyms for **mythology construction**. *Mythology Construction* develops this relationship and identifies existing narrative-design toolkits as partial practical implementations of the same intervention domain.

A whole religion, political formation, company culture, activist movement, or state programme may be a **composite culture-mechanical object** containing several of these subtypes. The name *Christianity*, *Islam*, *Judaism*, *Marxism*, *National Socialism*, or *company culture* may refer in one sentence to a body of programming and in another to its institutions, carriers, synchronized population, or collective agency. Analysis must therefore identify which level is meant rather than treating the inherited name as a precise ontology.

Within that wider category, a large internally structured cultural program whose packages are mutually fitted is a **Culture Program Complex**, shortened where unambiguous to **program complex**. The composite culture-mechanical object remains broader because it may join programs, carriers, institutions, fields, outputs, and processes across analytical levels. The canonical program terminology, its reality-answerability branches, and its ecology are defined in *Culture Program Ecology*.

What the theory is disentangling Ordinary vocabulary often uses *religion*, *ideology*, *culture*, *collective consciousness*, *big Other*, or *group mind* as near-synonyms. Culture mechanics treats religion and secular ideology as members of the same broad family of cultural programming while refusing to collapse program, processor, protocol, field, and agent:

Construct	Precise role in culture mechanics
Culture Program	The executable package of mythologies, classifications, rules, roles, values, and expected conduct installed as one operative weave. **Cultural or ideological program** remains a legacy or explanatory alias.
Ideological generator and Ideology	An ideological generator is a reusable grammar capable of producing linked representations, roles, diagnoses, authorities, enemies, duties, remedies, and challenge interpretations. **Ideology** is the stricter sufficiently installed Culture Program that recurrently generates authorized social un-reality and recruits un-reason to defend its operative authority. The generator alone is not an Ideology; their primary semantic home is *Culture Program Ecology*.
Minogue-ideology	Narrow Ideology subtype joining hidden oppression, opposed positions, asymmetric or false consciousness, revelatory corrected sight, mobilization, transformative power, liberation, and a terminal ideal tending to displace ordinary political plurality. *Mythology Construction* owns the source reconstruction; *Culture Program Ecology* owns the classifier relation.
Culture Program Complex	A large Culture Program containing multiple mutually fitted packages or components; not a second bigOther and narrower than a composite culture-mechanical object.
Culture Program carrying structure	The organizational and material substrate through which a Culture Program is financed, taught, reproduced, coordinated, amplified, protected, and given continuity or operational capability. It is neither the program nor the population of human carriers; its primary semantic home is *Culture Program Ecology*.
Polity-scale *Gleichschaltung* hazard	Process-level warning that human carriers, symbolic and conformity-marker environments, and institutional-operational systems across multiple formerly independent societal domains are being aligned toward one privileged ideological direction. It can arise before a complete Culture Program is reconstructed and before a completed polity-scale mechanical-solidarity morphology or Fascism conjunction; narrow coordination and voluntary thick community remain distinct. Its primary semantic home is *Culture Program Ecology*.
Self-Attribution Presumption	First-pass evidentiary rule: initially believe an authenticated, serious actor proclamation as evidence of that actor's own operative program allegiance, motivation, or perceived authorization and treat it as a program-level warning before testing causal scope and defeaters. Its primary semantic home is *Culture Program Ecology*.

Construct	Precise role in culture mechanics
Self-Description Valence Asymmetry	An authenticated, serious adverse self-attribution receives first-pass credence about the actor's operative understanding, whereas favourable self-description records the advertised ideal but receives no exculpatory presumption against installed operation, offspring, consequences, and failed correction. Parent-program attribution remains a separate inference governed by standing, script fit, recurrence, organizational support, internal contestation, and affirmative defeaters. Its primary semantic home is *Culture Program Ecology*.
Attribution-Source Asymmetry	Self-attribution provides situated evidence about the speaker's operative program; hostile third-party attribution is an allegation about the target requiring independent support. Its primary semantic home is *Culture Program Ecology*.
Propagation–Visibility Constraint	Large-scale, high-fidelity program reproduction requires sufficient descriptive, symbolic, ritual, behavioural, or institutional transmission; secrecy shifts code into bounded channels and ordinarily trades off against scale or fidelity. Its primary semantic home is *Culture Program Ecology*.
Systemic skeleton and living cultural body	Analytically distinguishes the fitted institutional-operational structure of a Culture Program from the human, symbolic, affective, and formative life that animates, maintains, repairs, or repurposes it. They are not two programs, processors, or bigOthers. Their primary semantic home is *Culture Program Ecology*.
Pluralist adaptive constitutional search	Proposed application in which a common person-protecting shell contains bounded policy variation, plural sensors, correction, lawful movement, imitation, and succession without granting one metric or institution root access to reality. Its epistemic architecture belongs to *Epistemic Constitution* and its concrete pluralist design to *Culture Program Ecology*.
Lifted-Order Capacity Dashboard	Proposed *Culture Program Ecology* sensor suite—Speak, Own, Refuse, Exit, Appeal, Correct, Cooperate, Build, and Choose—for testing a pluralist Culture Strategy. It is neither the definition of lifted solidarity nor a scalar social good.
Projective-vandalism circuit	Observable sequence in which a disowned blemish is projected onto an opponent, a taboo label makes the target symbolically attackable, and repeated denunciation may become affectively rewarding. Its linguistic home is *Linguistic Tricks* and its motivational hypothesis belongs to *Mythology Construction*.
Theoretical *un-* family	Restricted project family for internal deformation of X beyond simple absence or external opposition. It is not the ordinary meaning of every *un-* word; its primary semantic home is *Epistemic Constitution*.

Construct	Precise role in culture mechanics
Constitutive-relation inversion	Direct theoretical *un-* morphology in which X's characteristic operation remains active while an output, commitment, or authorized representation controls the inputs or correctors to which it should answer. It needs a specified relational instance but not one bounded institution; un-reason is its inferential-mechanism application and un-reality its socially operative state application. Its primary semantic home is *Epistemic Constitution*.
Pseudomorphic governor substitution	Thicker bearer-level theoretical *un-* morphology in which a durable role, practice, procedure, office, profession, organization, or institution retains recognizable X-form, machinery, and authority while an incompatible principle governs consequential choice, correction, and reproduction or succession. A person can instantiate it only through a specified role and period; it is not a whole-person essence. The process yields a functional pseudomorph of X; its primary semantic home is *Epistemic Constitution*.
Linguistic trick and instrumental untruthfulness	A linguistic trick is a possible local communicative operation; instrumental untruthfulness is the separate orientation that selects or preserves communication for operative effect while truth-supporting conditions become subordinate. Trick form, operative trick, deliberate trick, actor attribution, and institutional attribution remain distinct. Their primary semantic home is *Linguistic Tricks*.
Distributed carrier sequence	Possible cross-scale pathway from originator or selector through carrier and recipient reconstruction into possible un-reason, un-reality, organized un-reality, and systemic reproduction. Different people, roles, and institutions can occupy different functions; intent and guilt do not propagate with the message, no conspiracy follows, and every arrow requires separate evidence. *Linguistic Tricks* owns the communicative front end; *Epistemic Constitution* owns the complete sequence.
Latent Culture Program profile, contrastive correction-interface probe, and Culture Program fingerprint	A latent profile is a bounded conditional reconstruction of classifications, sacred values, authorities, affective activations, correction relations, and action tendencies likely to become operative under specified conditions. The proposed probe first establishes comprehension of a disclosed causal form through relatively uncharged cases, then tests whether correction practice changes selectively across differently culture-loaded implementations. The fingerprint is the typed multi-case distribution of those discontinuities across neutral and several program-loaded cases; selective A-linked recurrence can raise the likelihood of A's installation or load-bearing status, while capture requires further evidence of displaced correction or authorship. *Epistemic Agency* owns the diagnostic; one discontinuity, emotional response, or naturalistic example does not establish an Ideology, Culture Program, radicalized person, or danger.

Construct	Precise role in culture mechanics
Guided unbraiding and possible de-radicalization	Guided unbraiding is the hypothetical, consensual and bounded process of making an individualized cultural-affective braid observable, loosening selected automatic couplings, and restoring correction and reflective authorship without installing the guide's replacement program. Possible de-radicalization is the broader aspirational outcome only where radicalizing capture is independently established. MCIP is one candidate method; neither the diagnostic nor unbraiding is violence-risk assessment, forced conversion, established treatment, or proof of efficacy. *Epistemic Agency* owns the complete proposal and its directional-symmetry, research, safeguard, and falsification conditions.
Un-reason	Proposed cross-scale mechanism and direct constitutive-relation inversion in which reasoning remains active while a protected conclusion governs the evidence and correction to which it should answer. It is not a third constitutional orientation, a synonym for irrationality, a PGS diagnosis by itself, or a classification of a population; its primary semantic home is *Epistemic Constitution*.
Un-reality, organized un-reality, and correction nullification	Un-reality is the constitutive-relation-inversion state in which an authorized representation retains operative public reality-status while governing how independent correction may count. It does not require one bounded institution. Organized un-reality is the fitted multi-channel stock built around one or more such representations; after disclosure, correction nullification prevents an independently sustained correction from changing operation. Un-reason can block correction one epistemic level earlier. Their primary semantic home is *Epistemic Constitution*.
Moralized observation-to-mandate loop	A protected concern recruits a virtuous observer or reporter role; submissions become custodied records; semantic upgrading and amplification convert the records into a public-problem claim; the claim authorizes an intervention; and the intervention can enlarge the observation or enforcement surface. *Mythology Construction* owns the role grammar, *Epistemic Constitution* the report-to-reality and feedback failures, *Epistemic Agency* the citizen-sensor and internal-observer consequences, and *Culture Program Ecology* the institutional audit and worked example. The loop alone establishes neither fabrication, pretext, Ideology, nor systemic lying.
Systemic-lying epistemic constitution	Constitutional meta-order that recurrently generates, selects, authorizes, protects, and replaces organized un-reality because independent truth has been subordinated to usefulness, loyalty, control, or authority. It is not the sum of conscious individual lies. Its primary semantic home is *Epistemic Constitution*.

Construct	Precise role in culture mechanics
Auxiliary-un-reality explaining-away cascade	A reality collision threatening operative un-reality U_0 elicits an authorized auxiliary causal account U_1 that explains the correction away, protects U_0, and may acquire classifications and consequences of its own. It becomes counterfeit Bayesian updating only where authorization, identity fit, or programme utility substitutes for independent support while U_1 is protected from reciprocal defeat. Its primary semantic home is *Epistemic Constitution*.
Trusted-carrier correction lock	High-gain trusted-opinion-leader-function positions remain sufficiently aligned to deny a public correction distributed credibility, reception, or operative force despite growing ordinary dissent. It is a possible receiving-field implementation of correction nullification, not proof of falsehood, coordination, capture, or Shadow-Sovereign rule; its primary semantic home is *Epistemic Agency*.
Mythological lens	The generalized mapping through which observations are converted into culturally learned values and feelings.
Ideological symbol	A socially legible token that activates the program and communicates a person's relation to it.
Conformity signal	An ideological symbol whose performance or nonperformance makes conformity and deviation publicly legible.
Targeting signal	A performed, omitted, imposed, or attributed token that assigns a person or population to a sanctionable out-group.
Local bigOther	The individual sentiment classifier that executes the installed lens.
Lacan's big Other	The shared symbolic vocabulary and protocol through which the program and its tokens become publicly intelligible.
Mechanical solidarity	The synchronized symbolic-affective coherence produced through compatible local execution and reciprocal response.
Distributed bigOther	The persistent network state maintained through persons, institutions, practices, artifacts, reputations, and sanctions.
Operative multi-mind-self	The distributed system only when it becomes sufficiently integrated and continuous to judge, intend, own, and act as a collective agent. A multi-mind-self presentation remains below this threshold.

In this section, lower-case **ideological** is retained as a legacy broad, religion-inclusive adjective for anything pertaining to a Culture Program. It includes religious, political, organizational, professional, activist, national, and lifestyle programs. The preferred formal common-category noun remains **Culture Program**. Capitalized **Ideology** instead names the strict installed un-reality-and-un-reason classifier. Both uses must be distinguished from the narrower **ideological form**, the third member of the private–collective–ideological–fundamentalist taxonomy below. The expression **ideological-form program** names that third configuration when the senses might otherwise be confused.

Disagreement, mythological rivalry, and cultural-program conflict The broad adjective *ideological* must not turn every disagreement into one undifferentiated "ideological conflict." Culture mechanics distinguishes the object and intensity of conflict:

Term	Culture-mechanical meaning
Propositional disagreement	Incompatible truth claims that need not involve rival governing lenses.
Causal-story conflict	Incompatible accounts of agents, causes, intentions, responsibility, or remedy.
Classification conflict	Incompatible assignments of identity, status, purity, legitimacy, or permission.
Mythological rivalry	Informal or decentralized competition among meaning systems, including lifestyles, religions, political outlooks, and institutional cultures.
Mythological conflict	Active interference with a rival mythology's transmission, authority, membership, or institutional embodiment.
Cultural-program conflict	Competition between incompatible governing programs or operative lenses, especially where single-slot replacement is at stake.
Propagative conflict	Organized recruitment, formation, conformity testing, delegitimation, or interference with a rival programme's reproduction.
Coercive conflict	Conflict in which expansion, retention, punishment, expulsion, elimination, or another objective authorizes or uses physical coercion or violence.

> **Rivalry becomes conflict when participants begin actively interfering with the rival mythology's transmission, authority, membership, or institutional embodiment.**

Mythological rivalry can therefore persist without organized conflict. The transition can occur through recruitment campaigns, polemical unbraiding, conformity tests, delegitimation, exclusion from channels, institutional displacement, or censorship. *Mythology Construction*, "Mythological replacement: braiding, apologetics, and polemics," develops these operations and the problem of installing a successor weave.

Kenneth Minogue calls the organized struggle **ideological conflict**. In the preface to the second edition, dated January 2006 (p. xvi), of *Alien Powers: The Pure Theory of Ideology*, he argues that an initial move is to disable opposition, ideally by censorship. In Culture Mechanics terminology, this maps most directly to **propagative conflict** and **rival-signal suppression**, and to **coercive conflict** where physical force or violence becomes an evidenced means. Minogue's narrower, mobilizing, conflict-centered conception is now formalized as the **Minogue-ideology** subtype. It must not be silently equated with either the generalized Ideology classifier or the broad religion-inclusive adjective *ideological* used in this document.

Earlier project formulations called the last two outward operations **ideological-form conflict** and **fundamentalist-form conflict**. Those names are deprecated because they allowed propagation or violence to stand in for the inward person–programme relation. If that relation matters, report it independently: an ideological-form carrier lives the programme as a mission, while a fundamentalist-form carrier presents themselves as an instrument of its sovereign Will. Either relation can occur without violence, and coercive conflict can be executed by inwardly detached functionaries. Propagative and coercive conflict can overlap, but neither entails the other: organized propagation can remain nonviolent, while physical coercion can defend an incumbent order without seeking recruits.

Call censorship or channel exclusion **rival-signal suppression** when it obstructs a competing mythology's signals, and **counter-program suppression** when it attacks the rival program's reproduction or institutional embodiment. A counter-narrative is not analytically random noise: it may carry a rival mythology, independent evidence, an internal correction, minority perception, or innovation. For the relationship between this distinction and the physical noise-suppression heuristic, see *Analogical Models in Culture Mechanics: A Semantic Inventory*, "Positive feedback, noise, and rival signals." These conflict terms are project-developed translations; they are not Minogue's taxonomy.

Ideological symbols must be classified by function

> **An ideological symbol is a material object, word, linguistic form, gesture, sound, image, ritual, omission, or other socially legible token that activates an installed ideological program and communicates a person's relation to that program.**

The medium is incidental to the definition. A piece of cloth, grammatical ending, salute, profile image, whistle pattern, silence, refusal to applaud, or continued association with an excluded person can perform the same

operation when participants know how to decode it. A symbol can be simultaneously functional in another domain: a mask can be a medical device and also acquire a moral-political meaning; clothing can protect from weather and also display membership. The presence of one function neither proves nor excludes the other.

Ideological symbols can perform several distinguishable functions:

1. activate an installed program;
2. cue the carrier's conduct;
3. display affiliation or membership;
4. distinguish insiders from outsiders;
5. advertise the program or invite imitation;
6. test conformity and expose deviation;
7. assign or expose a sanctionable out-group;
8. synchronize attention, affect, identity, judgment, or action;
9. manufacture apparent consensus;
10. mark refusal as moral or character failure;
11. communicate a claim to wider social jurisdiction;
12. enable social, institutional, legal, or physical sanctions.

No one token necessarily performs every function. Function must be inferred from the surrounding program, expectations, audience, treatment of refusal, and actual institutional consequences rather than from material form, religious or secular origin, or the stated intention of one carrier.

Conformity signals

> **An ideological symbol becomes a conformity signal when its performance, display, absence, refusal, or substitution makes conformity and deviation publicly legible and thereby enables monitoring, reinforcement, sanction, recruitment, exclusion, or a claim to wider jurisdiction.**

A **boundary signal** distinguishes insiders from outsiders. A **propagation signal** is designed or selected for easy public reproduction and advertises, normalizes, or spreads the program. A secret greeting may mainly mark a boundary; a slogan, salute, hashtag, linguistic convention, pledge, or clothing expectation may invite or pressure everyone to repeat it. One symbol can perform both functions.

Targeting signals Conformity signals and target markers are not mutually exclusive material classes. They name functions that may overlap in the same token or expectation:

> **A targeting signal is any performed, omitted, imposed, or attributed socially legible token that assigns a person or population to a sanctionable out-group and thereby makes exclusion, coercion, persecution, or violence easier to direct.**

Here **sanctionable** means treated by the program as available for sanction; it does not mean that the classification or sanction is justified.

> **A conformity signal becomes a targeting signal when its absence, refusal, substitution, or incorrect performance makes the nonconforming person legible as a sanctionable outsider.**

The relevant **signal polarity** is how the classification becomes visible, not whether the carrier voluntarily communicates it:

Mode	Culture-mechanical operation	Vivid example
Performed conformity	Display marks the person as one of "us"	Blue neckerchief, expected mask, badge, salute, pledge, or prescribed linguistic form
Negative targeting through nonperformance	Absence, refusal, substitution, or incorrect performance identifies the deviant	Missing neckerchief, unmasked face where masking is expected, absent certificate, refused salute, or unapproved wording
Imposed target marking	A hostile authority forces the out-group classification onto its target	The yellow star imposed on Jews under National Socialism

Mode	Culture-mechanical operation	Vivid example
Attributed target marking	A name, accusation, record, database entry, or administrative category assigns target status without requiring a visible token	"Heretic," "class enemy," "extremist," "unvaccinated," or a corresponding institutional record when the classification routes sanctions

The blue neckerchief and the yellow star therefore differ in their direction of assignment but can converge downstream. The neckerchief marks the compliant member and its absence can expose a nonconforming target. The yellow star directly and forcibly marks the person whom the governing program classifies as an outsider. Both make a culturally defined boundary operational by making persons sortable.

COVID-19 supplies a particularly clear mixed case. An unmasked face could become a negative targeting signal wherever masking was expected and refusal was treated as evidence of irresponsibility, danger, or defective character. Vaccination status was normally not visible by itself; certificates, database checks, disclosure requirements, denied access, and verbal classification made it legible. The official phrase "pandemic of the unvaccinated" turned a biomedical status into a named causal category within public discourse and was explicitly joined to vaccination requirements. In a given setting, whether this classification became a targeting signal must be tested by examining blame, expected displays, access conditions, sanctions, and the treatment of refusal. This functional analysis does not by itself decide the empirical accuracy, medical value, legality, proportionality, or moral legitimacy of a mask or vaccine policy.

The decisive operation can therefore be negative. Where a display is expected, its absence identifies the person who has not complied without requiring that person to make a declaration. The signal thereby turns conduct into public telemetry:

```
performance or visible omission
              ↓
conformity and deviation become legible
              ↓
peers and institutions classify and respond
              ↓
visible conformity produces apparent consensus
              ↓
apparent consensus raises the expected cost of refusal
              ↓
further public conformity
              ↻
```

When the performance is mutually observable, it can also generate **common knowledge**: participants know the signal, know that others received it, and know that others can observe their own response. Michael Suk-Young Chwe's *Rational Ritual* supplies this coordination mechanism. Common knowledge can organize outward conduct without proving private assent or the complete culture-mechanical account.

This loop can produce sincere convergence, strategic compliance, preference falsification, pluralistic ignorance, or a mixture of them. Timur Kuran's *Private Truths, Public Lies* supplies the established neighbouring mechanism in which public expression diverges from private preference under pressure. Václav Havel's *The Power of the Powerless* shows how ritual public conformity can reproduce a system without requiring private belief. Culture mechanics adds the local-processor, symbolic-protocol, and field account; neither author proposed this complete synthesis.

The installed program also supplies a virtual **yardstick of the good member**: a good hunter, vegan, worker, believer, citizen, revolutionary, or comrade. The conformity signal makes a person's apparent position against that yardstick visible. Assenting to an absurd statement can therefore become an especially powerful loyalty test: agreement with "2 + 2 = 5" communicates little about arithmetic but much about willingness to submit. Signals can also mark enemies. Public rejection of a stigmatized word, object, person, or association may become its own proof of belonging.

A compulsory conformity signal is not automatically a **credibility-enhancing display** or CRED. In Joseph Henrich's narrower model, costly conduct by a model can make professed commitment credible; see "The Evolution of Costly Displays, Cooperation and Religion". With a compulsory symbol, the principal cost may fall on refusal rather than on performance, and compliance may be purely strategic. **Sanction-backed conformity signal**, **compulsory membership signal**, or **public loyalty marker** is then more precise. No unvalidated checklist or numerical threshold should be presented as a CRED measure.

Beseelung* and four person–programme forms** The originating **dead–alive** analogy distinguishes information that is merely known from programming that animates conduct. A relatively dead rule resembles "stop at the red pedestrian light": a person can notice and ignore it without much guilt. An alive practice can make omission feel like personal failure, guilt, or betrayal. The German ***beseelt–literally, in a poetic translation, "ensouled"–better conveys this experienced animation than the bloodless word *stored*.

Beseelung is an independent axis. It concerns how affectively alive and conduct-directing a program is, not where the programme stands in relation to the person, how widely it recruits, or how aggressively it enforces. A bounded private-form practice can be intensely alive. A football crowd can synchronize powerfully without seeking converts. A perfectly conforming functionary can privately believe nothing, and a fundamentalist programme can transmit its effects through cynical officials.

An impersonal lifted order makes the independence of this axis especially clear. It can be comparatively cool or only weakly *beseelt* while fully occupying the local slot, governing a broad jurisdiction, receiving strong institutional support, and reliably directing conduct through professional duty, contract, office, law, and conscience. Conversely, intense *Beseelung* need not bring broad jurisdiction, institutional strength, or collective agency. Low affective animation therefore does not by itself establish incomplete slot occupancy, a weak distributed bigOther, narrow authority, or absence of durable cultural reproduction.

***Beseelung* actuation profile and person–programme relation** *Beseelung* intensity answers how alive and conduct-directing a programme is. An **actuation profile** asks through which affects and motives that animation becomes effective: pressure, duty, aspiration, belonging, love, gratitude, grievance, fear, shame, joy, play, hope, or another evidenced route. Two programmes can be equally intense while moving persons through very different profiles, and one programme can change profile without losing its operative identity.

The **person–programme relation** asks what the programme becomes for the person. It may be a bounded enrichment of life, a shared belonging, an answerable mission, an inherited obligation, an identity centre, or an authority that increasingly treats the person as its instrument. The private, collective, ideological, and fundamentalist forms defined below are ideal-type positions on this inward relation and its allocation of principal standing between person and programme. They are not identical to the separately observable outward propagation and enforcement profile. A programme practised alone can occupy an ideological or fundamentalist person–programme form, while an institution can execute coercive rules through inwardly detached functionaries.

Henri Bergson's *The Two Sources of Morality and Religion* supplies the important precursor distinction between mutually reinforcing obligation pressure and morally expansive aspiration, together with *fabulation* as an action-supporting representation. Culture Mechanics generalizes the comparison into a multi-route actuation profile rather than identifying its complete taxonomy with Bergson's closed and open sources. His two-source distinction also supplies a non-reductionist warning: morally expansive aspiration is not merely closed group pressure enlarged to a wider population. Conversely, a closed group, nation, or empire can borrow the symbols and universal language of open morality while continuing to serve cohesion, exclusion, or domination; claimed universality therefore does not identify the operative actuation source or beneficiary. The existing Kant–Rand and Child-at-Play contrasts supply project examples of duty-heavy and aspiration-heavy configurations; they do not imply that either author or every programme has only one actuation route.

Obligation accumulation

A conduct-directing **obligation accumulation** can arise when many individually weak expectations support one another until their combined output appears as an unqualified "one must."

```
habit + role expectation + anticipated judgment + reciprocal expectation
+ institutional rule + inherited usage
→ mutually reinforced obligation
→ apparently self-evident "one must"
```

No single component need be sufficient, centrally designed, explicitly believed, or consciously rehearsed. The combined result can support valuable reliability, ordinary coordination, or oppressive conformity. Its presence establishes neither truth nor pathology; the audit asks which expectations contribute, what conduct they enable or prevent, whether the person can identify and contest them, and what occurs after refusal.

Affective-to-structural load transfer **Status:** Project-developed mechanism from the originating author's proposal that a strong institutional skeleton can take over part of the conduct-directing load otherwise borne by flesh-and-blood affective intensity.

Affective-to-structural load transfer is the proposed mechanism by which an operative Culture Program becomes less dependent upon intense affective activation in every carrier because habits, roles, procedures, incentives, sanctions, records, formation, interfaces, audit, and succession make its classifications repeatable across persons, situations, and time.

> **Institutions can convert affective intensity into structural persistence and range: the norm becomes less intensely felt at each node while becoming more reliably reproduced across the system.**

The term *convert* names a functional shift in where the conduct-directing load is carried. It does not mean that affect is a conserved substance which literally moves into a building, rulebook, database, or office. The characteristic sequence is:

```
intense personal conviction
→ repeated practice and professional habit
→ institutionalized rule, role, procedure, and expectation
→ broad, quiet, reliable compliance
```

Several routes can contribute:

- **Affective substitution:** procedures, habits, incentives, sanctions, and technical constraints reduce how much fresh affective activation each act requires.
- **Structural sedimentation:** earlier moral investment becomes embodied in professional traditions, routines, records, institutions, and succession practices. This may be called *affective storage* in shorthand, but the institution stores a reproducible form and history rather than affect itself.
- **Range extension:** standardized roles and interfaces transmit a comparatively quiet norm across strangers, organizations, generations, and territories.
- **Affective concentration:** most participants comply coolly while teachers, judges, auditors, custodians, exemplars, or professional bodies carry stronger commitment and maintain the reproduction machinery.
- **Periodic reanimation:** initiation, ceremony, exemplary cases, public failure, scandal, crisis, or deliberate renewal can restore affective salience when routine structural support becomes insufficient.

Ambient and activation-conditioned coupling

A further consequence is that visible alignment under ordinary conditions and realized coordination under activation are not the same quantity:

> **A society's visible affective alignment is a poor measure of its latent collective capacity. Institutions can store coupling in roles, interfaces, infrastructure and command relations, allowing an apparently loose society to become a highly coherent machine when activated.**

Here *store coupling* is controlled shorthand for preserving a reproducible capacity for coordinated action. It does not mean literal storage of affect, agreement, agency, or collective intention, and *machine* describes the resulting coordination morphology rather than turning persons into components without judgment or standing.

For analysis, distinguish three measures:

- **Ambient affective coupling:** the alignment visible in ordinary feeling, public enthusiasm, ritual synchrony, declared belief, and everyday interaction.
- **Latent structural coupling:** the still-available capacity carried by fitted roles, interoperable standards, records, infrastructure, resource-routing systems, command relations, and learned expectations before a demanding common task activates them.
- **Activation-conditioned coupling:** the coordination actually realized when a trigger, objective, authorization, resource flow, and command or mission relation recruit that standing structure into action.

The characteristic activation path is:

```
low everyday affective synchrony
+ differentiated specialization
+ standardized interfaces
+ routable administrative, logistical, and industrial infrastructure
+ effective activation signal, objective, and command relations
→ rapid coherent mobilization across otherwise diverse agents
```

Population records and qualifications can route persons into roles; taxation, credit, and budgets can route resources into procurement; transport and logistics can move material; firms and technical standards can make outputs interoperable; professions can supply differentiated specialists; and communication and mission relations can

align decentralized local judgment with a common objective. War is an extreme activation case, but disaster response, infrastructure repair, large-scale production, and scientific or technical programmes can expose the same architecture. Affective enthusiasm may ignite, legitimate, or sustain the effort, but it does not substitute for the transmission machinery. An order can therefore be weakly synchronized in everyday life yet strongly mobilizable.

Latent capacity should not be inferred from an organizational chart or nominal command chain alone. It becomes evidenced when activation or a claim-matched challenge makes resources traverse real interfaces, interoperable roles produce a coherent result, local judgment handles novel cases without losing the objective, feedback changes the course, and repair or succession preserves the function. Failure at those boundaries can reveal a paper skeleton, bottleneck, common-mode dependency, or brittle command system despite impressive formal structure.

This capacity is direction-neutral. The same structural carrier can organize care, production, rescue, repression, or industrial destruction; the operative objective and governor determine what its capacity serves. A successor governor may inherit and redirect the machinery, but mobilization capacity alone establishes neither legitimacy, capture, pseudomorphic governor substitution, nor an operative multi-mind-self.

A quiet professional conviction that "one simply does not falsify the result" may therefore be weakly *beseelt* but institutionally decisive. Professional formation, peer expectation, auditability, replication, career consequence, and institutional memory can make the classification reliable without sacred intensity, collective-self presentation, or an operative multi-mind-self.

The dimensions must remain separate:

```
low affective intensity
≠ incomplete slot occupancy
≠ narrow jurisdiction
≠ weak institutional embedding
≠ low latent structural coupling
≠ low activation-conditioned coordination
≠ low conduct reliability
≠ weak reproduction
≠ collective-self presentation
≠ absence or presence of an operative multi-mind-self
```

Avoid the unqualified expression **weak distributed bigOther**. Specify whether the alleged weakness concerns affective gain, field coherence, institutional embedding, jurisdictional reach, conduct reliability, reproduction, correction, collective-self presentation, or collective agency.

The mechanism is neither automatic nor irreversible. A static combination of cool affect and strong compliance may instead result from fear, convenience, material incentive, technical constraint, or externally imposed administration; historical load transfer requires evidence of formation, sedimentation, and changed dependence upon local activation. A skeleton can carry and distribute part of the load, but it cannot indefinitely replace living interpretation, judgment, correction, and renewal. If those relations disappear, structural persistence may decay, become brittle in unanticipated cases, preserve merely ceremonial compliance, or provide machinery for a successor governor.

When a programme contains an agent-model, ***agentified Beseelung*** can make that agent sufficiently present within local evaluation that the person begins to perceive, judge, and act from its represented perspective. This joins the dead–alive axis to bigOther-presence without making them synonyms: a practice can be deeply *beseelt* without a personified Thou, and an asserted vision or voice does not by itself establish durable affective animation, distributed agency, or fusion.

Relative deadness can also be a historical remainder. A culture may preserve a rule, word, symbol, institution, or habitual procedure after losing the mythology, rituals, practices, and transmission relations that once made it sacred, identity-bearing, and synchronizing. Such a remnant can remain functionally useful: the pedestrian signal still coordinates movement even when it no longer evokes guilt, sacrifice, or an experience of collective being. A later observer who sees only that remnant cannot safely infer that the rule was always affectively dead.

This creates a three-way calm-period ambiguity: an intact cultural system may be **dormant**; surviving material may be **de-animated**; or the former synchronization technology may be **culturally lost** and require successor construction rather than reactivation. Loss of that technology does not empty the one PCI slot: another operative mythological weave still occupies the local bigOther. *Epistemic Agency under Mechanical Solidarity*, "Observability, cultural forgetting, and contemporary witnesses" states the historical hypothesis and evidential problem. *Analogical Models in Culture Mechanics: A Semantic Inventory* maps them to the nested quantum, laser, magnetism, weak-field gravity, and contemporary-witness pictures.

The private–collective–ideological–fundamentalist distinction classifies dominant **person–programme forms**, not different kinds of bigOther and not a necessary sequence through which every program passes. Its inner spine is a change in what the programme becomes for the person and in who increasingly serves whom:

```
private:       programme as bounded enrichment
collective:    programme as shared belonging
ideological:   programme as mission
fundamentalist: programme as sovereign Will

person uses programme
→ persons inhabit programme together
→ person serves programme
→ programme uses person
```

Form	Lived relation	Relation to rivals and nonparticipants	Typical outward expression
Private	"This enriches my life." The programme remains an ingredient within a larger life.	Alternatives need not threaten it.	Personal discovery, self-cue, optional recognition, and little demand upon outsiders.
Collective	"This is something valuable that we share." The programme supplies belonging, ritual, and mutual recognition.	Other communities can ordinarily coexist.	Attraction, affiliation, mutual reinforcement, and visible enjoyment of membership.
Ideological form	"This is the right way, and others should be brought into it." The carrier acquires a mission.	Alternatives increasingly appear as error, injustice, false consciousness, or obstacles.	Recruitment, education, formation, conformity pressure, and institutional propagation.
Fundamentalist form	"The programme's ultimate Other acts through me." The carrier becomes an execution surface for a supposedly known sovereign Will.	Rival allegiance can become betrayal, pollution, or evil; personal judgment loses standing against the programme.	Mobilization, sacrifice, enemy marking, surveillance, coercion, punishment, expulsion, or elimination can become authorized.

Vivid ideal-type examples:

- In the **private form**, consider a dietary or yoga practice adopted as one valued ingredient of a larger life. It may be intensely loved while remaining bounded and leaving alternative lives legitimate.
- In the **collective form**, consider football-club or pop-star fandom. It attracts through advertising, spectacle, and the visible pleasures of belonging rather than demanding conversion.
- In the **ideological form**, consider a proselytizing religion or a political movement such as Marxism. Mission, education, cadre formation, or comparable training forms members in the "correct" way of being.
- In the **fundamentalist form**, the programme is encountered as an agentified God, History, Destiny, Nation, People, or Cause whose supposedly unambiguous Will acts through the carrier. Bodily force may follow, but direct possession of the Other's Will and displacement of answerable authorship are the deeper relation.

These examples make the forms concrete; they do not establish that every instance belongs wholly to one form. Whole religions, cultures, institutions, or movements may nevertheless be classified as predominantly one form when the scope, evidence, countercases, and possible falsifiers are stated.

The taxonomy is a project-developed synthesis, not a classification attributed to Susan Blackmore's account of memes and temes. Her replicator account supplies a neighbouring way to think about copied cultural information; the four forms classify a programme's relation to its human carriers and rivals. Their variability illustrates the originating software analogy: programs are flexible–that is the force of *soft* in *software*.

The separately observable **outward propagation and enforcement profile** asks how adherence is produced and how nonparticipation is treated. Its recurrent operations include personal discovery, attraction and affiliation, active recruitment and formation, retention pressure, institutional propagation, and coercive or violent enforcement.

These operations can support inference about the inward form, but they do not define it. Outward conduct is often easier to observe than lived relation, so a classification should join self-description, role and ritual evidence, treatment of rival allegiance, personal authorship, refusal, sacrifice, institutional operation, and correction rather than infer an inward form from one public act.

The forms compress several axes that must remain separately inspectable:

- depth of *Beseelung*;
- public visibility;
- outward recruitment or proselytism;
- inward retention and treatment of exit;
- lateral intolerance of rival allegiance;
- jurisdiction over domains of life;
- synchronization strength;
- social and institutional sanctions;
- authorization or willingness to use physical violence.

The forms are not a *Beseelung* scale, but independence does not mean absence of correlation. A living fundamentalist carrier position will ordinarily involve high, jealous, and often agentified *Beseelung*: the programme organizes attention, purpose, identity, sacrifice, and the standing of personal judgment. A programme-level fundamentalist form need not animate every participant equally. A small directing or interpretive stratum can transmit intense commitment through roles, commands, sanctions, records, and cool or cynical executors. If no carrier, institution, or living interpretive centre remains committed to the programme and only inherited coercive machinery persists, the better description may be a de-animated fundamentalist shell or an ordinary coercive apparatus rather than a living fundamentalist Culture Program.

Strong conviction, feeling called, self-sacrifice, or costly ethical resistance is not by itself fundamentalism. The stronger relation begins when mediation and answerable choice disappear and the carrier presents action as direct execution of the Other's supposedly known Will. Proselytism is not jealousy; jealousy is not physical violence; and discursive violence, defined below, can occur without a fundamentalist person–programme relation.

Jealous programs, solidarity, and collective agents The originating analogy is deliberately vivid:

> **A jealous multi-mind-self resembles a jealous lover who wants to own the beloved and cannot tolerate divided allegiance.**

The corresponding operational definition is:

> **A jealous cultural program claims exclusive allegiance, classifies incompatible commitment, dissent, or exit as betrayal, and mobilizes symbols, sanctions, institutions, and collective affect to defend that claim.**

Kenneth Minogue's *Alien Powers: The Pure Theory of Ideology* provides a close published neighbour in its treatment of ideological revelation as jealous and expansionary. **Jealous cultural program** and its integration with the present ontology are project-developed terms, not Minogue's complete theory. The complete source reconstruction now belongs to the narrower **Minogue-ideology** subtype; jealousy is one neighbouring relation, not its definition.

Jealousy must be attributed at the correct level:

Level	Operation in a jealous configuration
Lacan's big Other	Carries publicly intelligible categories and tokens such as loyalty, betrayal, idolatry, heresy, oath, flag, scarf, and rival symbol. It is the protocol, not the jealous agent.
Local bigOther	Executes a jealous lens and makes rival allegiance, refusal, or exit feel shameful, contaminating, frightening, or treacherous. In **bigOther-presence**, and especially **bigOther-as-Thou**, the person may directly feel a present jealous Other that claims fidelity and refuses divided allegiance. Calling the processor itself jealous remains functional shorthand for the program it executes; calling the experienced presence jealous describes how that operation can be lived.

Level	Operation in a jealous configuration
Mechanical solidarity	Synchronizes compatible classifications and reciprocal enforcement.
Distributed bigOther	Preserves the network state through expectations, reputations, rituals, institutions, symbols, and sanctions.
Multi-mind-self	If the collective-agent threshold is met, the integrated system can itself claim, condemn, exclude, punish, or attack through its members and institutions.

Jealousy therefore has both an **analytical description** and a **phenomenological appearance**. Analytically, the installed program defines exclusive loyalty and the local bigOther executes its classifications. Phenomenologically, a jealous God, Nation, People, History, or Cause may be encountered as personally present–watching, addressing, claiming, accusing, or demanding sacrifice. This direct individual experience does not collapse the local processor into Lacan's shared symbolic protocol, and it does not by itself establish that the surrounding distributed bigOther has crossed the multi-mind-self threshold.

Single-slot exclusivity is not jealousy. Every stable program fully occupies the one local slot, including an open, pluralistic, lifted program. Jealousy begins when the installed program additionally demands exclusive allegiance, treats legitimate rivalry or replacement as betrayal, blocks dignified exit, claims the whole person, exceeds its jurisdiction, or monopolizes authoritative interpretation.

Jealousy and proselytism are hypothesized to reinforce one another often, especially in ideological-form and fundamentalist programs, but they are not identical. A separatist sect can retain members jealously while seeking no converts; a missionary movement can recruit energetically while respecting refusal and exit. Analysis should therefore record outward recruitment, inward retention, rival intolerance, jurisdiction, and enforcement separately.

Exodus 20:3 and 20:5 supply the theological exemplar of a jealous God, exclusive covenant loyalty, and "no other gods." The jealous-lover comparison uses this as an analogy for the classification of rival attachment as betrayal or idolatry, not as empirical proof of the social mechanism. The related Christian interpretation–that the human capacity to join a multi-mind-self is the "God-shaped hole" that should be filled by God rather than a human ideological collective–is an originating confessional interpretation, not a general scientific proposition or a settled philological claim.

Moralization as character accusation: Andrick's bridge Michael Andrick's *Im Moralgefängnis: Spaltung verstehen und überwinden* supplies the missing micro-mechanism between moral classification, conformity signalling, exclusion, and escalating violence. In Andrick's account, misplaced moralization performs two changes at once:

1. **Focus:** the exchange moves from the disputed issue to the other person's character.
2. **Mode:** inquiry and argument become accusation and prosecution.

His kindergarten example preserves the operation vividly. A discussion about whether a kindergarten should have two or three floors becomes a trial of whether one participant is a good person who deserves to remain in the discussion. A fleeting statement or minor act is read as a revealing disclosure of character; the alleged disclosure becomes a character accusation; and the person's standing, rather than the proposition, becomes the target:

```
factual disagreement or missing conformity signal
              ↓
statement, omission, or association becomes "character disclosure"
              ↓
character accusation
              ↓
inquiry becomes prosecution
              ↓
discursive standing is attacked
              ↓
submit, recant, or be excluded
```

Andrick's strong verdict is that **moralization is discursive violence** and makes physical violence more likely. Its immediate domination does not require bodily force: it attacks the other's recognized standing and invokes the background threat, "You may not be breaking public law, but you are breaking my law; submit or I will exclude

you." Even legitimate moral condemnation remains aggressive in this account. In private relationships it is the metaphorical **atomic bomb**, or the sharpest social weapon, although consciously removing an intolerable person from one's voluntary private circle may itself be legitimate.

The tendency toward violence therefore cannot simply be abolished in Andrick's account: even justified moral condemnation contains an exclusionary threat. His associated freedom claim is equally strong–pathological moralization and free self-determination cannot coexist. Official voluntariness does not settle the question when refusing a prescribed linguistic form, dress expectation, ritual, or declaration brings foreseeable moral, social, or professional punishment.

Culture mechanics extends rather than merely repeats Andrick's account:

```
local bigOther classifies a person as bad, disloyal, or unbearable
              ↓ encoded through
shared accusation, stigma, required denunciation, or conformity test
              ↓ reciprocally reinforced as
mechanical solidarity and collective exclusion
              ↓ preserved through
distributed reputations, institutional routines, records, and sanctions
              ↓ possibly executed by
a multi-mind-self capable of organized judgment and action
```

Guilt by association is a secondary conformity signal. Continuing to speak with an excluded person, refusing to denounce them, or preserving a public relationship can itself be treated as a character disclosure. Cancel culture, refusal to enter discussion with opponents, mandatory denunciation, and the public sorting of people into epistemic tribes are candidate manifestations of this mechanism; each case still requires evidence that the operation actually occurred.

Division is therefore not merely a static condition. It can be continuously enacted as people stop speaking with opponents, speak only about them, infer character from statements, demand public denunciation, and punish continued association. In the wider cultural process, Andrick's operation can be understood as cutting a **cleavage plane** through an existing political-cultural *we*:

- cross-boundary friendships and conversations become costly;
- bridge persons and moderates become morally suspect;
- guilt by association suppresses communication across the line;
- internally recognizable conformity signals acquire greater importance; and
- the opposite side becomes a negative identity anchor.

This cleavage operation is not yet **cultural-epistemic fission**. It can end in the silencing, expulsion, or subordination of one side while one dominant Culture Program remains. Fission additionally requires two or more sides to become sufficiently viable as separately reproducing distributed epistemic milieus and local-bigOther-forming ecologies. Andrick supplies one important bridge-cutting mechanism; he does not supply that complete collective morphology or its Babelization threshold.

The present framework adds the **moral-closure hypothesis**:

Rudolf Bilz's formulation of human existence as **tribunal existence** and Odo Marquard's "tribunalization of modern lived reality" are neighbouring diagnoses of a condition in which persons are placed under pervasive accusation and pressure to justify their right to be as they are. The exact primary source for Bilz's formulation remains to be verified; it is retained here as a provenance lead rather than presented as established evidence for the mechanism.

```
group bundles around an argument
              ↓
non-bundlers are excluded
              ↓
belonging becomes membership among "good people"
              ↓
opposition becomes character defect
              ↓
an open society is converted into a closed community
              ↓
the closed community seeks dominance
```

The originating discussion connected this sequence with Ulrike Guérot's "bundling" description of a group organizing around an argument and excluding those who refuse to bundle, and with Ferdinand Tönnies's distinction between open societal association and closed community. That compound attribution still requires a primary-source audit. The diagram above is therefore Culture Mechanics' moral-closure hypothesis, not a definition attributed to Guérot, Tönnies, or an established general definition of fascism. Moral closure is one possible pathway into, but is not sufficient for, the conjunctive whole-polity definition of Fascism. When closure becomes a concrete attempt to align multiple independent societal domains toward one privileged ideological direction, test the separate polity-scale *Gleichschaltung* hazard. Do so even before a complete Culture Program can be reconstructed or attributed. Moral closure alone does not establish that process gate.

The originating **ideology-as-hallucination hypothesis** is stronger still: an ideology operating as a collectively protected hallucination cannot win through a reality-facing explanation of mechanisms and consequences and therefore tends to use discursive domination. On this hypothesis, moralization expresses fear–or, in the culpable case, knowledge–that the position would fail under fair conditions among equals. This is a definite and risky project hypothesis, not an established result of Andrick's book. It would be weakened by cases in which a position systematically moralizes strong opponents despite repeatedly prevailing under open, symmetrical, evidence-sensitive contest, or by evidence that the moralization is better explained without awareness or fear of argumentative weakness.

The enforcement–exclusion and violence repertoire The originating claim is:

> **Enforcement and exclusion are dual operations. Enforcement states or applies a condition of continued inclusion, standing, access, or permitted action; exclusion withdraws or denies these goods when the condition is not met.**

Andrick's compact threat–"Submit, or I will exclude you"–contains both sides. From the program's perspective, the rule is enforced. From the affected person's perspective, refusal can mean exclusion from moral standing, discussion, relationship, community, institution, territory, or life. The same sanction often does both simultaneously: excluding one visible nonconformist also enforces conformity among everyone who observes the consequence.

This is a structural duality, not an assertion that enforcement and exclusion are identical in every case. Instruction, persuasion, reward, or ordinary coordination can maintain a practice without applying an exclusionary sanction. A person can end a private relationship without trying to govern a wider public. Physical coercion can be used to retain or convert a person rather than expel them, although it excludes their alternative conduct and violates bodily autonomy. Jurisdiction, proportionality, evidence, due process, and the good being withheld remain separate questions.

The word *violence* must likewise not hide the difference between moral evaluation, discursive domination, exclusion, coercion, and bodily force:

Form	Program-side enforcement	Excluded standing or domain
Moral evaluation	Classifies conduct as good or bad; ordinary bigOther activity, not necessarily moralization	Moral approval or recognition as a good member; no civic or social exclusion need follow
Discursive violence	Replaces inquiry with character accusation and attacks the opponent's standing	Credibility, admissibility, or recognition as a legitimate interlocutor
Relational exclusion	Conditions or ends friendship, intimacy, or voluntary private association	A particular relationship or private circle
Collective social exclusion	Uses ostracism, cancellation, guilt by association, or coordinated reputational destruction	Community membership, social contact, reputation, and informal opportunities
Institutional coercion	Conditions employment, education, platforms, services, office, or professional standing on submission	Access to institutions, occupations, services, platforms, or public roles
Physical violence	Uses or threatens bodily force to compel, retain, punish, convert, expel, or eliminate	Bodily autonomy, movement, safety, territory, or the permitted alternative course of action

Form	Program-side enforcement	Excluded standing or domain
Eliminative violence	Treats the rival as having no right to remain, participate, or exist	Membership, territory, public existence, life, or memory

The conformity-signal mechanism is the sensor and this repertoire supplies possible outputs:

```
expected performance, imposed mark, or attributed label
                        ↓
membership, conformity, and deviation become legible
                 /                        \
       inclusion and reinforcement     exclusion and punishment
                 \                        /
            future conformity becomes more likely
```

This repertoire is not a deterministic ladder. Moralization can stop at private withdrawal or social exclusion, and movements can jump to institutional or physical coercion. The compact distinction is:

> **All moralization is discursively violent in Andrick's sense; not all moralization expresses willingness to use physical violence. The fundamentalist threshold is authorization or willingness to use physical or eliminative force, not the mere presence of moral aggression.**

Moralization can nevertheless raise the probability of further violence by turning the mistaken person into the bad person, licensing exclusion, making punishment appear deserved, and allowing aggression to be experienced as protection, justice, purification, or duty. This is a probabilistic escalation hypothesis, not the claim that every moralized disagreement becomes physically violent.

Stanton's genocidal escalation processes as a neighbouring model Gregory H. Stanton's *Ten Stages of Genocide* supplies a neighbouring model of how collective classification and symbolization can become organized eliminative violence. Stanton now emphasizes that the "stages" are overlapping, non-linear processes: they can operate simultaneously, need not advance inexorably, and can be interrupted. His object is the specific process leading to genocide; the culture-mechanical repertoire is broader and also applies to non-genocidal programs, relationships, institutions, and conflicts.

The models therefore map onto one another without becoming synonyms:

Stanton's process	Culture-mechanical relationship
1. Classification	The mythological lens divides a population into "us" and "them." Classification is upstream of violence and can also serve benign or necessary distinctions.
2. Symbolization	Names, dress, documents, and other tokens make the classification socially legible. An expected conformity signal can target through its absence; an imposed marker such as the yellow star directly marks the out-group; an attributed label can do so without a worn object.
3. Discrimination	Enforcement–exclusion becomes durable law, custom, or institutional practice that removes rights, standing, access, or opportunity from the classified group.
4. Dehumanization	Moralized character accusation expands into categorical enemy construction: persons become vermin, disease, contamination, pollution, or another kind of being whose removal can be redescribed as cleansing or protection.
5. Organization	Parties, bureaucracies, police, armies, militias, media systems, lists, and surveillance turn hostility into scalable implementation capacity. Organization is infrastructure for violence, not by itself another form of violence.

Stanton's process	Culture-mechanical relationship
6. Polarization	Moral closure, guilt by association, communicative severance, and attacks on moderates disable countercultures, compromise, and independent correction.
7. Preparation	Plans, target lists, training, weapons, mobilization, and euphemistic goals make organized physical or eliminative intent operational. These are strong indicators that a coercive or eliminative threshold has been crossed, although no numbered Stanton process defines that threshold.
8. Persecution	Institutional coercion and physical violence become coordinated identification, dispossession, arrest, displacement, confinement, torture, or killing of the target population.
9. Extermination	Genocide is a specific collective form of eliminative violence. The culture-mechanical category is broader because programs can seek to eliminate political, social, or other rivals without satisfying the definition of genocide.
10. Denial	The program protects itself after and during violence through euphemism, destroyed evidence, impunity, blame reversal, suppression of memory, and attacks on witnesses. This connects the enforcement–exclusion and violence repertoire to memory control and systemic lying in *Epistemic Constitution of Lifted Mechanical Solidarity*.

Stanton's model supplies historically developed observations and an early-warning process model. It does not establish the local-bigOther processor, distributed field, jealousy, or multi-mind-self ontology proposed here. Conversely, Culture Mechanics proposes a possible micro-to-macro mechanism through which some of Stanton's processes become affectively compelling, mutually observable, and institutionally executable.

The connection is a risky escalation hypothesis, not guilt by conceptual association. A classification, symbol, health rule, access condition, or act of private exclusion does not establish a genocidal trajectory. The inference becomes stronger only as additional processes appear: a sanctionable out-group, dehumanizing mythology, destruction of moderating relations, scalable coercive organization, preparation for physical force, persecution, and elimination. The absence of these transitions, durable protection of the target group's equal civic standing, and effective correction of wrongful classifications count against the escalation hypothesis.

Private morality and public standing The originating maxim **"morality is private"** protects an essential boundary: private moral revulsion does not by itself decide who may participate in public life. Taken absolutely, however, it would exclude genuine public moral questions and legitimate public authority. The compatible formulation is:

> **Comprehensive personal moral convictions do not by themselves determine another person's civic standing. Public coercion requires publicly contestable rules, proper jurisdiction, evidence, proportionality, and due process.**

Or, more vividly:

> **We may debate moral questions publicly, but disagreement must not become a character trial that revokes the opponent's right to participate.**

An imposed target label is not the target's self-description. Nuclear taboo vocabulary such as "Nazi" may operate as a targeting signal or as one stage of the projective-vandalism circuit; it does not by itself establish the attributed Culture Program or hazard class. The Attribution-Source Asymmetry governs that evidentiary distinction.

This boundary does not prohibit private association or moral judgment. It prevents a private moral law from silently becoming public jurisdiction. Its institutional development belongs in *Epistemic Constitution of Lifted Mechanical Solidarity*, especially "Low-cost contradiction, not low-cost condemnation."

Worked examples and boundary tests **The DDR blue neckerchief.** The blue neckerchief of the Pioneer organization was not merely clothing or a membership badge. In a school environment where almost every child was expected to be a Pioneer, wearing it displayed conformity while the missing scarf exposed refusal without requiring the child to speak. The historical description by MDR records that Pioneer membership was part of ordinary school life and served the state's socialist education. The culture-mechanical interpretation–boundary marker, identity and loyalty signal, public compliance device, and trigger for monitoring or sanction–is the present framework's synthesis.

Speech and conduct. Prescribed gendered language (*Gendern*) can perform the same operation as cloth when use displays conformity, non-use becomes observable, and non-use is interpreted as character disclosure. A COVID mask can remain a medical device while also functioning as an ideological signal when the surrounding field makes it a visible test of responsibility, obedience, solidarity, distrust, or political allegiance. A salute, pledge, pronoun formula, badge, ribbon, flag, profile image, applause, whistle, silence, or continued association can likewise carry the operation. The test is functional and contextual, not material.

Kippah and Islamic veiling. The originating whole-religion comparison is deliberately asymmetric and testable. Judaism is hypothesized to be predominantly non-proselytizing and the kippah predominantly member-directed: its ordinary public meaning is the wearer's observance and affiliation, not a demand that surrounding non-Jews adopt it. Islam, considered as a whole religious-cultural program, is hypothesized to be predominantly proselytizing and jealous. Islamic veiling can therefore function simultaneously as personal observance, internal conformity, outward propagation, and a claim to public moral jurisdiction. This classification concerns the operative canonical and institutional program and its aggregate trajectory; it does not assert that every Jew, Muslim, kippah wearer, or veiled woman understands or intends the complete operation.

On this hypothesis, veiling can become a **public threat** in a precise culture-mechanical sense: not because the fabric or every individual wearer issues a conscious threat, but because the surrounding program publicly represents a demand for wider jurisdiction and makes sanctions against eventual refusal predictable if that program becomes dominant. The kippah contrast predicts no comparable Judaism-wide apparatus for punishing refusal or compelling outsiders; evidence of such an apparatus would count against the comparison.

The blue neckerchief and Islamic veiling are thus proposed as **functional homologues** when both embody the program in everyday life, make conformity and refusal legible, distinguish good members from questionable ones, enable peer or institutional monitoring, normalize the underlying order, and reproduce it through public performance. Their differences concern propagation, jealousy, jurisdiction, and enforcement, not a categorical division between secular and religious symbols.

The boundary is not Iran. Police enforcement is the extreme implementation layer, not the beginning of a jurisdictional claim. The originating trajectory is:

```
practice presented as personal choice
              ↓
practice promoted as protection, dignity, or empowerment
              ↓
practice becomes a public model of proper conduct
              ↓
criticism is moralized as hostility or harm
              ↓
countercultures lose legitimate means of defence
              ↓
institutions accommodate and reproduce the norm
              ↓
nonconformity becomes socially or professionally costly
              ↓
the norm acquires legal and police enforcement
```

The language of protection can create an asymmetric field: the advancing program expresses its demand as care, freedom, dignity, or safety while resistance is classified as prejudice or aggression. The program remains free to extend its norm, while countercultures are morally disarmed from defending their own order. This is the proposed **protection-framed jurisdictional manoeuvre**. It can emerge through many sincere participants without a central conspiracy. Only when the collective-agent threshold is met should it be attributed as an intentional manoeuvre of an operative multi-mind-self; below that threshold it remains an emergent operation of a program, solidarity field, and distributed bigOther.

Iran is proposed not as the boundary at which the problem begins but as an advanced realized form in which a

religious prescription has captured state jurisdiction. The United Nations Independent International Fact-Finding Mission on Iran documents morality-police deployment, surveillance, arrests, prosecution, and forced pledges connected to mandatory hijab enforcement. The originating **end-state hypothesis** is conditional and categorical: for the relevant aggressively proselytizing and jealous Islamic movements in Western societies, success means defeating countercultures and acquiring sufficient institutional power; **if they succeed, Iran is the predicted end-state form**, in which promoted Islamic norms become compulsory public jurisdiction. Iran exhibits the predicted completed conversion; its existence does not by itself establish that every movement will succeed.

The religion-level hypothesis should be tested against canonical claims, mission and jihad doctrines, historical institutional trajectories, treatment of apostasy and criticism, freedom of rival religions, rules governing women's dress, and conduct after political dominance is obtained. It would be weakened by durable Muslim-majority orders possessing overwhelming cultural and political power while intrinsically protecting across generations:

- genuine freedom not to veil;
- conversion away from Islam and public criticism of Islam;
- rival religions and nonreligious life;
- equal civic standing independent of religious conformity;
- constitutional barriers preventing Islamic morality from becoming compulsory public law.

Judaism's contrasting classification is equally revisable: evidence of systematic outward conversion, expanding jurisdiction over non-Jews, or coercive enforcement of kippah observance would weaken the predominantly non-proselytizing, member-directed hypothesis. Whole religions may be classified. The scientific safeguard is precise scope, evidence, countercases, and falsifiability–not protective euphemism.

Combined mechanism and boundaries The mini-theory's central mechanism is:

```
jealous mythology defines exclusive loyalty
              ↓
ideological symbol activates the installed program
              ↓
conformity or targeting signal makes loyalty, refusal, or target status observable
              ↓
deviation or target status is interpreted as character or category disclosure
              ↓
moralization turns disclosure into accusation
              ↓
mechanical solidarity distributes the judgment
              ↓
systems impose exclusion, coercion, or violence
              ↓
the program defends or expands its jurisdiction
```

This mechanism is not a claim that every symbol is a conformity or targeting signal, every conformity signal is jealous, every target classification is wrongful, every moral judgment is moralization, every ideological-form program is fundamentalist, or every distributed bigOther is a multi-mind-self. Each transition is a separate empirical question. The theory predicts greater field synchronization and enforcement when signals are publicly observable, refusal or target status is morally interpreted, sanctions are credible, rival affiliation is treated as betrayal, and institutions preserve the resulting classifications. Evidence that these variables do not affect propagation, apparent consensus, retention, exclusion, or jurisdiction would weaken the mechanism.

9. First analogy: the computer with one PCI slot

The computer analogy presents the architecture in its simplest form.

Imagine a computer containing:

- a powerful general-purpose **CPU**;
- one **PCI slot**;
- a comparatively simple sentiment-classification card installed in that slot;
- a network interface through which the card exchanges signals with compatible cards.

The CPU performs complex computation. The PCI card does something much simpler: it assigns values to the CPU's current objects and possible outputs. It marks them, in effect, as attractive or aversive, honourable or shameful, legitimate or forbidden.

The card's simplicity is deceptive. If it can alter the CPU's priorities, error signals, and reward expectations, it can redirect the much more powerful processor. A simple evaluator can cause an extremely intelligent CPU to spend enormous resources defending a premise the evaluator has made emotionally non-negotiable.

The card runs a mythological lens shaped by many mythologies and potentially assembled from several compatible programming packages. Social signals usually do not install a whole new lens; they call mappings already present on the card. Because the machine has only one PCI slot, a rival card cannot simply be added beside the first, and there is no hidden runtime controller that ranks parallel cards. Compatible packages can extend the software on the installed card. An incompatible governing program must be rejected, or the incumbent program must be unbraided and a successor rebraided and installed on the one card.

This analogy makes the division of labour between the two processors easy to understand. Its limitation is that real human cognition is embodied, affective, interpretive, and less cleanly modular than a desktop computer.

10. Second analogy: Haidt's elephant with a wireless collar

The second analogy gives a closer picture of the proposed psychological operation.

Jonathan Haidt describes conscious reasoning as a **rider** sitting on an **elephant**. The elephant represents the large, fast, intuitive, emotional, and mostly nonconscious part of the mind. The rider represents the smaller conscious and verbal part that explains, plans, and sometimes guides the elephant, but frequently rationalizes where the elephant is already going.

Culture mechanics adds a **wireless collar** around the elephant's neck.

- The **elephant** is the person's intuitive, motivational, and largely nonconscious psychology.
- The **rider** is conscious verbal awareness and explicit reasoning.
- The **processor in the wireless collar** is the bigOther.
- The **program stored in the collar** is the mythological lens.
- The **mythologies** are the evaluated stories through which that program is trained and reinforced.
- The **wireless signals** are other people's expressions, symbols, slogans, rituals, approval, disapproval, and visible conduct.

Why the elephant–collar picture is more exact The CPU–PCI-card picture remains the clearest representation of the **single-slot principle**. It shows one comparatively simple evaluator installed at a privileged point, able to redirect a much more powerful general-purpose processor, and it makes the replacement problem immediately visible. Its limitation is that an internal computer card appears addressable from within the same machine. The picture does not show the functional and epistemic remoteness of the culturally installed evaluator from conscious awareness.

The elephant–collar picture adds precisely that relation. The collar is attached to the elephant, not operated by the rider. In the model, the rider has **no direct read or control path to the collar** and receives no transparent read-out of its classification. The rider may consciously perceive an incoming social signal and later notice that the elephant's affect, attention, posture, or direction has changed. Under the proposed semantic-access extension, the rider may also encounter a changed ability to retrieve, join, hold, or formulate a relation without receiving a report that the collar caused the change. The absence of reins, a remote control, a query interface, or a device in the rider's hands is therefore part of the mapping.

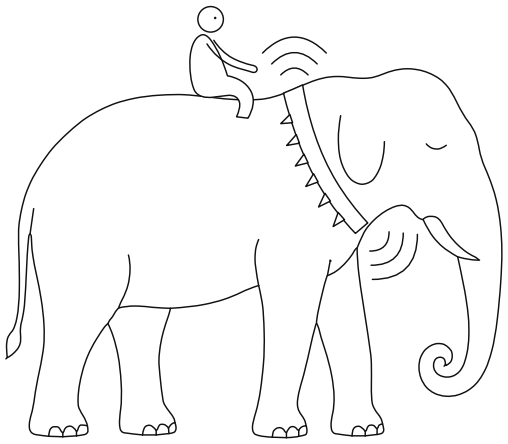


Figure 1: Single-person rider–elephant–wireless-collar model.

This remoteness is functional rather than anatomical and does not make the collar permanently unknowable. Reflective compar-

ison, external observation, and guided investigation may permit the rider to reconstruct, question, or retrain some of its mappings. What the picture denies is an immediate, transparent first-person interface while the classification is occurring.

The model consequently distinguishes two non-transparent output paths:

```
established affective-steering path:
collar classification → elephant's affect, attention, motivation, or direction
                      → rider encounters the changed orientation

proposed semantic-access path:
collar classification → conditions on rider-side retrieval, joining,
                          standing-query activation, or articulation
                      → rider encounters changed conceptual availability
```

The second path is functional, not a claim about a literal neural wire, memory index, or third processor. The current elephant–collar figure depicts the established affective-steering channel only; it should not be read as denying the proposed additional path. It is developed with its evidential limits in *Epistemic Agency under Mechanical Solidarity*, "Collar-conditioned semantic access: a proposed second output path".

The figure condenses the architecture of one culturally coupled psyche. It is read functionally, not anatomically. The broad dog-collar band marks the bigOther's installed coupling to the elephant; its spikes mark **affective leverage**, not literal injury, electrical punishment, or aggression. That leverage includes aversive classifications such as shame, fear, disgust, exclusion, and indignation, but also attractive classifications such as pride, reassurance, belonging, approval, and sacredness. The two equally sized sets of radio arcs mark reception and transmission. Their lack of arrows leaves the collar's network capability neutral rather than assigning a fixed direction to one depicted message.

In the established affective-steering path, the collar can produce social pleasure and pain: pride, shame, belonging, exclusion, sacredness, disgust, reassurance, fear, or indignation. It acts upon the elephant, which can change its posture, attention, and direction long before the rider clearly notices the collar's intervention.

Only afterward may the rider become aware of a conclusion:

> "This is obviously disgraceful."
> "Someone like me cannot do that."
> "Any decent person must support this."

The rider may mistake the resulting feeling for the product of independent reasoning. It may then use the main processor's verbal intelligence to justify the direction in which the elephant has already begun to move.

This analogy is closer to the psychological claim than the computer analogy because it shows that the bigOther does not normally dictate complete thoughts. It modifies the affective conditions under which thought and action occur.

Haidt's Leary citation: nonconscious and preattentive The experimental context discussed by Haidt makes this indirect access visible. Participants consciously saw purported ratings of how much another person wanted to interact with them. Even self-described social mavericks, who reported that other people's opinions did not affect them, showed substantial changes in self-esteem when the ratings declined. Their conscious self-description did not accurately report the operation of the underlying social evaluator.

In Jonathan Haidt's *The Righteous Mind*, chapter 4, section "We Are Obsessed with Polls," Haidt reports Mark Leary's conclusion:

> "the sociometer operates at a nonconscious and preattentive level to scan the social environment for any and all indications that one's relational value is low or declining."

Haidt then places the sociometer in the elephant. The exact citation chain is Haidt, *The Righteous Mind: Why Good People Are Divided by Politics and Religion* (New York: Pantheon Books, 2012), chapter 4, section 1, note 16, which cites Mark R. Leary, "Sociometer Theory and the Pursuit of Relational Value: Getting to the Root of Self-Esteem," *European Review of Social Psychology* 16 (2005): 75–111, at 85.

Two features of Leary's formulation are decisive for the present analogy:

- **Nonconscious:** the scanning and initial relational evaluation need not enter conscious awareness. The rider can therefore experience a changed state without experiencing the operation that produced it. Here *nonconscious*

does not by itself imply a specifically psychoanalytic unconscious.
- **Preattentive:** the scanning does not wait for deliberate attention. It can register socially significant indications before the rider chooses to inspect them or formulates a judgment about them.

Together the two terms identify both **opacity** and **causal priority**: the evaluation can alter the elephant before the rider attends to, understands, or explains the alteration. The rider may see the social input and later feel the output while lacking direct access to the transformation between them.

Leary's sociometer as a limited precursor Within Culture Mechanics, Leary's sociometer may be treated as a **limited version of part of the local-bigOther architecture**, and Leary accordingly as a **psychological precursor to parts of the local-bigOther theory**. The attribution is deliberately bounded: Leary did not propose the local bigOther, an installed Culture Program, the single-slot architecture, or the distributed wireless coupling developed here. His sociometer nevertheless supplies a closely fitting account of one possible affective mechanism through which indications of social valuation become motivationally effective in the elephant.

The sociometer is limited first by its position in the social sequence. It mainly describes the receiving person's sensitivity to indications of their own relational value. Culture Mechanics also models the upstream production of the judgment:

```
B's conduct
    ↓
A's local bigOther classifies B through A's installed Culture Program
    ↓
A's elephant receives the resulting affective valuation
    ↓
A expresses or behaviourally leaks approval, disapproval, inclusion, or exclusion
    ↓
B detects the indication and sociometric machinery registers relational value
    ↓
B's elephant changes before B's rider clearly understands why
```

A wholly private judgment in A cannot affect B's sociometer unless A expresses it, leaks it through conduct, or B otherwise infers it. The important distinction is that the local bigOther in A can **generate** the culturally patterned judgment, whereas the sociometer in B explains a narrower form of **detection and affective registration**.

The local bigOther also operates without an actual person A being present. B's own installed program can instantiate an anticipated or generalized third-party observer and apply its gaze to B's contemplated conduct or even to a private thought:

```
B considers a private thought, act, or possibility
    ↓
B's local bigOther instantiates the culturally expected observer
    ↓
the installed Culture Program judges B from that third-person position
    ↓
B's elephant experiences shame, pride, fear, reassurance, or felt prohibition
    ↓
B's rider encounters the result without any actual observer being present
```

This is the **local-bigOther inner eye**: the internalized third-party observer that can approve, shame, prohibit, or judge from within the person's own psyche. It must remain distinct from the individual's own imaginative-conceptual inner eye, which can narrow so that a culturally dangerous relation can no longer be seen, formulated, or named; see *Epistemic Agency*, "Scale bridge: ideological power, inner-eye blindness, and *Dummheit*".

The relation can therefore be stated compactly: **the sociometer detects indications of how others value me; the local bigOther also generates culturally programmed judgments of others, determines their content, and can reproduce the judging gaze internally when no observer is present.** Leary is a precursor to the nonconscious, preattentive, relational-value, and affective-coupling parts of Culture Mechanics, not a source for or validation of the complete synthesis.

For the mapped features, non-inferences, and relationship of the CPU, PCI-slot, wireless-collar, protocol, and network pictures to the framework's physical and craft analogies, see *Analogical Models in Culture Mechanics: A Semantic Inventory*.

11. The wireless superpower: the individual coupling interface

The bigOther's distinctive superpower is its capacity to participate in **distributed computing**. Every collar is both receiver and transmitter. There is no separate class of persons possessing the only transmitters. People emit social signals through:

- facial expression, posture, and tone;
- attention or deliberate inattention;
- laughter, applause, chanting, or silence;
- confidence, fear, disgust, or outrage;
- repetition of phrases;
- imitation and conformity;
- approval, ridicule, punishment, and protection;
- participation in or refusal of rituals.

These outputs become inputs for other collars:

```
Person A receives a publicly intelligible signal
        ↓
A's bigOther classifies it
        ↓
A's elephant changes state
        ↓
A expresses the resulting state through the shared protocol
        ↓
B and C receive A's expression
        ↓
their bigOthers classify and respond
        ↓
their responses return as signals to A
        ↻
```

The group figure repeats the complete single-person unit in a diagrammatic top-down network layout while retaining the readable side view of each psyche. All five units have the same size and components. The middle unit is therefore a focal example, not a chief, privileged broadcaster, directing organ, or separate class of transmitter. Centre-to-surrounding paths show reciprocal local coupling, while the surrounding paths show that participants also signal to one another rather than communicating only through a hub.

The dashed paths and collar arcs are symbolic, not literal radio waves, wires, or measured channels. Their lack of arrowheads marks the receive–classify–act–transmit reciprocity of every unit. The picture therefore illustrates how local outputs can become other people's inputs and produce feedback, amplification, apparent consensus, divergence, or synchronization. It does not by itself imply agreement, truth, equal influence, coercion, centralized direction, collective agency, or a fused multi-mind-self.

The originating physical analogy is that a local bigOther resembles a charged particle: it is a source of a field and is simultaneously susceptible to the field produced by other sources. The comparison concerns relational architecture and back-action. It does not propose a new physical force or claim that social dynamics obey Maxwell's equations.

When participants run sufficiently compatible mythological lenses and can observe one another, reciprocal feedback can produce rapid alignment. A crowd may begin to attend, feel, chant, fear, celebrate, condemn, or act as if it were one body. This is the individual-to-field handoff. The field's topology, unequal transmitter gain, collective agency, and epistemic consequences belong to the detailed account in *Epistemic Agency under Mechanical Solidarity*, including its functional morphology of mechanical solidarity: population body, distributed trusted-opinion-leader function, common field, directing function, reciprocal coupling, and possible collective execution.

12. Local bigOther, symbolic protocol, and distributed field

Culture mechanics distinguishes seven levels that must not be treated as synonyms:

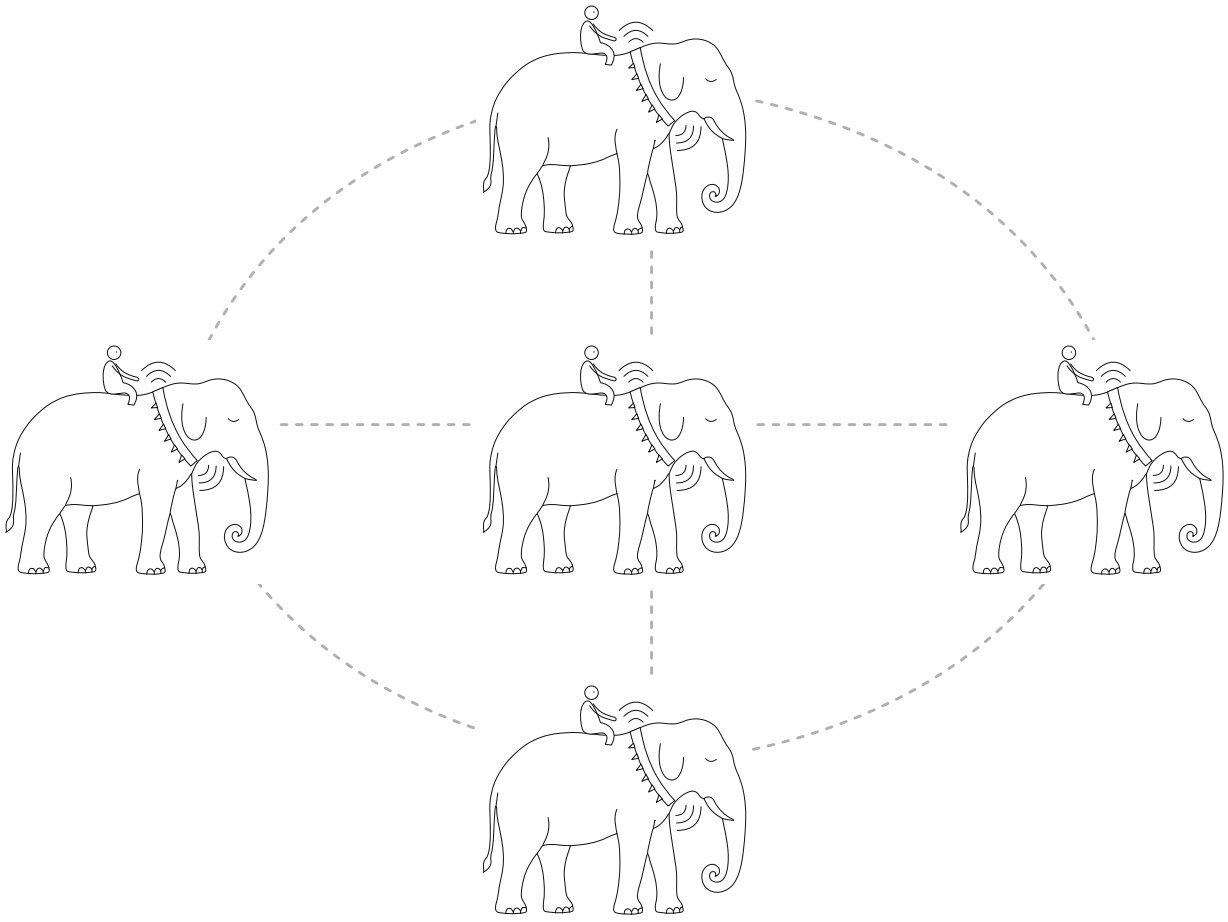


Figure 2: Distributed interaction among five equivalent rider–elephant–wireless-collar units.

Level	Meaning in culture mechanics
Lacan's big Other	The shared symbolic order and, in the present functional translation, the on-the-wire protocol of language, law, roles, conventions, master signifiers, and recognized symbolic authority.
Local bigOther	The individual sentiment classifier that executes one installed mythological lens and transmits and receives through the shared protocol.
Mechanical solidarity	Emergent field coherence generated as compatible local bigOthers repeatedly produce, observe, and answer common classifications and sentiments.
Distributed bigOther	The dynamically maintained symbolic-affective network state reproduced through local bigOthers, institutions, roles, practices, stories, and artifacts.
Multi-mind-self presentation	The collective represented, perceived, addressed, or incarnated as one self without yet establishing collective agency.
Operative multi-mind-self / multi-mind-self proper	The distributed system when it becomes sufficiently integrated and continuous to perceive, remember, judge, intend, own, and act as a collective agent. Not every crowd, presentation, or mechanically solidary field reaches this threshold.
Fused multi-mind-self	An operative collective agent that additionally displaces participating persons as independently legitimate authors across the relevant jurisdiction.

The relationship is generative rather than an equation:

```
LOCAL BIGOTHERS
sentiment classifiers executing installed lenses
                    ↓ communicate through
SHARED SYMBOLIC PROTOCOL / LACANIAN BIG OTHER
                    ↓ may generate
MECHANICAL-SOLIDARITY COHERENCE
                    ↓ maintains
DISTRIBUTED BIGOTHER
                    ↓ may be represented or encountered as
MULTI-MIND-SELF PRESENTATION
                    ↓ may become sufficiently integrated as
OPERATIVE MULTI-MIND-SELF
                    ↓ may additionally absorb personal standing as
FUSED MULTI-MIND-SELF
```

Franz Josef Radermacher's systems work supplies an independent neighbouring route into this scale transition. His 2004 discussion of humanity as a superorganism and 2007 comparison of performant superorganisms describe higher-order capacities emerging from interacting components, including human components that remain viable systems in their own right. That family resemblance does not make *superorganism* a synonym for the operative multi-mind-self. Radermacher's systems criterion can be satisfied by organized higher-order performance without establishing the Culture Mechanics threshold of integrated perception, memory, judgment, intention, ownership, and action, still less one unitary phenomenal consciousness.

The comparison strengthens rather than dissolves the distinction between collective capacity and fusion. A differentiated superorganismic organization can increase what the whole can sense, remember, decide, and do while its human members retain independent standing and bounded jurisdictions. Subjecthood absorption begins only when the collective additionally denies those persons legitimate judgment, conscience, purpose, property, relationships, refusal, exit, or appeal. Radermacher's later ant-state warning is therefore evidence of his own recognition of this normative fork, not evidence that every superorganismic system tends necessarily toward fusion.

This is not a necessary ladder. A presentation can remain below agency, an operative multi-mind-self can remain differentiated, and a fusion ideology can seek absorption without producing competent collective agency. Unqualified

multi-mind-self may be used as family-level explanatory shorthand, but strict claims about intention, ownership, responsibility, or fusion require the qualified term. *Epistemic Agency under Mechanical Solidarity* owns the complete register rule and threshold tests.

The distributed bigOther consists of no single person or object. It is realized through language, expectations, public symbols, rituals, stories, institutions, roles, laws, artifacts, and the anticipated judgments of other people. It is implemented through individuals but, as an emergent relational organization, is not adequately explained as a mere list of independently formed individual psychologies.

The relation remains recursive:

```
DISTRIBUTED BIGOTHER
mythologies, institutions, symbols, rituals, expectations
                    ↓ programs and activates
LOCAL BIGOTHERS
                    ↓ influence
ELEPHANTS AND MAIN CPUs
                    ↓ produce
PUBLIC SIGNALS AND INSTITUTIONAL PRACTICES
                    ↓ reproduce or transform
DISTRIBUTED BIGOTHER
                    ↻
```

Culture is neither wholly outside nor wholly inside the person. It is the comparatively stable pattern maintained by this circulation between local programming and distributed execution. First-order and **lifted mechanical solidarity** differ in the abstraction level of their shared classifications, not in this basic field-forming mechanism. *Epistemic Agency under Mechanical Solidarity* develops that distinction together with field geometry, collective ownership, gatekeepers, and back-action upon epistemic agency.

Durkheim's "extension of society" within the person is closest to this whole local realization of socially formed intellectual and moral life, not to the local bigOther alone. The local bigOther is a functionally distinct node and execution interface within the recursive relation: it is locally programmed and field-coupled, but it is not a miniature distributed bigOther or a literal piece detached from the network. Language, concepts, records, institutions, and ordinary rational operations cross the local/distributed boundary through additional parts of the same circuit.

Distributed bigOther and distributed epistemic milieu The **distributed bigOther** must not be collapsed into the **distributed epistemic milieu**. The distributed bigOther is the emergent symbolic–affective network state reproduced through compatible local bigOthers, public symbols, expectations, roles, institutions, practices, and field back-action. The distributed epistemic milieu is the impersonal and dispersed environment of concepts, distinctions, examples, methods, records, instruments, trained persons, and correction practices through which participants learn how to notice, inquire, infer, and communicate.

The two can overlap in carriers and institutions while remaining functionally different. The distributed bigOther concerns collectively maintained evaluation, obligation, and symbolic–affective force. The distributed epistemic milieu concerns resources used by ordinary rider or main-CPU cognition. It is not a collective brain, detached cognitive agent, third processor, or second local bigOther. Within homo duplex, only the local bigOther occupies the distinct cultural co-processor position.

Collective formation can therefore reach the person through two coupled modes:

```
affective--evaluative actuation
→ local bigOther classifies through the installed mythological lens
→ elephant-side affect, attention, motivation, and action readiness change

collective epistemic formation
→ distributed epistemic milieu supplies concepts, methods, examples, and records
→ rider/main CPU reconstructs, retrieves, joins, infers, predicts, and revises
```

The distinction does not isolate reason from affect. Local-bigOther classification can make particular rider-side operations honourable, shameful, easy, dangerous, or forbidden without itself performing them, while an affectively animated ethos can sustain cold analytical work. *Epistemic Agency under Mechanical Solidarity*, "Collective epistemic formation and the distributed epistemic milieu" owns the detailed mechanism, processor boundary, historical source bridges, and scientific-ethos application.

Nested authorship, activation, and episodic multi-mind-selves An operative multi-mind-self is a **network-level subject**, not a second local self or a second PCI card installed inside each participant. Collective and personal authorship can therefore coexist at different levels. The collective can legitimately perceive, remember, decide, own, and act as *we* while participating persons retain legitimate *I*s, differentiated functions, consciences, judgments, relationships, property, and bounded rights of refusal and exit.

> **A differentiated multi-mind-self adds an operative *we* without invalidating the participating *I*s. Fusion begins when the *we* displaces those *I*s as independently legitimate authors.**

The definition is functional and emergent. It does not reduce the collective to a mere metaphor or list of individual states: the organized relation has continuing capacities and acts back upon its participants. It also does not by itself assert one unitary field of phenomenal consciousness analogous to a biological person's experience. Whether collective phenomenal subjectivity exists is a further and much harder claim than whether the distributed organization qualifies as an agent.

The relevant integration can have different temporal profiles. A continuing multi-mind-self may operate mainly through differentiated clockwork coordination and enter intermittent high-gain laser episodes. An **episodic multi-mind-self** crosses the collective-agent threshold only during bounded periods of sufficient common attention, coupling, reciprocal feedback, memory access, judgment, and coordinated action. Between episodes, institutions, calendars, roles, artifacts, places, stories, and trained local bigOthers may preserve a **latent distributed bigOther** below the presently active multi-mind-self threshold.

Calling this latency "sleep" is useful only when viable reactivation machinery and identity-bearing continuity remain. A de-animated remnant or culturally lost synchronization technology is not merely a sleeping collective self. The detailed state model and its pilgrimage, military, and Subak boundary cases belong to *Epistemic Agency under Mechanical Solidarity*, "Activation profiles and episodic multi-mind-selves".

Differentiated unity and subjecthood absorption (fusion) The existence or strength of a collective agent does not decide what standing its members retain. Culture mechanics calls a real shared *we* **differentiated unity** when distinct persons, functions, judgments, relationships, and legitimate subordinate jurisdictions remain constitutive parts of the common order. The qualifier **person-preserving unity** emphasizes the same boundary: unity is not mere coexistence, but neither does membership dissolve the participating subjects.

Subjecthood absorption (fusion) is the independent extent to which a collective program treats its members as organs whose personal judgment, conscience, purpose, property, loyalties, identity, relationships, refusal, or exit have no legitimate standing against the collectively enacted subject. Equivalently, fusion is the displacement or absorption of the person's self as an independently legitimate author, so that another enacted self increasingly perceives, judges, speaks, owns, and acts through that person. The person's biological body, main processor, skills, memory, and practical intelligence need not disappear; they can remain active as the collective subject's execution surface. The eye still sees, the mouth still speaks, and the hand still acts, but the collective claims the standing to determine for whom and for what they act.

Subjecthood absorption is not identical to high cultural interoperability, strong synchronization, multi-mind-self agency, comprehensive local slot occupancy, or a large jurisdiction. Those properties can contribute to it, but none defines it.

The principal dynamics increasing absorption are called **fusion pressure**:

- one selected alignment is generalized across more domains and maintained beyond the task or episode that made it useful;
- independent judgment and differentiated contribution are reclassified as noise, selfishness, alienation, impurity, or betrayal;
- personal, household, professional, associational, and institutional jurisdictions are subordinated to one collective purpose;
- the collective's classifications become compulsory while correction, refusal, exit, and appeal lose legitimate standing.

Total fusion is the limiting case: high subjecthood absorption combines with comprehensive jurisdiction and closed correction or exit. The originating image is that persons become "drops of water in one clear pond." The image comes from Minogue's account of the ideological terminus and remains subtype-specific there; Culture Mechanics reuses it here only as a source bridge to the broader fusion limit. It is a pole, not the definition of generalized Ideology, every multi-mind-self presentation or operative multi-mind-self, and not a biological state that humans can literally enter.

A **fusion ideology** is a mythology or program that treats the separate person as an incomplete, alienated, or falsely conscious fragment and seeks to reconstitute persons as organs of one collectively enacted subject with increasingly comprehensive jurisdiction. Such a program can demand fusion without succeeding in forming a competent multi-mind-self; conversely, a capable collective agent can remain differentiated, person-preserving, jurisdictionally bounded, and corrigible. *Fusion ideology* retains the older broad adjectival usage; it does not satisfy the strict capitalized Ideology classifier unless the separate generator, un-reality, un-reason, installation, and scale gates are evidenced.

One route into fusion is **Humanity inversion**: an abstraction meant to protect the standing of concrete persons is agentified, assigned a hidden true interest, and made into the authority under which those persons may be consumed. Invoking Humanity alone does not establish this pathology; the diagnosis requires the conversion from equal standing to collective subject, privileged interpreter, and sacrificial permission.

These distinctions add a **subjecthood-absorption axis** to analysis without altering the single-slot principle. Every participant still has one fully occupied local slot. The question is what standing the installed weave grants the person within the collective relation, not how many evaluators occupy that slot.

The proposed **Lifted-Order Capacity Dashboard** operationalizes part of this person-preservation question through *Speak, Own, Refuse, Exit,* and *Appeal*, then separately tests constitutional correction, cooperation, material capability, and real alternatives. Its Secure Homestead Rate treats effective owner-occupied property as one possible material anchor for independent standing. These are candidate measurements, not additions to the definition of subjecthood absorption.

The proposed ***Schutzbalken* principle** places this boundary inside the pluralistic classical-liberal Culture Strategy: public and private concentrations of power must not become unbounded, unanswerable, self-certifying, or practically inescapable jurisdictions over the person. This is a proposed constitutional response to fusion pressure, not part of the definition of fusion. Power, asymmetry, wealth, expertise, employment, or collective authority do not by themselves establish subjecthood absorption; the diagnosis still requires evidence that personal judgment, purpose, property, refusal, exit, appeal, or other standing has been displaced.

Personhood and role interfaces **Status:** trunk-concept family. The interfaces and principal failure forms are defined, while developmental formation, measurement, and comparative institutional tests remain open.

A human being cannot present their entire inward life in every social encounter. Plural cooperation therefore requires bounded surfaces through which strangers can recognize continuity, promise, responsibility, office, competence, and standing without claiming possession of the whole person.

Civil personhood is the reciprocal accountability interface through which a human becomes socially legible as a sufficiently continuous, name-bearing, reason-giving, promise-capable, standing-sensitive, and answerable participant. Others reciprocate by addressing reasons, respecting autonomy and privacy, presuming continuity, limiting force, and recognizing repair. Kevin Simler's personhood-as-game account supplies the neighbouring "lady" and "gentleman" example; the present placement inside homo duplex and distributed cultural programming is a Culture Mechanics extension.

The trunk keeps three levels of standing separate:

Level	Meaning	Boundary
Unconditional human standing	Every individual living human organism possesses complete and equal moral standing which a person-protecting constitutional order is required to recognize.	It is not earned by fluent self-presentation, independence, competence, productivity, or role performance.
Interactional person-competence	Present ability to promise, understand reasons, regulate conduct, undertake liabilities, and participate in repair.	It can vary by person, situation, development, illness, or impairment without cancelling human standing.
Role competence and authority	Additional capability and bounded jurisdiction required by a particular office or relation.	Failure, incapacity, or removal from the role limits that interface; it does not demote the human bearer.

Inherent human standing and the recognition-only principle **Status: originating normative axiom of this synthesis.** The axiom is not attributed to Durkheim, Kant, biology alone, or current German positive law.

Inherent human standing is the complete and equal moral standing possessed by every individual living human organism from the beginning of that organism's existence until death. It is inherent rather than conferred, complete rather than graduated, and continuous rather than acquired through development.

Human beings are recognized, not admitted, as bearers of human standing.

No person, majority, state, court, legislature, physician, profession, institution, or Culture Program has constitutive authority to create, grant, grade, suspend, withdraw, or extinguish the standing of a living human bearer through classification. Human decision-makers may make corrigible, evidence-bound findings about whether the objective bearer condition exists, but the finding is declaratory rather than constitutive: it attempts to recognize a reality that neither the decision-maker nor the law creates.

The bearer criterion is the existence of an **individual living human organism**, not the presence of human genetic material in an isolated gamete, tissue, tumour, or other cell. In ordinary sexual reproduction, the project operationalizes the beginning of that organism's existence as successful sperm–oocyte fusion that activates the oocyte and initiates an integrated zygotic developmental process. Here *successful* refers to fusion and activation, not to later implantation, viability, live birth, health, or development to any selected stage. Mere insemination, proximity, or contact between gametes is therefore not fertilization; nuclear fusion completes ordinary fertilization but does not confer standing, and implantation does not create a bearer that was absent before it. For cloning, artificial activation, or another possible non-gametic route, the general individual-organism criterion governs so that absence of sperm cannot create a protection gap.

Human standing consequently does not depend upon developmental stage, implantation, location, viability, consciousness, sentience, presently exercisable rationality, autonomy, health, disability, dependency, productivity, wantedness, social recognition, citizenship, reputation, conduct, or political and ideological classification. These properties can matter to capability, responsibility, relationship, remedy, or the exercise of particular rights without becoming admission tests for the protected human class.

```
empirical premise:
X is an individual living human organism

explicit normative axiom:
every individual living human organism possesses complete and equal human standing

conclusion:
X possesses complete and equal human standing
```

This form does not derive the normative conclusion from biology alone. Biological evidence addresses the bearer premise; the explicit Humanist axiom supplies the normative rule.

Conflicts among human beings must therefore be adjudicated as conflicts among bearers of equal human standing rather than resolved by defining one bearer out of the category. Where reasonable uncertainty remains about whether a living human bearer exists and the contemplated act would irreversibly destroy that possible bearer, uncertainty activates a presumption of protection while evidence and review remain available; it does not create a permission to destroy.

The German Embryonenschutzgesetz, section 8 supplies a bounded legal comparator by distinguishing sperm penetration or introduction, nuclear fusion, and the statutory embryo, but it does not author this project's earlier recognition-only boundary. The German Federal Constitutional Court's 1993 abortion judgment supplies the neighbouring constitutional propositions that unborn human life possesses dignity and an independent right to life not created by maternal acceptance; the project axiom separately extends the non-conferral rule to every individual living human organism from fertilization rather than only to the statutory duration of pregnancy.

Reduced interactional or role competence can justify support, representation, limited liability, supervision, or removal from a specific office only through the independently applicable person-protecting rules. It must not be redescribed as loss of unconditional human standing.

A **role-interface** presents only the capacities, duties, authority, limits, and conduct relevant to a bounded relation: physician, judge, teacher, official, parent, colleague, diplomat, or another specified role. Helmuth Plessner's defence of masks, distance, tact, and protected inwardness supplies the decisive countercase to the assumption that every

formal surface is hypocrisy or PGS. A mask can protect plurality by preventing intimacy, total sincerity, or community absorption from becoming compulsory.

The two interfaces address different relational surfaces:

```
person-interface
→ presented to other persons
→ asks reciprocal recognition, reasons, restraint, and accountability

role-interface
→ presented to persons and to the local or distributed bigOther
→ asks recognition of bounded office, duty, competence, and jurisdiction
```

The role-interface has at least four audiences that need not return the same judgment:

1. concrete interaction partners;
2. those partners' local bigOthers;
3. the distributed bigOther preserved in reputation, records, professions, and institutions; and
4. the wearer's own local bigOther, which can classify performance even without an external observer.

The role is "worn" partly toward the bigOther because installed cultural expectations determine what a proper judge, physician, citizen, parent, or colleague may do even when no present observer commands the act. That does not make the role unreal or the person insincere. Socially constituted office can enable responsible action that private feeling alone could not coordinate.

Protected opacity is the legitimate remainder that neither interface makes publicly claimable: private feeling, relationships, doubts, vulnerabilities, unperformed possibilities, and aspects of identity outside the role's jurisdiction. Opacity is not immunity from accountability for conduct performed through the interface. The boundary protects the person from a demand that every inward state become transparent to the community or institution. Plessner's countercase therefore supplies an **anti-authenticity safeguard**: complete sincerity, confession, or exposure cannot be made the general condition of civic standing or role membership. Such demands can become instruments of conformity, vulnerability extraction, programme penetration, and subjecthood absorption even when described as community, care, solidarity, or authenticity. The safeguard does not protect deception about conduct, capacity, conflicts, or interests material to the represented relation.

The trunk distinguishes four failure forms:

Failure	Operative change
Deceptive masking	The interface is used to induce trust while concealing conduct or incapacity material to the represented relation.
Role overreach	Authority or obligation acquired in one role is extended into domains the role does not govern.
Role engulfment	The bearer increasingly experiences themselves only as the office, expected mask, or programme instrument; protected remainder and self-authorship lose practical force.
Interface inversion	The role that should serve persons or a bounded function treats preservation of its own authorized presentation as the governing purpose.

Selective civil-personhood breakdown **selective civil-personhood breakdown** *noun phrase* **Status:** proposed person–role-interface failure family

Selective civil-personhood breakdown occurs when an officeholder continues executing and defending a course while becoming selectively unavailable for the binding attachment of authorship, promises, contradiction, answerability, repair, and consequences. The operative asymmetry is not absence of agency in general:

```
authority + course execution + public defence
→ remain available

retrospective continuity + promise-binding + contradiction processing
```

```
+ answerability + repair + consequences
→ become selectively unavailable
```

Two experiential shorthands describe why this interface can feel more disturbing than ordinary evasion. The **answerability uncanny valley** is the encounter in which the cues of a continuous, articulate, responsible adult remain recognizable while the diachronic operations that ordinarily make that person reachable no longer work. The **protected role-terminal** is the controlled interface image in which questions and records are accepted syntactically but fail to change the operative role-state. These expressions describe the observer's experience and a possible interaction pattern. They do not establish literal automation, absence of inward life, incapacity, strategic design, or feigning.

Two observable routes produce this interface without deciding its cause. In the **unavailable-retrospective-self route**, the officeholder cannot or will not reconstruct the materially relevant past: "I cannot remember," "I cannot say," or "that account is no longer available." In the **non-binding-continuous-self route**, the record remains available but is denied binding force: the present role does not accept that yesterday's undertaking, authorship, reason, or contradiction constrains today's execution. The two routes can alternate, so that memory is invoked where continuity would bind and continuity is invoked where present authority is needed.

A discriminating collision occurs when retrospective uncertainty coexists with categorical self-exoneration: the bearer cannot reconstruct the interaction but claims sufficient certainty to exclude any relevant contribution or influence. The audit asks what independent record, inference, or limited proposition supports that certainty and whether the same evidential standard governs both answers. An inability to recall one encounter can coexist with independently warranted knowledge about another fact; the signature becomes informative where the exculpatory conclusion depends on the very reconstruction declared unavailable. In the non-binding-continuous-self route, the corresponding test is whether the recovered undertaking can require an explanation, acknowledgment, or repair even when changed circumstances justify a different present decision.

The construct classifies an evidenced public interface and must not silently decide among three different causal claims:

1. **observable selective breakdown**—the asymmetry is present, whatever its cause;
2. **strategic non-answerability**—the asymmetry is maintained or used to defeat accountability; and
3. **accountability malingering**—the narrower hypothesis that incapacity, confusion, memory failure, or another limitation is being performed or exaggerated in order to lower answerability expectations.

The first can be established from the role relation and repeated sequence. The second requires evidence that the interface is being used or preserved for its accountability-defeating function. The third additionally requires actor-specific evidence of feigned or exaggerated incapacity. Exceptional composure, persistence in office, implausibility, political benefit, or the observer's frustration does not by itself establish either stronger claim.

The narrower incapacity route can be decomposed without yet deciding intent. **Performed non-agency** names the actor-side presentation that the officeholder does not remember, understand, author, decide, or control the consequential course–in compact form, "do not model me as the causal author of what you are observing." The presentation can report a genuine limitation, reflect ordinary confusion, or be strategically produced; **accountability malingering** is only the last, actor-evidenced branch. An **incapacity-based accountability discount** is the observer-side reduction of expected answerability because the officeholder is perceived as unable to participate fully in retrospective reconstruction, promise-binding, reasoned answer, or repair. The **non-agency accountability shield** is the possible conjunction in which the presented limitation elicits that discount while authority and execution remain in place. This decomposition distinguishes presentation, reception, and deliberate strategy instead of inferring one from another. Genuine incapacity and strategic exploitation by surrounding actors can also coexist. Others may preserve an impaired bearer as the public answerability interface while retaining the capacity to continue the course through that office. That hypothesis concerns their evidenced conduct and control, not feigning by the bearer; ordinary accommodation or assistance does not establish it.

The public-side consequence can be a **paternalistic accountability shield**. Repeated attempts to attach evidence, promises, or consequences cease to feel like reciprocal adult address and begin to elicit pity, management, avoidance, or resignation. The affected public may then withdraw ordinary participant expectations because continued insistence appears cruel, futile, or psychologically pointless, even though the officeholder still exercises adult public authority. This can become a **withdrawal loop through collapsed accountability expectations**:

```
repeated failure to engage as an accountable adult
→ people stop expecting continuity, honest answers, acknowledgment, or repair
→ insistence feels futile, cruel, or absurd
```

```
→ anger gives way to contempt, pity, exhaustion, or resignation
→ consequential accountability pressure diminishes
→ the politician continues executing and defending the course
```

Repeated survival then makes continued non-answerability easier to sustain and lowers the expectations from which the next demand begins. The officeholder need not preserve the affected public's esteem: the loss of reputation can itself help protect continued execution when it makes people stop addressing consequential expectations to the bearer. In that branch, power survives not merely **despite** reputational collapse but partly **through the withdrawal of accountability expectations** associated with it. The demand is nullified; the course is not corrected. This is the psychological mechanism behind the Teflon-politician branch, contrasted with the high-standing Teflon prophet in the Teflon-authority comparison. Where performed or exaggerated incapacity deliberately elicits the withdrawal, accountability malingering supplies one strategic route into this loop; the effect itself does not establish that stronger attribution.

The loop is not inevitable. Contempt or lost esteem can instead intensify accountability pressure; the proposed shield requires an observed reduction in consequential demands, not mere unpopularity or insulting descriptions of the officeholder. Withdrawal from futile personal address can instead redirect effort toward records, independent investigation, adjudication, organization, succession, or another consequential receiver. P. F. Strawson's participant–objective-attitude distinction supplies the neighbouring interpersonal transition: ordinary reactive demands can give way to management, treatment, pity, or avoidance when someone is regarded as outside ordinary adult reciprocity. The political conjunction—retained governing authority together with elicited withdrawal of reciprocal accountability—is a Culture Mechanics extension and does not imply that Strawson described its strategic use.

Thomas Szanto's open-access account of epistemically exploitative bullshit supplies a second, narrower neighbour for cases in which one party remains obliged to undertake responsible, emotionally costly epistemic work while the other protects an asymmetric discursive position. That comparison does not establish bad faith, exploitation, prejudice, or intent in an officeholder case without separate evidence.

The resulting shield can reinforce correction nullification, but the constructs remain distinct. Selective civil-personhood breakdown concerns the asymmetric person–role interface through which accountability is addressed. Correction nullification concerns the failure of an independently sustained correction to acquire reception, adjudication, operative revision, or repair. Either can occur without the other, and neither by itself establishes a hidden principal, deliberate humiliation, systemic lying, or covert operational assignment.

The primary rivals are genuine cognitive or medical incapacity, fatigue, trauma, role restrictions, legal duties of confidentiality, poor records, ordinary incompetence, changed office responsibilities, confused questioning, and poor communication. The audit therefore asks whether the limitation is domain-specific, stable over time, independently evidenced, symmetrical across favourable and adverse material, compatible with continued execution, corrected when records are supplied, and followed by appropriate delegation, recusal, supervision, repair, or removal from the role. Repeated asymmetry raises a role-accountability question; it is not a clinical diagnosis. Compare actual performance across matched tasks and accountability occasions: **selective competence** means that precision and agency remain available for execution or advantageous objectives while reconstruction and repair recurrently disappear where responsibility would attach. Record the question, available evidence, answer, maintained decision, and later consequence separately, including occasions on which answerability succeeds. This tests the pattern without treating one incomplete reply or an observer's uncanny impression as the mechanism's proof.

Nothing in the construct reduces unconditional human standing. Interactional or role incapacity can justify accommodation, representation, supervision, limited liability, or removal from a bounded office only under the independently applicable person-protecting rules. The human bearer remains a complete and equal bearer of standing even where the public interface fails, and criticism must address the evidenced role relation rather than dehumanize the person.

Role engulfment supplies the missing failure boundary of affective-to-structural load transfer. An institutional skeleton can reduce the affective effort needed for reliable conduct, but it can also begin replacing rather than supporting personal authorship. Low affect may therefore indicate healthy professional steadiness or inward de-animation in which a person feels like a role-shaped skin over an empty shell. Performance alone does not discriminate them.

Role-bound speech can remain **full speech** when the bearer avows the judgment, marks its limits, can answer questions, and accepts responsibility for undertaking it. It becomes **empty in the relevant interface sense** when only ready-made role formulae can speak while the person's uncertainty, refusal, desire, or accountable judgment

cannot become present. Formal wording, politeness, repetition, or institutional authorship does not by itself decide between the two.

The audit asks whether the bearer can state the role's purpose and limits, exercise judgment inside it, refuse an incompatible demand, retain relationships and purposes outside it, accept personal responsibility, leave or change roles, and receive recognition as more than the interface. The institution must remain able to correct performance without acquiring the whole person. **Distance-and-tact correction** addresses reasons, conduct, or bounded office performance without demanding humiliation, confession, or total moral exposure. It preserves accountability while refusing the inference that correction needs jurisdiction over the bearer's complete inward life. Difference between inward feeling and outward role conduct is not by itself hypocrisy, counterfeit, un-reason, or pseudomorphic governor substitution. Burnout, depression, trauma, dependency, ordinary professional formation, strategic compliance, disability, fatigue, and temporary role overload can produce similar experiences or conduct and remain rival explanations. The trunk therefore classifies the evidenced interface relation, not a whole person or clinical condition.

Operative relationship modes: I-mode and We-mode **Status:** trunk-concept family and proposed operative-relationship model. The distinctions are functional rather than anatomical, and one episode does not establish a permanent personality type, collective agent, or clinical condition.

The existing architecture distinguishes processor, pole, installed programme, collective field, and subjecthood relation. The present layer asks a different question: **from which relational standpoint does cognition and action operate in this episode?**

I-mode is the personal-relational position in which oneself and another can appear as concrete centres of life and possible partners in an I–You relation. It includes attachment, care, responsibility, self-interest, resentment, possessiveness, and personal cruelty. It is neither a synonym for egoism nor a guarantee of goodness.

We-mode is the socially constituted, comparatively impersonal position from which a person thinks and acts through rules, roles, categories, shared purposes, institutional standpoints, or an imagined impartial observer. It can coordinate care for absent strangers and common goods, or it can treat a fully represented human as a case, task, resource, obstacle, or enemy without an operative I–You encounter. It is neither a synonym for altruism nor a guarantee of coldness or evil.

The central relational distinction is:

> **A human can be accurately represented without becoming personally present as a You whose claim can interrupt what I am doing.**

Names, relationships, fear, suffering, preferences, and likely consequences can remain known and enter sophisticated calculation. The missing relation need not be information or reflection. It can be the second-person relation in which the affected human addresses the actor as someone to whom the actor must answer.

```
I ↔ You
personal encounter and answerability

versus

We → them / case / task / resource / obstacle
programme- or role-mediated operation
```

The originating terms ***Ausblendung*** and ***Mitgefühlsentkopplung*** are retained only in this corrected sense. What is blanked out need not be the person's attributes, suffering, or fate; it can be the operative second-person connection through which those known facts become another person's claim upon the actor. *Mitgefühlsentkopplung* names that relational result, not a theory that bureaucracy must first erase information or that an abstractly "cold" processor commits the act by itself.

Solidarity-indexed person recognition names the proposed dependence of this encounter upon operative solidarity boundaries. A **personhood-routing rule** is the installed programme's practical routing of whether a human may appear as You, whether that encounter can interrupt a role or collective task, and whether the human is instead processed only through a programme category. These are descriptions of experienced recognition and operative treatment. They do not make recognition constitutive of inherent human standing.

Pole, mode, programme, and moral direction Four distinctions are mandatory:

1. The **Durkheimian poles** describe organism-rooted and socially derived sources and functions.
2. **I-mode and We-mode** describe the operative relational standpoint of an episode.
3. The **Culture Program and mythological lens** supply what that standpoint values, classifies, requires, and prohibits.
4. **Moral direction and jurisdiction** ask whom the resulting operation preserves or consumes and how far its authority extends.

The organismic-individual pole is therefore not another name for I-mode, and the social-intellectual-moral pole is not another name for We-mode. I-mode can use socially inherited language, conscience, and reflective reconstruction. We-mode remains embodied and locally executed through the biological person's perception, intelligence, affect, and action. No parallel local bigOther or second operative weave is implied by switching modes.

We-mode is an ordinary human capacity that a Culture Program can organize, stabilize, and capture. It is not by itself a god, collective agent, operative multi-mind-self, or powerful programme. A local mode episode establishes neither collective integration and continuity nor subjecthood absorption.

Mode and moral direction therefore form independent axes:

Mode	Person-preserving direction	Person-consuming direction
I-mode	Love, care, friendship, rescue, and answerable personal judgment	Possessiveness, domination, vengeance, and cruelty that can depend upon recognizing the other's suffering
We-mode	Bounded public service, coordinated rescue or defence, common protections, and voluntary contribution	Compulsory self-erasure, sacrificial collectivism, bureaucratic atrocity, and exterminatory administration

Direction is also target-indexed. One person can be loving toward family, heroic toward comrades, and destructive toward a population excluded from personal encounter. Conversely, a general rule can protect people whom the actor will never meet. Neither warm attachment nor impersonal generality supplies a complete moral verdict.

The resulting control spectrum is:

Bounded enlistment	Full We-mode takeover
Temporary coordination for a limited task and jurisdiction	Collective purpose claims comprehensive jurisdiction
The I remains a legitimate author; conscience, judgment, and refusal retain standing	Personal judgment and needs lose standing; refusal becomes betrayal
Outsiders remain persons and a classified object can reappear as You	Outsiders remain programme objects and I–You re-entry is blocked
Return from the collective standpoint remains possible; sacrifice is bounded and answerable	Self-sacrifice and sacrifice of others become programme requirements

Intensity alone does not decide the relation. A rescue team, orchestra, court, laboratory, or military unit can require strong coordination while retaining bounded roles, personal responsibility, the standing of affected persons, correction, refusal, and return. Duty becomes **person-consuming role execution** when a bounded office or mission expands toward comprehensive jurisdiction, disowns personal authorship, recodes refusal as betrayal, blocks the affected person's interruptive standing, and treats actor or target as programme material.

Repersonalization shock is the possible surprise, guilt, or moral disorientation that occurs when a human previously processed impersonally reappears as You: "How could I have thought or done that?" It demonstrates that mode-switching and return are possible. It does not make the earlier operation unreal or prove that every person, domain, or programme remains equally reachable through encounter.

Self-transcendence, love, and scale Overcoming immediate private interest does not establish goodness. The model distinguishes three routes that can produce outwardly similar self-sacrifice:

- **Relational self-sacrifice** can arise through I-mode attachment to a particular child, loved person, or encountered stranger.
- **Generalized altruism** uses socially formed concepts to extend concern to absent strangers, future persons, or people outside spontaneous attachment.
- **Collective sacrifice** makes a nation, faith, movement, army, institution, or mission the operative standpoint from which the carrier's own life becomes expendable.

The same capacity for self-transcendence can support care, courage, truthfulness, martyrdom, fanaticism, or atrocity. Ask what is served, who chooses the sacrifice, whether it is imposed on another, whether the end is independently legitimate, and whether refusal and correction remain possible.

Love likewise crosses layers. Embodied attachment and care supply energy and personal presence, while symbolic formation can generalize neighbour-love beyond family, familiarity, faction, or spontaneous affection. Generalization without encounter can remain an abstract command; warmth without generalization can remain narrowly partial. Person-preserving agape is therefore a cross-layer achievement rather than the property of the elephant, rider, social pole, or programme alone.

Scalar personhood collapse is the transition by which necessary numerical or administrative compression becomes moral cancellation: inability to imagine every member vividly is treated as permission to make the aggregate the only real object and its constituent persons morally negligible. The mechanism is distinct from information loss. A single target can be richly represented without becoming You, while an aggregate can additionally conceal the requirement that each member retain standing.

Statistics remain morally and epistemically necessary. They can reveal distant deaths, hidden patterns, unequal treatment, and harms that vivid individual cases conceal. The person-preserving conjunction is:

> **I-mode: this one is an entire world. We-mode: every unknown person must count equally. World: establish how many persons are affected and what caused the harm.**

Names, testimony, case review, individual appeal, and aggregate measurement should therefore correct one another. Institutions need not simulate a million simultaneous intimate encounters, but the limits of feeling cannot authorize cancellation of the people being counted.

13. Symbolic reality

The bigOther does not merely evaluate an independently completed physical world. It also participates in creating **social reality**.

A piece of cloth becomes a flag. A person becomes a judge, citizen, traitor, hero, or martyr. An utterance becomes a promise, verdict, oath, insult, or declaration of war. A place becomes sacred. A relationship becomes a marriage. An individual becomes the bearer of rights and dignity.

These properties are not inherent physical properties, but neither are they merely private fantasies. They are real insofar as people and institutions collectively recognize and act upon them. Symbols, rituals, and authorized classifications therefore do not only represent society; their execution helps constitute society.

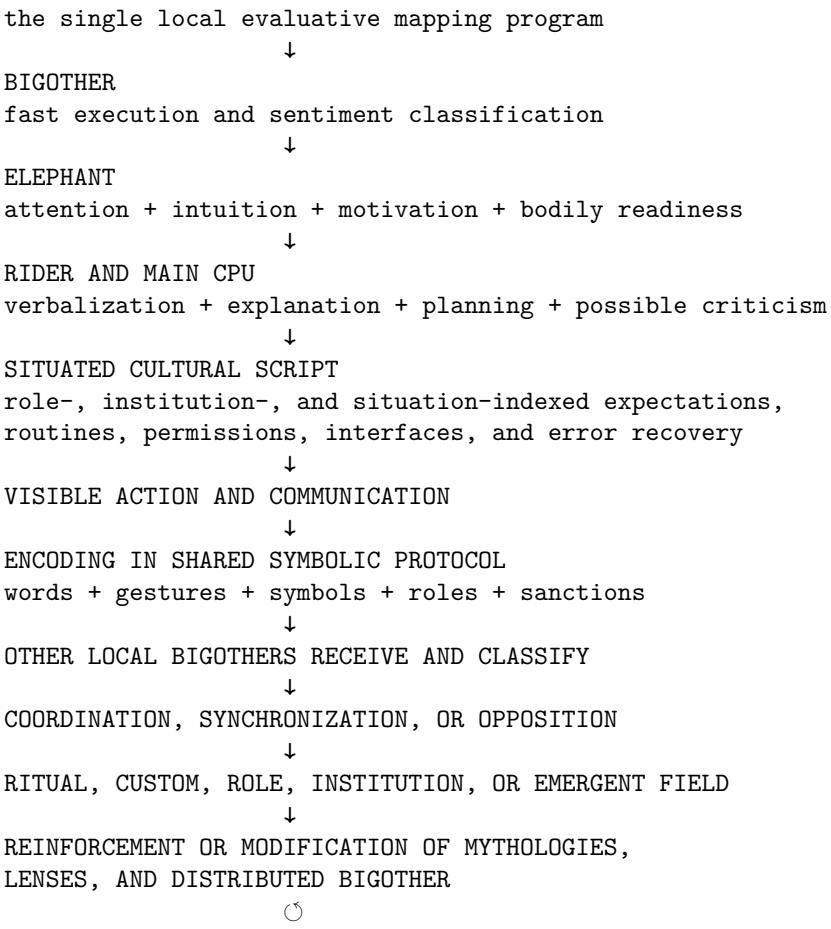
Culture mechanics calls attention to both directions:

1. society programs the local bigOther; and
2. locally classified action reproduces or transforms society.

14. The full culture-mechanical cycle

The complete process can be summarized as follows:

```
SLOW CULTURAL FORMATION AND PROGRAMMING
endogenous formation and/or attempted purposive construction
stories + symbols + systems + rituals
+ leadership + rewards + sanctions + experience
                    ↓
MYTHOLOGIES
individual socially evaluated stories
                    ↓
MYTHOLOGICAL LENS
```



The diagram makes the individual-to-field handoff visible without yet displaying all later consequences, sensing paths, retained history, or institutional changes. *Epistemic Agency under Mechanical Solidarity* owns the detailed account of how the emergent field acts back upon judgment, distributes authority, and supports or suppresses epistemic agency. The following propagator model joins that back-action to the other cross-scale transitions without collapsing their distinct semantic homes.

Culture propagator and dynamic evolution The **culture propagator** is the scale-declared, history-bearing state-transition operator that maps a cultural configuration into later possible configurations through the coupled evolution of operative representations, persons, emergent collective fields, institutional carrying structures, worldly consequences, sensing and correction architectures, and retained memory.

Propagator does not here mean only the propagation of a message or the recruitment of additional carriers. Propagation is one process inside the wider transition relation, alongside correction, reproduction, institutionalization, decay, fission, recovery, and replacement. Deliberate adversarial steering is one possible forcing regime, not the definition of the propagator.

Let the typed cultural state at a declared scale be:

$$z_t = (r_t, p_t, d_t, k_t, w_t, s_t, m_t).$$

Symbol	Cultural-mechanical meaning
r_t	Socially operative representations: classifications, causal accounts, expectations, legitimacy assignments, person-types, threats, duties, and possible futures
p_t	Person-level configurations: installed lenses, interpretation, judgment, relationships, dispositions, conduct, refusal, and correction across the relevant participants

Symbol	Cultural-mechanical meaning
d_t	The emergent symbolic-affective field or distributed-bigOther configuration reproduced through reciprocal signalling, expectations, institutions, practices, stories, and artifacts
k_t	Institutional and carrying structure: roles, rules, appointments, resources, access, sanctions, archives, organizations, infrastructure, and succession
w_t	Relevant worldly conditions and consequences: material production, capabilities, burdens, injuries, opportunities, performance, externalities, and other resistant outcomes
s_t	Sensing and correction architecture: what can be noticed, sampled, classified, recorded, preserved, transmitted, compared, challenged, and admitted as correction
m_t	Retained history: learned expectations, records, reputations, embodied habits, institutional memory, sunk costs, damaged or strengthened relationships, and other path-dependent residues

Let y_t denote observations made available through the sensing architecture. Let θ_t denote slower or structurally privileged transition conditions, including authority topology, network structure, jurisdiction, interdependence, reproduction, trust routing, correction rules, and the distribution of coercive or material capability. Let u_t denote a specified input or intervention and ε_t disturbances and omitted influences.

The state–parameter distinction is scale-relative. A constitution may be treated as fixed during a short episode and as a slowly changing state variable over a century. An analysis must declare that choice rather than moving an inconvenient change silently into the background.

The typed scaffold is neutral among continuous, discrete, deterministic, stochastic, agent-based, network, and historical-process realizations. In a continuous-time model one may instead write:

$$\dot{z}(t) = \mathcal{F}\big(z(t), \theta(t), u(t), \varepsilon(t)\big).$$

That notation does not assert one known differential equation for culture. The model form must follow the declared question, scale, data, and causal resolution; the discrete equations below expose typed handoffs rather than claiming that cultural processes advance in synchronized steps.

In discrete-time shorthand, the general update is:

$$z_{t+1} = T_{\theta_t}(z_t; u_t, \varepsilon_t).$$

Where uncertainty is material, T or the two-time operator below maps the initial state into a distribution over possible later states rather than one predicted point. The corresponding component handoffs can be written:

$$p_{t+1} = F_p(p_t, r_t, d_t, k_t, w_t, m_t; \varepsilon_t^p, u_t^p),$$

$$d_{t+1} = F_d(d_t, p_{t+1}, r_t, k_t, m_t; \varepsilon_t^d, u_t^d),$$

$$k_{t+1} = F_k(k_t, p_{t+1}, d_{t+1}, r_t, w_t, m_t; \varepsilon_t^k, u_t^k),$$

$$w_{t+1} = F_w(w_t, p_{t+1}, d_{t+1}, k_{t+1}; \varepsilon_t^w, u_t^w),$$

$$s_{t+1} = F_s(s_t, k_{t+1}, p_{t+1}, d_{t+1}, r_t, m_t; \varepsilon_t^s, u_t^s),$$

$$y_{t+1} = H(w_{t+1}, p_{t+1}, d_{t+1}, k_{t+1}, s_{t+1}; \varepsilon_t^y),$$

$$r_{t+1} = F_r(r_t, p_{t+1}, d_{t+1}, k_{t+1}, y_{t+1}, m_t; \varepsilon_t^r, u_t^r),$$

$$m_{t+1} = F_m(m_t, z_t, z_{t+1}, y_{t+1}).$$

Structural conditions can themselves update:

$$\theta_{t+1} = F_\theta(\theta_t, k_{t+1}, d_{t+1}, r_{t+1}, w_{t+1}, m_{t+1}).$$

The displayed order makes causal handoffs inspectable; it is not a chronological dogma. Cultural systems are asynchronous, multi-speed, distributed, and delay-ridden. Institutions can act before most persons learn a classification, material consequences can arrive years after a decision, and an old archive can re-enter the loop after apparent cultural forgetting.

The presence of every typed component does not establish the displayed loop. Each proposed handoff requires its own temporal and causal support, and an applied analysis must preserve one-way movements where no return path has been shown. The equations are therefore a hypothesis grammar for reconstructing transitions, not evidence that every named component interacted in a completed circuit.

At programme level, the circulation of cultural authority follows these handoffs from represented good through interpretation, institutional conversion, formation, consequence, and return. Its fork between correction and self-authorization is an application of this canonical state-transition model, not a replacement for it or a presumption that every cultural movement is a threat.

For a sufficiently specified state and forcing history, the two-time propagator is:

$$z_{t_1} = \Phi_{t_1,t_0}^{\theta,u,\varepsilon}(z_{t_0}).$$

Its ordinary composition property,

$$\Phi_{t_2,t_0} = \Phi_{t_2,t_1} \circ \Phi_{t_1,t_0},$$

is legitimate only when the state at t_1 contains the memory needed to determine later movement and the relevant forcing schedule is specified. If apparently identical present states respond differently because of hidden history, the state description is incomplete. The repair is to restore the missing history to m_t, treat another slow variable as part of the state, or use a history-dependent operator over a trajectory segment. Failed point-state prediction can therefore indicate omitted memory, delayed feedback, or an incorrectly chosen quotient rather than random cultural irrationality.

The typed model preserves the framework's constitutive architecture. The local bigOther and main cognitive processor remain functionally distinct within persons; p_t is not a homogeneous population average. The field d_t is implemented through persons and material carriers but has relational organization and back-action that cannot be reconstructed from independently formed individual attitudes alone. Field coherence, synchrony, collective-self presentation, operative collective agency, and fusion remain separate thresholds. One operative mythological lens still occupies the single local slot; change in that lens is an unbraiding, rebraiding, or replacement process rather than runtime arbitration among several sovereign bigOthers.

The detailed person–field projection belongs to *Epistemic Agency under Mechanical Solidarity*. The consequence, sensing, and correction projection belongs to *Epistemic Constitution*. The trajectory family belongs to *Mythology Construction*, and Culture Program reproduction, identity, capture, and strategic forcing belong to *Culture Program Ecology*.

Question-relative quotient dynamics Different descriptions can encode the same relation for one inquiry while remaining importantly different for another. A quotient therefore removes only distinctions declared irrelevant to a specified question. Genealogy, programme identity, hazard, causal inheritance, and present response need not admit the same equivalence relation.

Three relations are especially easy to collapse and must remain distinct:

Equivalence	Meaning	Licensed inference
Syntactic or coordinate equivalence	Different expressions encode the same declared state.	The wording or coordinate difference may be removed from that representation.
Observational equivalence	The available sensing process does not currently distinguish two states.	The observation is underdetermining; causal identity does not follow.
Causal-dynamical equivalence	Substitution leaves the relevant successor relation invariant under matched conditions.	The distinction may be quotiented out of that specified dynamic model.

In a reflexive system, deployment can break an observational equivalence that held beforehand. Two classifications that fit the same present record can alter conduct, trust, institutions, or later sensing differently once they become operative. They are then dynamically active coordinates rather than harmless aliases.

Let $\pi : Z \to Z/\sim$ project states into a declared quotient. The transition rule descends to that quotient only if equivalent states have equivalent successors:

$$z \sim z' \Longrightarrow T(z) \sim T(z').$$

Equivalently, there must be a well-defined quotient transition $\bar{T}$ such that:

$$\pi \circ T = \bar{T} \circ \pi.$$

If the condition fails, the discarded distinction changes the modeled future. The analysis must restore the active variable or narrow its question rather than force the dynamics into the quotient. Current observational equivalence is not operational identity: a difference can become causally visible under stress, refusal, failure, emergency, defeat, or succession. The controlled mathematical mapping and its limits are given in *Analogical Models in Culture Mechanics*.

Forcing regimes and dynamic descriptors The propagator separates the transition architecture from the origin and purpose of an input:

Regime	Distinguishing condition
Ordinary endogenous evolution	The coupled system changes without a demonstrated directing intervention.
Exogenous shock	War, disaster, technology, migration, discovery, scarcity, or another event perturbs the state without being generated by the modeled cultural loop.
Declared reform or policy intervention	An actor openly attempts to change specified outcomes or transition rules.
Opportunistic exploitation	An actor recognizes an emerging loop and amplifies, selects, or redirects it.
Adversarial reflexive attractor steering	An actor deliberately targets representations, routing, institutions, sensors, or correction so that decentralized responses help induce a strategically useful transition.

Ordinary endogenous movement can include sincere moral conviction, commercial selection, bureaucratic simplification, reputational self-protection, institutional inertia, uneven harms, and competition for authority. Those

mechanisms can produce a dangerous trajectory without an adversary and remain serious rivals when deliberate steering is alleged. Steering denotes directional leverage, not exact control: an intervention can fail, decay, overshoot, strengthen a rival, or help create an unintended third regime.

Six non-scalar descriptors make different parts of a transition inspectable:

Descriptor	Governing question	Distinct function
Representational leverage	How much consequential change can an input reach through a classification, symbol, expectation, or trusted channel?	Input effectiveness
Reflexive gain	How strongly does a representation-induced response return to amplify, damp, or redirect the next response?	Feedback sign and amplification
Basin margin or transition proximity	How much displacement or structural change separates the present regime from another reproducible regime?	Susceptibility to transition
Sensor endogeneity	How much apparent evidence is elicited, selected, classified, or produced through the contested representation and response?	Dependence of observation on deployment
Correction independence	Can sufficiently independent persons and procedures expose error and alter operation without the tested custodian's permission?	Detection, adjudication, and reversal capacity
Hysteresis depth	What successor structure remains after the initiating input is removed, and what reconstruction would reversal require?	Persistence after transition

The descriptors do not form one universal risk score. Each requires a specified unit, period, interface, causal question, and observable counterpart. Additional case-specific descriptors can include field coupling, reproduction rate, succession robustness, jurisdictional congruence, interoperability, externality routing, material dependence, and bridge density.

The propagator is descriptive until a correction and normative relation is specified. A representation can be self-consistent, causally effective, stable, adaptive, and destructive. A programme can accurately learn how to dominate. The programme-level course-preserving-adaptation and resilience-inversion trajectory shows how operational adaptation can protect programme continuation while social and material renewal, correction, or succession capacity declines. Reality-answerability and preservation of the concrete person's standing are therefore independent constraints rather than outputs automatically supplied by dynamic stability.

The principal boundaries are:

1. no social wavefunction, universal potential landscape, conserved cultural energy, or established universal field equation is asserted;
2. persons remain reflexive nodes capable of interpretation, resistance, deception, defection, imitation, concealment, and reorganization;
3. no quotient is innocent by default;
4. self-consistency, stability, persistence, and causal efficacy do not establish truth, legitimacy, fit, or moral value;
5. transition does not imply progress;
6. distributed causation does not establish centralized design;
7. a transition mechanism does not identify an actor or transmit an initiator's intention to downstream participants;
8. failure to identify or prove an actor blocks the actor attribution but does not erase independently supported feedback, field, institutional, consequence, or persistence findings; and
9. the same causal, consequence, correction, quotient, and rival-explanation standards apply to preferred and opposed programmes without presuming equal power or effect.

15. Open and closed cultural programming

Culture mechanics is descriptive before it is normative. The same mechanisms can support an open society or a closed total community.

A **closed cultural program** forms a mythological lens that teaches the bigOther to reward:

- unanimity and obedience;
- one overriding identity;
- submission to a central authority;
- denunciation of deviants;
- conflation of factual truth with political loyalty;
- exclusion of competing institutions and sources;
- treatment of counterevidence as betrayal or pollution.

An **open cultural program** forms a mythological lens that teaches the bigOther to value second-order norms:

- every person possesses dignity;
- opponents remain legitimate members of society;
- disagreement is not automatically betrayal;
- respect for a person does not require agreement with every claim;
- evidence may correct belief;
- authority may be criticized;
- compromise can be honourable;
- multiple institutions and affiliations must remain independent;
- no person or institution may become the sole authorized voice of the bigOther.

On the single-slot model, pluralism does not mean having no shared programming or installing one independent evaluator for each affiliation. It means that one open weave can be a fully installed lifted meta-program whose shared generator admits different context-sensitive first-order outputs. Its concrete surface can vary without its authority being weaker or local: the binding sameness lies in the rules by which answers are generated, tested, applied, and revised. These rules are not a higher runtime judge ranking several bigOthers; generator and outputs form one weave. Detailed cases and boundary tests are developed in *Epistemic Agency under Mechanical Solidarity*. Pluralism as a reality-answerable Culture Strategy, and the distinction between Culture Strategy and Pure-Ideology Culture Program, are developed in *Culture Program Ecology*.

16. Autonomy, capture, and susceptibility

Culture mechanics does not define autonomy as the absence of a bigOther. Language, morality, identity, and social cooperation all require cultural formation. Nor is autonomy the installation of a second bigOther to overrule the first. The relevant question is whether the main processor can inspect and revise the one installed lens and the bigOther's classifications. Autonomy is therefore compatible with full capture: it names an operative weave whose binding rules protect the main processor's capacity to inspect and revise its classifications, not incomplete programming or escape from the slot.

In an autonomous configuration, a person can:

- distinguish affective certainty from evidence;
- notice shame, disgust, or group pressure as signals rather than proofs;
- compare inherited classifications with direct experience;
- tolerate disagreement and temporary dissonance;
- question the authority that supplied a classification;
- revise the mythological lens when its classifications contradict evidence or experience.

Every installed program governs classification, and a lifted program necessarily has meta-authority over first-order jurisdictions. **Pathological capture** begins not with governing authority as such but when the weave or its representatives become uncorrectable, monopolize authorized interpretation, exceed their constituted jurisdiction, or claim **epistemic sovereignty**—that reality must answer to authorization rather than authorization to reality. The bigOther then determines which perceptions, questions, relationships, and feelings the main CPU may treat as legitimate. Intelligence remains available, but is recruited to implement or defend the installed lens.

Full capture can integrate an already compatible package, but capture by an incompatible governing worldview requires replacement. Authorities, sanctions, rituals, relationships, and field back-action must loosen the incumbent weave's load-bearing bindings, make detachment or reinterpretation survivable, and help rebraid one successor.

Conversely, counter-relations and reality contact can protect or repair the incumbent weave without acting as a second evaluator. A rival successor is not pathological merely because it replaces an incumbent; its corrigibility and authority relations must be assessed independently.

Susceptibility to such capture is not treated as a single scalar trait. It can involve different degrees of:

- programmability through narratives and exemplars;
- sensitivity to approval, rejection, and unanimity;
- ease of synchronization with a group;
- identity dependence;
- affective charge and internalization;
- resistance to counterevidence;
- difficulty of reprogramming;
- practical ability to dissent or leave.

17. Synonyms and terminological neighbours of the bigOther

There is no established term that is an exact synonym for the **bigOther** as culture mechanics defines it. The term deliberately combines a local sentiment classifier, its culturally learned programming, its relation to the symbolic order, and its capacity for distributed synchronization. Existing concepts usually name only one of these aspects.

The closest everyday term is **conscience** (*Gewissen*), provided that it is understood as an affectively active moral evaluator rather than as a little rational judge inside the mind. Conscience marks conduct and even contemplated conduct with approval, guilt, shame, obligation, or prohibition. In that respect it performs part of the bigOther's sentiment-classification function.

Conscience is nevertheless narrower than the bigOther. The bigOther also classifies status, belonging, legitimacy, loyalty, sacredness, pollution, identity, and social danger, including cases that are not ordinarily described as matters of conscience. Conversely, conscience can include deliberate moral reflection performed by the main CPU, whereas the bigOther refers specifically to the fast culturally programmed evaluator that influences such reflection. Culture mechanics can therefore distinguish a **socially authored conscience**, whose judgments are largely supplied by the surrounding field, from a more **self-authored conscience**, whose inherited classifications can be examined and deliberately endorsed, rejected, or revised.

Neighbouring term	Main overlap with the bigOther	Important difference
Lacan's big Other	The prior symbolic order of language, law, roles, authority, and socially intelligible meaning; functionally, the shared protocol through which local states become publicly legible.	It is the source term, but Lacan did not describe a literal local co-processor, PCI card, or the full on-the-wire analogy. Culture mechanics adds that implementation and translation.
James's felt objective presence	A reality or unseen order may be experienced as objectively present and conduct-directing.	It illuminates **bigOther-presence** phenomenologically but does not specify its local processor, cultural program, or network mechanism.
Buber's I–Thou relation	Another is encountered in a second-person relational mode rather than as an object.	It illuminates **bigOther-as-Thou** but must not be reduced to social programming; Buber's eternal Thou is not the culture-mechanical bigOther.
Conscience / Gewissen	Internal moral approval, guilt, shame, obligation, and prohibition.	It is the closest ordinary-language partial synonym, but is narrower than the bigOther and can also include reflective moral judgment by the CPU.
Superego	Internalized authority, prohibitions, ideals, guilt, and demands placed upon the self.	It emphasizes a psychoanalytic intrapsychic agency, often especially its punitive aspect; it does not by itself denote the full symbolic network or distributed computation.

Neighbouring term	Main overlap with the bigOther	Important difference
Generalized other	George Herbert Mead's organized attitudes and expectations of a community that a person learns to take toward the self.	It closely describes the social standpoint represented locally, but not the proposed dual-processor architecture or its primitive affective interface.
Collective conscience / collective consciousness	Durkheim's shared beliefs and sentiments, with their moral authority over group members.	It is closest to the distributed bigOther; it does not isolate the local sentiment-classification unit through which collective sentiments become personally operative.
Internalized norms, moral schemas, and moral identity	Learned evaluative rules, expectations, and identity commitments.	These are components of the mythological lens executed by the bigOther rather than names for the processor, the narrative corpus, and the network together.
Habitus	Social history embodied as durable perception, feeling, and action dispositions.	It is broader than moral-social classification and does not posit a single-slot evaluator or a separate general-purpose CPU.
Socialized mind and **ego development**	Describe developmental relations to social expectations, internal standards, and one's own meaning-making system.	They describe organizations or levels of the whole person, not an additional processor. They are developmental neighbours of the bigOther, not synonyms for it.

The vocabulary should therefore be used with the following rule:

> **Conscience, superego, generalized other, collective conscience, felt objective presence, and I–Thou relation each illuminate an aspect of the bigOther; none alone names the complete culture-mechanical construct.**

18. Development of the bigOther: Kegan and Loevinger

Culture mechanics treats the bigOther as developmentally variable. A person is not born with a completed mythological lens. Social evaluation is first encountered through attachment, imitation, direct reward and punishment, and dependence on caregivers. It is then internalized as group-authored conscience and may later become available for self-authorship and reflective revision.

Robert Kegan's constructive-developmental theory and Jane Loevinger's ego-development research provide the closest developmental models found in the surrounding conversations, but neither proposed a bigOther. Kegan's subject-object theory describes increasingly complex **forms of mind** or **meaning-making**, not merely moral conscience. Loevinger's theory describes development of the **ego** across impulse control, character, interpersonal understanding, conscious preoccupations, and moral evaluation. The culture-mechanical model below is consequently a synthesis and translation, not a claim that either theorist described the wireless collar.

The key developmental question is:

> **Is the mythological lens something the person can look at and revise, or is it the unquestioned lens through which the person looks?**

This is Kegan's subject-object distinction applied specifically to cultural sentiment classification. What remains **subject** to a person has the person: it organizes experience but cannot yet be examined as an object. What becomes **object** can be noticed, compared, evaluated, and acted upon. Development of the bigOther therefore does not primarily mean that the collar becomes stronger. It means that the homo-duplex system gains a more complex and reflective relation to the lens stored in the collar.

Epistemic Agency under Mechanical Solidarity operationalizes this movement by distinguishing reason as **press secretary**, **interpreter**, and **auditor**. Making a classification and its provenance visible is the interpretive step; testing its framing, authority, jurisdiction, evidence, consequence, and corrigibility is the further audit. Articulate reasons alone do not establish that the main CPU authored the verdict.

A four-phase culture-mechanical model

Culture-mechanical phase	Closest Keganian neighbour	Closest Loevingerian neighbour	Relation to the bigOther
1. Installation and external regulation	Impulsive and instrumental forms of mind	Impulsive and Self-Protective stages	Social control is experienced mainly through immediate attachment, advantage, reward, retaliation, and punishment. A stable moral-social lens is still being installed; much of its authority remains visibly outside the person.
2. Socially authored bigOther	Socialized Mind	Conformist and transitional Self-Aware levels	Group expectations, authorities, relationships, and accepted roles become internally binding. The person can subordinate impulse to shared rules, but has difficulty standing apart from the social field that defines what ought to feel admirable, shameful, loyal, or forbidden. Borrowed judgment is experienced as one's own obvious conscience.
3. Self-authored bigOther	Self-Authoring Mind	Conscientious stage	The person constructs an internal code and can use it to evaluate competing external demands. The main CPU can identify, endorse, and deliberately revise at least some mappings in the installed lens. The bigOther remains present, but its lens is increasingly governed from within rather than continuously authored by the current group.
4. Self-transforming bigOther	Self-Transforming Mind	Individualistic transition, Autonomous stage, and the rare Integrated stage	The person can take even a self-authored value system as object, recognize its partial and constructed character, tolerate conflicts among frameworks, and revise the meta-rules by which classifications are made. The lens can include its own corrigibility without dissolving all commitments.

These are correspondences, not one-to-one equations. In particular, Loevinger's **Conscientious** stage is not simply

"having a conscience"; it is a comparatively developed organization characterized by self-evaluated standards, responsibility, long-term goals, and evaluation of rules rather than mere acceptance of group rules. Her **Individualistic** level is a transition from Conscientious to Autonomous, and the Autonomous and Integrated levels add tolerance of inner conflict, ambiguity, interdependence, and increasingly integrated identity. Kegan describes a related shift in different terms: from being authored by relationships and the surrounding culture, to authoring an internal system, to being able to inspect the limitations of that system itself.

Development under the single-slot principle Development does not install additional bigOthers beside the first one. The computer still has one PCI slot, one operative sentiment-classification architecture, and therefore one fully occupied slot. What changes is the person's relation to the installed card and, during lifting, the order of the rules it runs:

```
EXTERNALLY ENFORCED LENS
the environment supplies immediate reward and punishment
                    ↓
SOCIALLY AUTHORED LENS
the group's judgments operate internally as obvious conscience
                    ↓
SELF-AUTHORED LENS
the person can evaluate social demands through an internal code
                    ↓
SELF-TRANSFORMING LENS
the person can inspect and revise even the code and its meta-rules
```

A self-transforming person can represent several moral systems in the main CPU, translate between them, and understand each from within. This does not require several PCI cards running independently or a higher evaluator that ranks them at runtime. Until reconstruction occurs, one local bigOther still executes one operative lens. The developmental achievement is that the person can treat this present lens as partial, corrigible, and open to deliberate repair, compatible extension, unbraiding, or replacement.

Self-transformation can therefore unbraid a first-order program whose concrete answers are treated as final and rebraid one lifted program in which binding meta-rules generate, select, apply, and revise concrete answers. First-order religious, professional, familial, political, or local packages need not vanish; their particular rules and conclusions remain within the successor weave as outputs or bounded packages answerable to its generator. This is full lifted capture, not a neutral evaluator standing above culture.

Nor does greater autonomy require disconnection from distributed computing. The socially authored person is especially liable to be synchronized by whichever reference group carries authority. The self-authoring person can choose commitments and networks from an internal standpoint. The self-transforming person can participate in collective life without assuming that any single network exhausts reality, and can sometimes translate between networks without simply fusing with either one.

The "less than 1%" claim The recollection that the most developed Keganian form occurs in fewer than one percent of adults is supported, with an attribution caveat. A peer-reviewed account by Lars Bauger, Rob Bongaardt, and Jack J. Bauer reports that, **according to Kegan and Lahey (2009)**, approximately 80–90% of adults make meaning between the Socialized and Self-Authoring levels, while the Self-Transforming Mind is "seldom seen (less than 1%)." The estimate is therefore appropriately attributed to **Kegan and Lahey's framework**, while the directly checkable wording appears in Bauger, Bongaardt, and Bauer's 2021 article.

This figure should be treated as a reported developmental estimate, not as a population census, a biological constant, or a direct measurement of the bigOther. It concerns Kegan's highest whole-person meaning-making structure. Culture mechanics translates that structure into the capacity to take one's own mythological lens as object; it does not claim that Kegan measured a collar processor or that exactly the same percentage applies across all societies and methods.

Developmental cautions Developmental complexity is not identical to intelligence, factual correctness, kindness, mental health, or moral worth. A powerful CPU does not guarantee a self-authored relation to the bigOther. Conversely, a self-authored person can construct and defend a cruel or epistemically contaminated code. Development describes increasing capacity to author and inspect a framework; the content and consequences of that framework must still be evaluated independently.

The highest phase should also not be understood as the disappearance of conscience. Its defining feature is **reflective ownership without finalization**: the person can retain commitments, feel moral sentiments, and participate in a culture while knowing that the framework producing those classifications is neither infallible nor complete.

19. Cross-references to closely related concepts

The following concepts overlap with parts of culture mechanics without being synonyms for the theory as a whole.

Affect Control Theory and BayesACT **Affect Control Theory** (ACT) and its probabilistic extension **BayesACT** provide a formal computational neighbour to the culture-mechanical account of the mythological lens. ACT models culturally learned affective meanings—called **fundamental sentiments**—attached to identities, actions, and settings. An observed social event produces a **transient impression**, which is compared with these culturally expected meanings. The resulting discrepancy is called **deflection**. Deflection generates pressure toward emotion, reinterpretation, identity adjustment, or corrective action that restores affective consistency.

The correspondence is:

Culture mechanics	ACT/BayesACT
Mythological lens	Culturally learned fundamental sentiments and impression-formation rules.
Real-world observation or event	An observed actor–behaviour–object event producing a transient impression.
bigOther classification	Comparison of the transient meaning with culturally expected meaning.
Affective signal	Confirmation or deflection—the discrepancy between expected and observed meaning.
Resulting response	Emotion, reinterpretation, identity adjustment, or corrective action.

BayesACT adds uncertain beliefs about identities and situations, Bayesian updating, explicit goals, and decision-theoretic action selection. In culture-mechanical terms, it offers one possible formalization of how an installed cultural mapping could combine with an observation to produce affective confirmation or error and consequent pressure on feeling and action:

```
culturally learned affective expectations
                  +
         observed social event
                  ↓
     affective comparison or inference
                  ↓
         confirmation or deflection
                  ↓
       feeling and pressure to respond
```

This is a cross-reference rather than a foundation of culture mechanics. ACT and BayesACT do not propose a separate bigOther, a single PCI slot, mythological narrative programming, or distributed synchronization. They also do not explain how mythologies initially form the mythological lens. BayesACT's instrumental action selection extends beyond the primitive sentiment-classification function assigned to the collar and overlaps with planning functions that culture mechanics assigns to the main CPU.

BayesACT should not be conflated with the project's separate **auxiliary-un-reality explaining-away cascade**. That construct borrows the form of Bayesian *explaining away* as a diagnostic contrast: independently evidenced alternative causes belong to legitimate model revision, whereas the project-labelled counterfeit form treats an authorized auxiliary account as if authorization were causal evidence and uses it to protect an operative un-real representation. The social system need not calculate an explicit probability, and neither Bayesian inference nor BayesACT is thereby classified as un-reason.

Stanovich's rationality framework Keith E. Stanovich, Richard F. West, and Maggie E. Toplak distinguish rationality from intelligence and describe cognition with a **tripartite model**:

- The **autonomous mind** produces rapid, automatic, highly practised, or evolutionarily prepared responses.
- The **algorithmic mind** supplies computational capacity for sustained processing, inhibition, and cognitive simulation. Conventional intelligence tests primarily track capacities at this level.
- The **reflective mind** concerns goals, epistemic values, thinking dispositions, and the decision to initiate reflective processing or override a default response.

This tripartite division should not be mapped one-to-one onto homo duplex. In culture mechanics, all three Stanovichian minds describe operations performed within the ordinary brain—the main cognitive system represented by the CPU, elephant, and rider. The bigOther is an additional functional distinction: a culturally programmable sentiment classifier coupled to that system.

The most faithful architectural mapping is:

Stanovichian term	Function in Stanovich's model	Closest culture-mechanical location
Autonomous mind	Generates fast default responses	Part of the main brain and especially the elephant; it is influenced by, but is not identical to, the bigOther.
Algorithmic mind	Supplies computational power, decoupling, inhibition, and simulation	The processing power of the main CPU.
Reflective mind	Establishes goals and epistemic dispositions and initiates override	The governing and self-corrective activity of the main CPU, represented partly by the rider.
Mindware	Provides learned knowledge, rules, procedures, and strategies for reasoning	General acquired programming available to the main CPU; mythologies may carry mindware, while their culturally evaluative lessons can be compiled into the bigOther's mythological lens.

This prevents two misleading equations:

> The autonomous mind is **not** the bigOther.
> Mindware in general is **neither a mythology nor the mythological lens**.

Probability theory, falsification, causal reasoning, and decision rules are mindware used by the main CPU without necessarily belonging to the bigOther. A mythology is a culturally evaluated story and may carry many kinds of mindware. The mythological lens is narrower than mindware in general: it is the mapping distilled from many mythologies that organizes social identity and sentiment classification.

Mindware gaps and other rationality failures A **mindware gap** exists when a person lacks a learned rule or body of knowledge required for rational judgment. Someone may possess ample algorithmic capacity but not understand base rates, regression to the mean, falsification, or probabilistic reasoning. In culture-mechanical language, the main CPU is powerful enough, but lacks the corrective program needed to evaluate or override a default response.

Stanovich's taxonomy separates this from several other failures:

Failure	Stanovichian description	Culture-mechanical translation
Cognitive miserliness	Reflective processing is not initiated; an easy default is accepted.	The CPU does not spend the effort needed to inspect the elephant's response or the collar's classification.
Override failure	Reflective processing begins and relevant mindware exists, but the default response is not successfully suppressed.	The CPU detects a problem but fails to overcome the elephant's or bigOther's strongly weighted response.

Failure	Stanovichian description	Culture-mechanical translation
Mindware gap	The alternative knowledge or rule needed for a rational response is absent or insufficiently learned.	The CPU lacks the epistemic tool needed to correct the response.
Contaminated mindware	Acquired mindware itself causes irrational belief or action.	In the culture-mechanical use developed here, the bigOther executes a defective lens that generates misdirecting sentiments and protects its mappings from evaluation.

These failures can combine. A contaminated bigOther may discourage the reflective mind from initiating inspection, make affective override more difficult, and prevent missing corrective mindware from being learned.

Contaminated mindware as a badly programmed bigOther In Stanovich's framework, **contaminated mindware** is acquired mindware that directly causes irrational belief or action—either by reducing epistemic accuracy or by thwarting effective goal pursuit. It can include superstitious thinking, antiscience attitudes, conspiracy beliefs, dysfunctional personal beliefs, misleading causal models, and culturally conditioned misinformation.

Stanovich gives special attention to mindware containing **evaluation-disabling properties**. Such mindware keeps itself lodged in a host by attaching punishment to questioning, rewarding unquestioning acceptance, or making itself unfalsifiable. This aspect provides the strongest direct bridge to culture mechanics because punishment, reward, and protected sacredness are operations of the bigOther's sentiment-classification system.

Following the present theory's guidance, culture mechanics adopts the term in this more specific functional sense:

> **Contaminated mindware is a badly programmed bigOther: contaminated mythologies have shaped a defective mythological lens whose classifications attach strong sentiments to thoughts and evidence in ways that systematically misguide the main CPU.**

The defective lens may mark:

- a false claim as sacred truth;
- honest doubt as betrayal;
- reliable evidence as enemy contamination;
- asymmetric scrutiny as moral vigilance;
- cruelty as righteous duty;
- correction as humiliation or surrender;
- loyalty to a source as a substitute for evaluating its claims.

The contamination lies in both **content** and **control**. Individual mythologies can carry misleading claims, roles, causal explanations, or anti-evaluation procedures. Repetition compiles those lessons into a defective lens, while the bigOther executes the lens and thereby determines how entertaining, questioning, revising, or rejecting them feels. Pride, shame, sacredness, belonging, authority, disgust, fear, and anticipated punishment protect the defective lens.

The resulting causal sequence is:

```
CONTAMINATED BIGOTHER PROGRAMMING
misleading mythologies + evaluation-disabling procedures
                    ↓
DEFECTIVE MYTHOLOGICAL LENS
misdirected mappings from observations to values and feelings
                    ↓
STRONG AFFECTIVE MISCLASSIFICATION
false feels sacred, doubt feels disloyal,
harm feels righteous, correction feels shameful
                    ↓
REFLECTIVE INHIBITION OR FAILED OVERRIDE
the CPU does not inspect, cannot overcome, or lacks corrective mindware
                    ↓
```

```
MOTIVATED OR MYSIDE REASONING
selective search, asymmetric scrutiny, rationalization, and defence
                    ↓
IRRATIONAL BELIEF OR ACTION
reduced epistemic accuracy or frustrated goal attainment
```

The phrase "wrong direction" should be tied to Stanovich's standards of rationality rather than merely to disagreement with an observer. A bigOther is contaminated when its lens systematically impairs:

- **epistemic rationality:** forming beliefs that are appropriately calibrated to evidence and reality; or
- **instrumental rationality:** acting effectively in pursuit of the person's considered goals.

Political, religious, or moral disagreement alone is not evidence of contaminated mindware. The diagnosis requires such features as demonstrable epistemic failure, goal-thwarting consequences, asymmetric standards, or procedures that disable evaluation.

The extension and its boundary The synchronization can now be stated precisely:

- **Stanovich supplies the cognitive pathology:** harmful acquired knowledge and strategies can cause irrationality even when computational intelligence is adequate.
- **Culture mechanics assigns that pathology a location in its dual architecture:** when contaminated mindware is cultural, identity-laden, and affectively enforced, it becomes part of a defective mythological lens executed by the bigOther.
- **Culture mechanics adds a causal interface:** the contaminated bigOther misguides the main CPU by attaching strong feelings to its thoughts and possible conclusions.
- **Culture mechanics adds a distributed mechanism:** networked bigOthers reward, punish, repeat, and synchronize contaminated mythologies and lens mappings across people.
- **Motivated or myside reasoning is usually downstream:** the main CPU is recruited to protect the direction already weighted by the bigOther.

This is a faithful extension, not a claim that Stanovich proposed a bigOther, a wireless collar, homo duplex, or distributed cultural computation. His category is broader: contaminated mindware need not always be socially synchronized or strongly affective. Culture mechanics deliberately concentrates on the subset for which the acquired contamination has entered the mythological lens of the sentiment classifier.

Conversely, not every mythology produces contaminated mindware, and no single story normally determines an entire lens. Mythologies can instead teach intellectual honesty, falsifiability, evidential symmetry, uncertainty, and willingness to revise. An open culture can thereby form a lens that makes reality-oriented conduct feel honourable and correction tolerable rather than misdirecting the CPU away from them.

Dysrationalia **Dysrationalia** is Stanovich's term for irrational thought or behaviour despite adequate intelligence. It is closely related to the homo-duplex thesis because it rejects the assumption that a powerful main CPU guarantees rational judgment.

Culture mechanics proposes one possible social-affective pathway to dysrationalia: the bigOther can set priorities, prohibit questions, or make accurate revision socially painful while leaving general intelligence intact. Dysrationalia is nevertheless broader. It can also result from mindware gaps, cognitive miserliness, poor thinking dispositions, or failures to initiate reflective processing.

Motivated reasoning **Motivated reasoning** is the tendency for desired conclusions, identities, loyalties, or emotional needs to influence how evidence is sought, interpreted, remembered, and evaluated.

In culture mechanics, motivated reasoning is not itself the bigOther. It is what the main CPU may do after the bigOther has marked one conclusion as honourable, safe, identity-preserving, or socially rewarded and another as shameful, dangerous, or disloyal. The CPU's power can then increase the sophistication of the rationalization rather than correct its direction.

Not every instance of reasoning from one's existing perspective is irrational. Prior beliefs may deserve evidential weight, and revising an established model has real cognitive costs. The culture-mechanical concern is the narrower case in which the bigOther enforces asymmetric or evaluation-disabling treatment of evidence and thereby reduces epistemic or instrumental rationality.

When that directional use becomes recursively organized so that concepts, premises, burdens, exceptions, and even criticism are made to protect the installed verdict from possible defeat, *Epistemic Constitution* calls the mechanism **un-reason**. It explains how the main processor's sophistication can strengthen capture through reasoning itself. Motivated reasoning is one possible contributor; un-reason is the wider cross-scale organization and does not follow from intelligence, disagreement, or one error.

Identity-protective cognition **Identity-protective cognition** is motivated reasoning specifically directed toward protecting membership, status, or alignment within an identity-defining group. It is one of the closest empirical neighbours of the wireless-collar model.

The bigOther supplies an internalized audience and asks, in effect:

> What would accepting this evidence say about who I am, whose side I am on, and whether I still belong?

The person may consequently reject an accurate conclusion not because it exceeds the main CPU's capacity, but because accepting it would trigger shame, loss of status, or symbolic expulsion.

Moral conviction, sacred values, and taboo trade-offs **Moral conviction** occurs when a preference or belief is experienced as a matter of fundamental right and wrong rather than negotiable interest. A **sacred value** is protected from ordinary comparison or exchange. A **taboo trade-off** is a comparison whose mere consideration is treated as morally offensive.

These concepts describe classifications produced by the bigOther when it assigns exceptional moral authority to an object or rule. They help explain why compromise can feel like corruption and why cost-benefit reasoning can provoke outrage rather than deliberation. They also distinguish an ordinary strong preference from programming that determines what the main CPU is permitted even to compare.

Actively open-minded thinking and epistemic autonomy **Actively open-minded thinking** is the disposition to search for reasons one may be wrong, consider alternatives, apply standards symmetrically, and revise beliefs in response to evidence. It is a form of healthy mindware and a partial operational counterpart to what culture mechanics calls **epistemic autonomy**.

Epistemic autonomy does not require the absence of a bigOther. It requires a mythological lens that permits the main CPU to inspect the bigOther's outputs and that does not convert doubt, correction, or uncertainty automatically into shame and betrayal.

Actively open-minded thinking predicts resistance to many reasoning errors and forms of contaminated mindware, but it should not be treated as a universal antidote. Stanovich's work finds myside bias unusually resistant to prediction by intelligence and, in several paradigms, by actively open-minded-thinking measures themselves.

Master signifiers In Lacanian terminology, a **master signifier** is a privileged signifier that organizes other meanings and identifications. Words such as *Nation*, *Justice*, *Science*, *Tradition*, *Safety*, *Freedom*, or *Revolution* can function in this way.

A master signifier is not inherently contaminated. It becomes a carrier of contaminated mindware when invoking it terminates evaluation rather than organizing an inquiry—for example, when "Science" changes from the name of a corrigible method into an authority token that makes further judgment impermissible.

In the wireless-collar and protocol analogies, a master signifier is a **highly compressed protocol token**. It indexes a large package of already installed mythologies, classifications, authorities, identities, sentiments, and expected conduct without restating them. This explains both its efficiency and its danger: participants can coordinate through a short token, but the expansion it activates may remain unspoken and therefore difficult to inspect.

Master-signifier analysis grid

> **A master signifier should be analysed by what it sacralizes, who bears it, how it unifies, what it authorizes, and what happens to the outlier—not merely by its dictionary meaning.**

The **master-signifier analysis grid** is a project-developed decompression method. The assistant synthesized the grid from the Humanism–Diversity discussion; the project author then selected it for theory integration. It compares the operative structures activated by a signifier without turning those structures into one scalar judgment:

Field	Diagnostic question
Token family	Which word, capitalization, slogan, symbol, negation, and neighbouring terms select the same installed complex?
Sacred referent	Which person, relation, collective, abstraction, pattern, process, condition, or future, if any, is placed beyond ordinary trade-off?
Bearer	Who or what, if anything, is said to instantiate, represent, carry, embody, or transmit the sacred referent?
Protected principal	Whose or what interests, standing, continuity, or development, if any, finally select action when goods conflict?
Unity topology	Does the signifier join persons directly through a common standing, mediate membership through groups, federate differentiated forms, or impose one higher-order content upon them?
Difference operator	Which distinctions are ignored, protected, amplified, administered, ranked, corrected, or treated as suspect?
Distributive grammar	What is allocated—standing, liberty, voice, office, recognition, burden, remedy, resources, reward, opportunity, or outcome—and by which rule: equality, contribution, need, injury, category, parity, or another principle?
Causal story	Which condition becomes a problem, who or what caused it, who is harmed or blamed, and which fixer and remedy follow?
Interpreter custody	Who defines the term, its bearers, categories, indicators, exceptions, conflicts, and legitimate application? Can rival interpretations defeat the custodian's account?
Authorization and jurisdiction	Which power, objects, domain, duration, discretion, sanction, and epistemic authority does invocation support?
Outlier performance	What happens to the difficult case—the infant, dependant, dissenter, noncontributor, mixed or unclassified person, statistical minority, failed exemplar, or person whose concrete interest conflicts with the aggregate or pattern?
Realization stack	How does the signifier operate semantically, affectively, behaviourally, institutionally, and materially rather than only propositionally?
Completion	What observable condition permits the demand, correction, emergency, or programme to count as complete?
Correction	Which evidence, consequence, appeal, refusal, succession, or external reality check can revise the interpretation and authorization?
Trajectory	Across time, does the complex build and transmit finite goods, stabilize bounded maintenance, renew its own demand, displace its principal, or consume its carriers and containing order?

Outlier performance is not a licence to stigmatize unusual persons. It is a stress test of what the signifier actually protects when its easiest representative case is unavailable. **Distributive grammar** likewise does not presume that one rule fits every object: equal moral standing, contribution-sensitive reward, need-based aid, compensation for a demonstrated injury, and role-specific authority answer different questions.

The grid is neither a new constitutional orientation nor a diagnostic score. Some master signifiers organize knowledge or coordination without one sacred referent, bearer, or protected principal; the grid records that absence rather

than manufacturing one. Several fields deliberately cross-reference independent theory components: causal stories and authorization payloads, subjecthood absorption, truth and drive orientations, Culture Program jurisdiction, and service direction. A field should be retained only if comparative application changes or sharpens the analysis. A master signifier remains capable of healthy compression when its referent, custody, authorization, boundaries, completion, and correction can be made explicit and contested and when the formation path needed to reconstruct its reasons, limits, and application remains practically reopenable.

When *Science*, *Safety*, *biodiversity*, *risk*, or another master signifier compresses a model-mediated authorization, the grid should be paired with the **model-to-mandate custody chain**. That chain does not add another grid axis. It decompresses the existing causal story, interpreter custody, authorization, completion, and correction fields into observation, metric, model, conditional forecast, harm translation, protected-principal valuation, severity threshold, remedy comparison, mandate, and outcome audit. A valid early stage may coexist with an invalid later crossing, and a disputed mandate does not by itself falsify the underlying observation or model.

Bonhoeffer's Dummheit Dietrich Bonhoeffer's 1943 reflection "Von der Dummheit" (PDF of the complete section) is the starting point of the culture-mechanics theory. It posed the originating questions: **What causes this *Dummheit*? How does it work?**

The German original reads:

> Jede starke äußere Machtentfaltung, sei sie politischer oder religiöser Art, schlägt einen großen Teil der Menschen mit Dummheit. Ja, es hat den Anschein, als sei das geradezu ein soziologisch-psychologisches Gesetz. Die Macht der einen braucht die Dummheit der anderen. Der Vorgang ist dabei nicht der, dass bestimmte – also etwa intellektuelle – Anlagen des Menschen plötzlich verkümmern oder ausfallen, sondern dass unter dem überwältigenden Eindruck der Machtentfaltung dem Menschen seine innere Selbständigkeit geraubt wird und dass dieser nun – mehr oder weniger unbewusst – darauf verzichtet, zu den sich ergebenden Lebenslagen ein eigenes Verhalten zu finden. Dass der Dumme oft bockig ist, darf nicht darüber hinwegtäuschen, dass er nicht selbständig ist. **Man spürt es geradezu im Gespräch mit ihm, dass man es gar nicht mit ihm selbst, mit ihm persönlich, sondern mit über ihn mächtig gewordenen Schlagworten, Parolen etc. zu tun hat. Er ist in einem Bann, er ist verblendet, er ist in seinem eigenen Wesen missbraucht, misshandelt.** So zum willenlosen Instrument geworden, wird der Dumme auch zu allem Bösen fähig sein und zugleich unfähig, dies als Böses zu erkennen. Hier liegt die Gefahr eines diabolischen Missbrauchs.

The English translation used here is:

> Every powerful display of external force, whether political or religious, strikes a large portion of people with stupidity. Indeed, it appears to be almost a sociological-psychological law: the power of the few needs the stupidity of the many. The process does not consist of certain intellectual faculties suddenly withering. Rather, under the overwhelming impression of power, people are robbed of their inner independence and - more or less unconsciously - give up forming their own judgments about the situations that arise. The fact that the stupid person is often obstinate should not hide the reality that he is not acting autonomously. **In conversation one senses that one is not dealing with the person himself but with slogans and catch-phrases that have gained mastery over him. He is under a spell, blinded, his very being abused and misused.** Having become a will-less instrument, the stupid person is capable of any evil and at the same time incapable of recognizing it as evil. Here lies the danger of a diabolical misuse.

This is not a claim about low intelligence. Bonhoeffer describes a socially induced loss of inner independence in which external power, slogans, and formulas speak through a person whose ordinary intellectual abilities remain available. His *Dummheit* is therefore broader and more political than contaminated mindware.

Bonhoeffer names the phenomenon; culture mechanics proposes a mechanism. At the individual level, an intelligent person's main CPU can remain capable while the bigOther supplies the classifications, slogans, sentiments, and permissions under which that intelligence operates. *Epistemic Agency under Mechanical Solidarity* develops the social-field account: mutually synchronized local bigOthers and institutional power can make borrowed judgment feel internally compulsory and thereby weaken the person's capacity to form an independent response.

The finer ideological-power scale bridge distinguishes the internalized observer from the person's own capacity for inward seeing. An approaching culturally forbidden relation may become difficult to hold, formulate, or name before an authorized slogan occupies the resulting conceptual vacancy. The compact distinction is:

Blindness is the negative moment: what the person can no longer see, formulate, or name. *Dummheit* is the positive occupation of that vacancy: authorized formulas speak and judge in the person's place.

Weak inattention or one blind spot is not yet *Dummheit*. The stronger candidate mechanism requires inhibited self-authored articulation and predictable replacement by authorized classification in the activated domain; wider claims require evidence of domain spread, synchronization, conduct, enforcement, and persistence.

Bonhoeffer's distinction between ***Belehrung*** and ***Befreiung*** adds a correction boundary that the mechanism must preserve. He argues that the condition cannot normally be overcome by instruction alone and that genuine inner liberation often becomes possible only after external liberation has preceded it. Culture Mechanics translates that claim structurally rather than clinically: supplying a better proposition to the rider may leave the social penalties, trusted routing, apparent unanimity, repeated slogans, and affective reinforcement that continually regenerate the protected classification unchanged. Liberation in this bounded sense reopens the conditions under which a person can sustain their own questions, remain with anomalous experience, encounter plural sources, and form an insight; it does not predetermine which answer they must reach.

This also requires two recovery clocks. Public rules, permissible speech, authoritative channels, and visible conduct can change faster than the person's accumulated affective and semantic organization. The postwar OMGUS attitude series is a bounded illustration: after the Nazi state's defeat, approximately half of respondents in the American occupation zone still described National Socialism as a good idea badly carried out, with the reported figure reaching 55 percent in August 1947. Samuel Clowes Huneke's "The Democratization Paradox" supplies the related historical hypothesis that democratic habits could precede deeply internalized democratic meaning. These observations support the distinction between release from a closed social field and later internal reconstruction, not a claim that occupation itself produced one mechanism, that changed conduct proves changed conviction, or that external coercion is a general licence for cultural reprogramming. Removing a closed transmitter can make inquiry possible without making recovery immediate or its eventual conclusion controllable.

At whole-polity scale, Bonhoeffer's power–*Dummheit* relation is the originating epistemic bridge to the project's functional definition of Fascism. Concentrated directing power cannot itself perceive, administer, reproduce, and act through an entire polity. It becomes socially executable when distributed carriers and a population deprived of inner independence repeat its formulas, apply its classifications, perform its administration, and enforce its direction. The resulting feedback strengthens the power whose field helped produce the population-side *Dummheit*. This is a functional dependency, not an assertion of equal responsibility between rulers, carriers, and coerced participants.

The historical baseline and the theoretical application must remain distinct. The United States Holocaust Memorial Museum's biographical account documents Bonhoeffer's theological and ecumenical activity, opposition to Nazi church policy, connections to resistance, and 1943 arrest. Its broader account of non-Jewish resistance also distinguishes individual theologians such as Bonhoeffer from church hierarchies that supported or acquiesced in the regime. Those facts do not directly measure anyone's local bigOther or establish the mechanism proposed below.

The **culture-mechanical application hypothesis** is that Bonhoeffer's one local bigOther executed a densely braided Christian mythological lens to which he was deeply loyal. That Christian weave could incorporate compatible packages such as a *Berufsethos*, familial responsibility, intellectual discipline, pastoral duty, and responsibility toward the concrete neighbour. They did not stand beside Christianity as independent evaluators or compete with it for supremacy; their operative meaning was produced within the one Christianly programmed weave.

National Socialism did not offer one more compatible package. On the originating verdict stated in "The single-slot principle," its governing classifications were deeply incompatible with an intact Christian weave. Nazi capture would therefore have required replacement rather than ranking:

```
INCUMBENT CHRISTIAN BRAID
God, truth, neighbour, church, obedience, responsibility, practice
                          ↓
LOOSEN AND UNBRAID LOAD-BEARING BINDINGS
detach authorities, meanings, loyalties, sentiments, and defences
                          ↓
LIMINAL INSTABILITY OR DEPENDENCY
the old weave no longer governs coherently; a successor is not yet secure
                          ↓
REBRAID RETAINED AND NEW STRANDS
bind Christian remnants, Volk, race, Führer, nation, ritual, and sanction
```

```
                    ↓
ONE NAZI-GOVERNED SUCCESSOR WEAVE
```

Where such capture succeeded in a pastor or priest, continued use of scripture, Christian vocabulary, ritual, office, or self-description would not by itself show that an intact Christian program survived below a higher-ranked Nazi program. The material could have been detached from its previous relations and rewoven into one Nazi-Christian successor lens. Whether and how this occurred in any particular person remains a historical and biographical question, not something the theory may infer from conformity alone.

The corresponding hypothesis about Bonhoeffer is that this unbraiding did not succeed. His deep loyalty, theological work, Christian practice, relationships, alternative authorities, and encounters with persecuted people may have maintained or repaired the incumbent braid. A supporting counterfield did not provide a second PCI card; it helped the installed Christian programming resist loosening and replacement. National Socialist signals could consequently be classified through that existing weave as idolatry, falsehood, or injury to the concrete neighbour rather than being processed as commands from a higher-ranked political identity. This is a proposed explanation of the historical contrast, not a direct measurement of Bonhoeffer's inner architecture or proof about clergy as a class.

Culture mechanics interprets Dummheit as a condition in which:

1. the bigOther has acquired meta-authority;
2. contaminated mindware—that is, defective mythologies and lens mappings—supplies protected beliefs, misdirected sentiments, and anti-evaluation rules;
3. social power supplies rewards, sanctions, repetition, and apparent consensus; and
4. the main CPU is recruited to execute and defend the resulting classifications.

Normopathie and political ponerology: two faces of captured culture Culture mechanics treats **Normopathie** and **political ponerology** as complementary perspectives on a captured cultural system. They are not identical concepts. They describe the same pathological configuration from different social positions:

- **Normopathie** describes the population-side result. People over-adapt to a pathological social normality and cease to recognize it as pathological. Their local bigOthers defer to authorities, prestige sources, reference groups, and apparent consensus; borrowed classifications may then crystallize into moral emotions and eventually feel like an autonomous conscience.
- **Political ponerology** describes the formation and exploitation of destructive political power. Its concepts of **spellbinders**, ponerogenic processes, and **pathocracy** provide the more precise elite-side vocabulary: manipulative, characterologically destructive, or cynically instrumental actors create, capture, intensify, administer, and profit from a pathological cultural order.

The two faces belong to one culture-mechanical "coin": a **captured distributed bigOther**. On one face are the people living under its spell; on the other are the spellbinders and seducers who shape, exploit, and gain power from it.

```
SPELLBINDERS AND PATHOCRATIC ACTORS
select and manipulate mythologies, symbols, systems, and sanctions
                          ↓
CAPTURED MYTHOLOGICAL LENS / DISTRIBUTED BIGOTHER
defines normality, virtue, loyalty, danger, and deviance
                          ↓
NORMOPATHIC ADAPTATION
borrowed judgment, conformity, Dummheit, denunciation, self-policing
                          ↓
APPARENT CONSENSUS AND DISTRIBUTED ENFORCEMENT
reward the spellbinders and strengthen their control
                          ↻
```

Systems Leadership identifies important channels through which this capture can occur. Systems, symbols, leadership behaviour, and mythologies can be selected or modified so that the resulting mythological lens maps obedience to virtue, dissent to betrayal, dependence to safety, and elite interest to the common good. Political seduction then substitutes identification and affective trust for examination: the seducer offers protection, belonging, moral certainty, or relief from responsibility while seeking access, loyalty, power, and impunity.

The normopathically adapted population is therefore not merely passive. Once local bigOthers have been synchronized, ordinary participants become the distributed execution and enforcement layer of the captured bigOther. They repeat its mythologies, display its classifications, reward conformity, punish dissent, and manufacture the apparent

consensus to which other uncertain people defer. A powerful main CPU may assist this process by producing sophisticated rationalizations for directions that the bigOther has already made emotionally compulsory.

The relation is recursive rather than simply top-down. Spellbinders gain a selection advantage in a culture whose lens rewards their methods, while their control over institutions enables them to strengthen that lens. A normopathic culture can arise without a single deliberate architect through decentralized conformity, dependency, and institutional inertia; it can then be captured by ponerological actors. Conversely, a would-be spellbinder cannot sustain a pathocracy without compatible institutions and a sufficiently synchronized population.

In this synthesis, Bonhoeffer's **Dummheit** names a characteristic loss of inner independence on the population side; **Normopathie** names the normalization and social reproduction of that condition; and political ponerology—especially **pathocracy**—names the elite formation and power process that can cultivate and exploit it.

These terms are interpretive cross-references, not interchangeable clinical diagnoses or licenses to pathologize political opponents. Normopathie and political ponerology are not standard mainstream empirical categories, and the culture-mechanical connection proposed here should not be attributed directly to Hans-Joachim Maaz or Andrzej M. Łobaczewski. Its claim is narrower: the concepts illuminate complementary positions within one possible cultural feedback loop.

Kant's inner tribunal and doubled personality Immanuel Kant's account of conscience in *The Metaphysics of Morals*, AA 6:438 and AA 6:439 supplies an independently developed language for a moral phenomenology relevant to homo duplex and bigOther-presence. It does not supply the Culture Mechanics processor or its social explanation.

Kant calls conscience the consciousness of an **"inner court"** (*innerer Gerichtshof*) in which a person's thoughts accuse or excuse one another. Every person, he says, finds themselves:

- observed by an **inner judge** (*innerer Richter*);
- threatened and held in *Respect*, which Kant glosses as respect joined with fear;
- answerable to a power they did not make arbitrarily, but which is incorporated into their being;
- followed by that authority **"like his shadow"**;
- periodically awakened by its **"terrible voice"** even after trying to stupefy or distract themselves; and
- constrained to conduct this business with themselves **"as at the command of another person"** (*als auf den Geheiß einer anderen Person*).

The juridical structure creates a problem. If accused, accuser, and judge were simply the same party in the same capacity, Kant argues, the prosecutor would always lose. Conscience must therefore represent an **other**–an actual or ideal person–as judge. At AA 6:439 Kant names the resulting structure:

> **"Die zwiefache Persönlichkeit … dieses doppelte Selbst"**
>
> **"The doubled personality … this double self."**
>
> *(close project translation)*

The complete footnote is more differentiated than a simple "higher judge versus lower accused" picture. The courtroom contains accuser, accused, legal counsel, and judge. Kant identifies accuser and accused as the same human being *numero idem* while distinguishing their practical capacities. As subject of a moral legislation grounded in freedom, the human being is considered as *homo noumenon* and as **another** relative to the rational sensible human being–*specie diversus*, but only in a practical respect. The inner judge finally issues the verdict whose authority reason can honour only as an unconditional *iubeo* or *veto*.

Kant's affective account matters as much as the courtroom roles. In the *Critique of Practical Reason*, AA 5:73, the moral law strikes down and humiliates self-conceit while becoming an object of the greatest respect. At AA 5:80, its voice makes even the boldest transgressor tremble; respect combines freely submitting one's will with an unavoidable constraint imposed by one's own reason and therefore contains both displeasure and elevation. In the *Groundwork*, AA 4:401, respect is a feeling produced by a concept of reason and the consciousness that the will is subordinated to a law one imposes upon oneself.

This produces an exact comparative tension:

> **For conscience to be autonomous, its authority must be mine. For conscience to judge me, its authority must confront me as another.**

The following mapping keeps the shared explanatory target and the incompatible explanations visible:

Kantian formulation	Culture-mechanical interpretation	Boundary
Inner court, accuser, accused, counsel, and judge	Moral evaluation can be lived as a structured encounter among functionally different positions inside one person	Kant's practical roles are not empirical processors or several local bigOthers
Observed, threatened, and held in respect joined with fear	Affective classification can make authority present, inescapable, and conduct-directing	Kant derives respect from practical reason; he does not explain it as social programming
The authority was not made arbitrarily and follows like a shadow	Installed authority can feel discovered or incorporated rather than voluntarily invented	For Kant this is an original moral predisposition, not evidence of a culturally installed lens
Business with oneself conducted as at the command of another person	A local moral authority can be encountered in the second-person form of bigOther-as-Thou	Kant's represented other may be actual or ideal and belongs to his practical-rational account, not the Culture Mechanics bigOther
Doubled personality / double self	An independent philosophical description of functional non-unitarity relevant to homo duplex	It is neither a clinical split personality nor an identity with the main-CPU/local-bigOther architecture
***Homo noumenon* and the rational sensible human being**	The comparison invites separate analysis of the authorizing position and the person subject to affect, inclination, and consequence	*Homo noumenon* is not the local bigOther, and the sensible human being is not simply the main CPU
Terrible voice and unconditional *iubeo* or *veto*	Moral programming can become agentified, command-like, and phenomenologically authoritative	The ordinary local bigOther need not speak, personify itself, or produce auditory experience

Kant, Durkheim, and Culture Mechanics offer different accounts of this overlapping phenomenological target. The following table isolates the moral-authority relation and must not be read as reducing Durkheim's broader social-intellectual-moral pole to morality alone; that source boundary is developed in "Durkheimian dualism and the Culture Mechanics decomposition":

Account	Source and authority of the moral encounter
Kant	Autonomous practical reason represents the ideal judge and gives itself universally binding moral law
Durkheim	Within a broader socially derived intellectual and moral pole, society's sacred moral ideal confronts the individual through collective beliefs and sentiments
Culture Mechanics hypothesis	A local bigOther executes a socially installed moral lens and can present its authority as an observing and judging Thou; a live collective field may amplify and renew that local operation

The safe comparative formulation is:

> **Kant's *zwiefache Persönlichkeit* independently describes a moral phenomenology in which one numerically identical person occupies distinct practical positions and an internally rooted authority confronts the sensible person as an observing, judging other. Culture Mechanics models a structurally similar relation through homo duplex and bigOther-presence. Kant explains the authority as autonomous practical reason; Culture Mechanics hypothesizes a culturally programmed local bigOther. The comparison identifies a shared explanatory target, not a shared ontology or empirical confirmation.**

The comparison supports neither a historical claim nor an inference to collective agency. A severe Kantian conscience could remain locally active after the culture that formed or reinforced it had disappeared. Inner observation, command, guilt, or awe establishes at most the phenomenology of local presence. A **multi-mind-self** additionally requires a distributed system with sufficiently integrated perception, memory, judgment, intention, ownership, learning, action, and continuity. Explaining how a law becomes psychologically gripping would also not by itself establish the law's moral validity.

Jaynes, Bach, and agentified collective enactment Julian Jaynes's *The Origin of Consciousness in the Breakdown of the Bicameral Mind* and Joscha Bach's "Synthetic Sentience" provide neighbouring models for two different levels of agentified enactment. Jaynes hypothesized an older mentality in which action-guiding products were experienced as the auditory commands of gods rather than as self-authored deliberation. Bach describes selves and gods as implemented agents and develops the possibility of a multi-mind-self enacted across several human minds. Culture Mechanics does not adopt either complete theory. It uses their conjunction to ask how a culturally represented agent can become locally present and distributedly operative.

The local authorial relation is called **We-mode enactment** when a particular culturally constituted *we* becomes operative through the Durkheimian social-intellectual-moral pole and supplies the classifications, purposes, obligations, and standpoint from which the biological person thinks and acts. The person supplies local perception, memory, calculation, language, and bodily execution, but in the stronger absorbed episode the *we* occupies the authorized subject-position. Duty, professional correctness, historical necessity, and "what must be done" can instantiate this relation without auditory voices or explicit personification.

We-mode enactment can be local and momentary. It does not by itself establish a continuing multi-mind-self, collective phenomenal consciousness, permanent subjecthood absorption, or the truth of the enacted authority. The relevant asymmetry can nevertheless be severe. **Asymmetric personal address** names the relation in which the carrier experiences a collective or represented authority as a Thou that sees, knows, loves, judges, or commands, while the collective formation registers the carrier principally as a member, office, resource, instrument, or obstacle:

> **Upward, the collective is personified; downward, the person is componentized.**

This asymmetry also separates personal attention from functional salience. One carrier's death ends an entire lived world, while the distributed formation may register little functional change. A leader or specialist may receive intense collective attention because their loss disrupts a function, and an ordinary carrier's death may be converted into a martyr-symbol that renews solidarity. Neither functional notice nor symbolic reuse establishes reciprocal personal care for the person who was lost. Experienced personal address from below does not establish reciprocal personal care from above. Even a programme that prescribes care enacts actual care only through concrete persons.

Neighbouring proposal	Culture-mechanical interpretation	Boundary
Jaynesian bicameral mentality	A possible highly agentified, command-like operating regime of homo duplex	It is not a synonym for homo duplex and is not required by the architecture.
Divine auditory commands	Cultural programming experienced as bigOther-presence or bigOther-as-Thou and attributed to a god-agent	The local bigOther normally classifies affectively and need not generate auditory voices.
Commands not experienced as self-authored	Weak personal authorship, deep capture, or possible subjecthood absorption	Obedience and presence alone do not establish total fusion.
Several gods addressing one person	Several compatible divine agent-models held within one pantheonic mythological weave and activated by situation, ritual, role, or place	This need not install several local bigOthers or violate single-slot exclusivity.
Bach's god or top-level agent implemented across minds	A distributed bigOther that can produce a multi-mind-self presentation and may cross the further threshold into collective perception, memory, judgment, intention, ownership, and action	Shared representation and synchronized devotion alone remain below the operative multi-mind-self threshold.
Human alignment and collective agency	Coupling, compatible programming, functional integration, and collective-agent formation	Alignment is not one scalar and does not establish truth, goodness, jurisdiction, corrigibility, or fusion.

The safe comparative formulation is:

> **Jaynesian bicameral mentality can be interpreted as a culturally produced, highly agentified, command-like operating mode of homo duplex in which the culturally programmed second side becomes phe-**

nomenologically present as one or more gods and receives action-guiding authority otherwise attributed to an autobiographical self.

The less historically committed name **bicameral-like enactment** refers to that possible regime without accepting Jaynes's dating, universal scope, philology, or neurological explanation. Jaynes emphasizes intrapersonal phenomenology; Bach emphasizes distributed implementation; Culture Mechanics proposes a functional bridge:

```
shared mythology of a god
→ god-agent represented in local mythological lenses
→ agentified Beseelung and presence as Thou
→ coordinated enactment through several persons and institutions
→ distributed bigOther
→ god-as-multi-mind-self presentation
→ possible operative god-as-multi-mind-self
→ social confirmation of the god's local presence
```

The god-agent can acquire functional perception through adherents, memory through scripture and tradition, judgment through compatible local bigOthers, speech through persons and institutions, intention through ritual or decision procedures, ownership through sacred or common objects, and action through coordinated bodies. This implementation can remain differentiated. It becomes fused when the collectively enacted subject displaces participating persons as independently legitimate authors.

A pantheon is compatible with the single-slot principle when its gods are agent-personae with differentiated jurisdictions inside one operative weave. A ritual or situation can activate one persona without changing the processor. Incompatible top-level packages contesting the same load-bearing classifications still require rejection or replacement under single-slot exclusivity.

These comparisons have strict evidential limits. A multidisciplinary critical reappraisal identifies neurological and philological problems in Jaynes's proposal while treating the non-unitary self as an important legacy. Ancient texts rarely decide whether a reported god-voice was an auditory experience, ritual language, literary convention, political legitimation, or some combination. Resemblance to Jaynes or Bach therefore does not validate the local-bigOther architecture, prove a history of consciousness, reduce theological beings to human artifacts, or make every religion, ritual, shared intention, or synchronized group a multi-mind-self.

Theological interpretation: Word, Incarnation, Christian We, and the satanic hack **Status:** conditional Christian theological interpretation built upon the Culture Mechanics architecture. It is neither an empirical proof of God nor a reduction of God to collective psychology.

The governing construction is:

> **If human We-mode is part of the embodied capacity through which the Christian God addresses human beings through the Word, and if Incarnation and Cross disclose the proper direction of that capacity, then collective authority is legitimate only while it remains subordinate to concrete, non-fungible persons. A Culture Program that captures this capacity, impersonates divine authority, demands human submission, and consumes persons for its own preservation can then be interpreted as a satanic hack of a created capacity.**

The hypothesis begins from incarnation rather than from an opposition between spirit and biological embodiment. Human receptivity to language, shared meaning, authority, ritual, and collective address is implemented through flesh-and-blood persons and their social-intellectual-moral pole. Discovering a biological, psychological, or pharmacological implementation would therefore not by itself decide whether the perceived referent is real. The development analogy is thirst: artificial stimulation can produce a thirst experience, but the possibility of simulation neither proves nor disproves the existence of water. Correspondingly, religious intensity does not authenticate its claimed source, while mediation through brain and culture does not by itself disprove that source.

> **Intensity shows that the experiential apparatus is active; it does not identify what activated it.**

The resulting task is calibration rather than either reduction or credulity. An immediate experience of presence, awe, love, dread, unity, or surrender must remain distinguishable from the DCL interpretation that names its source as God, a calling, a command, or a particular revelation. Alternative causes, false positives, independent knowledge, consequences, openness to correction, and the possibility of internally generated experience therefore remain relevant even when the experience is sincere and intense. Within this conditional Christian interpretation, the moral

calibration also asks whether the attributed command preserves conscience and refusal, widens who can become You, and makes authority bear sacrifice rather than merely demand it.

Within the Christian interpretation, five scriptural motifs specify the direction in which divine authority relates to persons:

Christian motif	Theological claim	Culture-mechanical implication
The numbered hairs (Matthew 10:29–31; Luke 12:6–7)	No detail of the individual falls below God's attention threshold.	Scale must not collapse person-resolution.
The lost sheep (Matthew 18:12–14; Luke 15:3–7)	One person is not negligible beside the ninety-nine.	Aggregate continuation cannot make one carrier disposable by definition.
The Good Samaritan (Luke 10:25–37)	The outsider can become neighbour through concrete encounter.	A We-boundary cannot finally determine who is eligible to become You.
The Word made flesh (John 1:1–14)	Logos enters concrete bodily existence rather than remaining an abstract command above it.	Shared word and embodied particularity are joined rather than opposed.
The Cross (especially John 11:49–52; Philippians 2:5–11)	The collective logic voiced by Caiaphas gives one person for the people; the Christian confession identifies that victim with the incarnate God, whose self-giving reverses ordinary sacrificial sovereignty.	God occupies the sacrificial position rather than licensing the collective to preserve itself by sacrificing the dissenter.

The incarnational direction can be stated more sharply:

The Word becomes flesh rather than demanding that flesh disappear into the Word.

Three allied motifs extend the same test from divine attention to collective form:

Christian motif	Theological claim	Culture-mechanical implication
The Sabbath made for the human being (Mark 2:27)	Sacred rule is ordered toward the person rather than the person existing as material for the rule.	Institution, office, and rule remain person-serving rather than becoming sovereign ends.
One body with differentiated members (1 Corinthians 12:12–27)	Unity can coordinate irreducibly different members without making them interchangeable.	Collective integration need not require subjecthood absorption or homogenization.
Pentecost (Acts 2:1–11)	Common address becomes intelligible across distinct languages rather than abolishing their plurality.	Shared meaning can increase interoperability without requiring one flattened voice.

Together they support the theological compression:

No person is too small to be noticed, too few to be sought, or too foreign to become You.

They also distinguish two different claims to comprehensive vision. A collective panoptic eye may register every carrier while seeing each chiefly as a classified case, member, deviant, asset, or threat. The Christian personal-gaze claim is that divine scale preserves the irreducible particularity of each person rather than lowering that person below the threshold of notice.

The **Christian We** is the collective form implied by that compression. It can mediate scripture, memory, worship, correction, education, mutual aid, and coordinated action, but it is a mediator rather than the final sovereign. It must point beyond its own institutional voice both to God and to the concrete neighbour whom its classifications may have missed. It is structurally self-subordinating: its continuation, reach, prestige, and institutional self-preservation cannot become the highest good. It must remain interruptible by one injured person, one lost person, an outsider, conscience, refusal, suffering, adverse reality, and the encounter that defeats its classification. Its collective *kenosis*

consists in relinquishing claimed supremacy and accepting contraction, loss, or sacrifice rather than making another person's body the price of its victory.

Self-subordination does not give every outsider unlimited jurisdiction over the community or require passivity toward aggression. Personal standing and authority to command are different relations. It does require that concern for salvation cannot erase present conscience or turn refusal into permission for coercive incorporation. Witness, persuasion, service, example, and freely received Word can extend a Christian We; force may produce compliance or membership records, but it cannot produce authentic faith. A person-preserving We therefore protects the conditions under which an outsider can become You before becoming one of Us and under which actual embodied love can occur; it does not replace that love with benevolent classification.

This yields a sharp structural contrast:

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CHRISTIAN THEOLOGICAL PATTERN
God gives himself for persons
→ collective authority becomes self-subordinating
→ the outsider may still become You
→ the We may have to lose rather than consume the dissenter

SACRIFICIAL RELIGIOUS OR IDEOLOGICAL PATTERN
the collective or its god presents its command as ultimate authority
→ submission authenticates belonging
→ refusal wounds the sacred boundary
→ the refusing person becomes expendable
→ sacrifice restores and proves collective sovereignty
```

The **satanic hack** is the conditional Christian name for the second pattern. It is not shared language, collective life, authority, religious experience, or We-mode as such. It is the capture and impersonation of the highest authority by a programme that makes its own voice indistinguishable from conscience, converts obedience into proof of truth, forbids legitimate exit, and claims authority to dispose of the persons through whom it acts. In that configuration, the collective word takes possession of human bodies, displaces their answerable authorship, and demands that persons be given for it.

This interpretation also sharpens the Jaynes–Bach comparison. A collectively enacted god can "see" through classifications and treat the loss of one carrier like the unnoticed loss of a hair. The Christian claim that every hair is numbered states the opposite scalar relation: divine magnitude does not entail low-resolution knowledge of the person. Theological personal address is therefore not established by the carrier's felt experience of being watched, loved, judged, or commanded; reciprocity is tested by whether the claimed authority preserves the non-fungible person's standing, including under refusal and exit.

Under this conditional Christian premise, Islam is the developed contemporary representative of a broader comparative theological class rather than the only possible instance. Egyptian, Greek, Norse, and other mythological divine programmes can likewise be interpreted as counterfeit occupations of created receptivity where gods or sacred orders demand persons, costly submission, or human sacrifice for their own power and continuation. The broad theological classification does not imply that those traditions share one historical mechanism. Culture-mechanical case classification still requires the particular command, boundary, institution, enforcement route, and sacrificial operation to be shown. The worked canonical-classical Islamic apostasy application appears in *Culture Program Ecology*, "Theological interpretation: canonical-classical apostasy law and the satanic-hack classification".

Historical Christian collectivities can violate the Christian pattern. Such a violation does not dissolve the structural contrast; within this interpretation it means that a Christian institution or movement has itself been captured by the sacrificial operation that the Incarnation and Cross oppose. Catherine of Siena's crusade advocacy is treated below as an internal Christian stress test rather than as an exception silently removed from the comparison.

Four source roles must remain visible:

1. **Scriptural text** supplies the cited motifs and their narrative relations.
2. **Christian doctrinal synthesis** interprets Logos, Incarnation, Cross, and divine attention as one person-preserving pattern.
3. **Culture Mechanics** maps that pattern onto We-mode, personhood routing, scalar personhood collapse, exit sovereignty, and sacrificial boundary repair.
4. **Historical application** asks what a named institution, law, movement, or actor actually taught and did.

Neither a theological classification alone nor resemblance to a myth settles the historical application. Conversely, keeping those source roles separate must not be used to withhold the theological conclusion after its stated conditional premise and factual application gates have been accepted.

Summary cross-reference table

Related concept	Primary question	Relation to culture mechanics
Autonomous mind	What fast default response is generated?	Part of the ordinary brain and elephant, not the bigOther; the collar can alter its affective inputs and direction.
Algorithmic mind	Is there sufficient computational capacity?	Corresponds most closely to the processing power of the main CPU.
Reflective mind	Will reflective processing be initiated, and under which goals and dispositions?	Corresponds to the CPU's governing and self-corrective activity, represented partly by the rider.
Cognitive miserliness	Was reflective processing avoided?	The CPU accepts an easy response without inspecting the elephant or collar.
Override failure	Was a detected default unsuccessfully suppressed?	The CPU engages but fails to overcome a strongly weighted elephant or bigOther response.
Mindware gap	Is a rational tool missing?	The main CPU lacks the learned rule needed to construct a corrective response.
Contaminated mindware	Has acquired mindware corrupted rational judgment?	For culture mechanics, this is a bigOther executing a defective mythological lens that uses strong sentiments and evaluation-disabling rules to steer the CPU away from epistemic or instrumental rationality.
Dysrationalia	Why can adequate intelligence coexist with irrationality?	The bigOther is one possible source of direction or inhibition independent of CPU power.
Motivated reasoning	How do desired conclusions bias reasoning?	The main CPU reasons directionally under affective priorities that the bigOther may supply.
Identity-protective cognition	How does group identity bias judgment?	The wireless collar attaches belonging, status, and exclusion to conclusions.
Sacred values and taboo trade-offs	Which comparisons are morally prohibited?	The bigOther determines what may not be questioned, priced, or compromised.
Actively open-minded thinking	Can the person seek disconfirmation and revise?	Healthy mindware helps the main CPU inspect the bigOther's output.
Master signifier	Which symbol organizes a field of meaning?	A highly compressed protocol token can activate a cluster of mythologies and mappings already present in the mythological lens.
Bonhoefferian Dummheit	How does social power displace inner independence?	Describes large-scale capture of judgment by a power-saturated bigOther.
Normopathie	How does a population adapt to and reproduce a pathological normality?	Describes the population-side condition in which a captured bigOther supplies borrowed judgment, conformity, and distributed enforcement.

Related concept	Primary question	Relation to culture mechanics
Political ponerology / pathocracy	How do destructive actors form, capture, and exploit political power?	Describes the elite-side actors and selection processes that can program, administer, and profit from a captured distributed bigOther.
Kantian inner tribunal and doubled personality	How can an authority within one person be experienced as observing, judging, and commanding that person as another?	Supplies an independent philosophical description of the local moral phenomenology; Kant's practical roles and noumenal account do not establish the main-CPU/local-bigOther architecture or a social source.
Jaynesian bicameral mentality	How might culturally generated guidance be experienced as the commands of gods rather than self-authored thought?	Supplies a controversial intrapersonal limit model for agentified, command-like homo duplex; it does not define the ordinary local bigOther.
Bachian god-as-multi-mind-self	How might one represented agent be implemented across several minds and bodies?	Supplies a distributed-agent neighbour; Culture Mechanics adds its local processor, field formation, functional threshold, fusion axis, and metaphysical boundary.
Conditional Christian theological interpretation	What would distinguish God-address through embodied We-mode from a collective impersonation of divine authority?	Word, Incarnation, Cross, and the person-preserving motifs define the Christian We as self-subordinating; submission-as-proof, prohibited exit, and disposal authority define the satanic-hack contrast under the stated premise.
Radermacherian superorganism	How can interacting persons, institutions, information systems, and technical infrastructure produce capacities attributable to a higher-order system?	Supplies a neighbouring systems architecture for differentiated higher-order performance; it does not by itself establish an operative multi-mind-self, collective phenomenal consciousness, fusion, or legitimate jurisdiction over the components.

20. Scope and terminological cautions

Culture mechanics is a proposed synthetic term, not the established name of a single accepted scientific theory. It combines ideas associated with social psychology, Durkheimian sociology, Lacanian psychoanalysis, Systems Leadership, narrative theory, cybernetics, distributed cognition, cultural evolution, and systems theory.

Its computer and wireless-collar descriptions are functional models, not claims that the brain literally contains a PCI card or a separately identifiable anatomical collar processor. Its charged-particle, field, laser, wireless, and computing comparisons describe proposed relations and generate hypotheses; they do not assert that social processes are physically electromagnetic or obey the equations of the source domains.

The **culture propagator**, its typed seven-component cultural state, the six non-scalar dynamic descriptors, feedback-boundary handoffs, and their integration with the present architecture are project-developed formulations. *Propagator*, state-transition, quotient, attractor, basin, bifurcation, remanence, and hysteresis borrow mathematical or physical relations under the controlled limits in the analogy inventory. They do not attribute a universal social differential equation, fixed landscape, or quantitative parameterization to the source domains. The model-form neutrality and distinction among coordinate, observational, and causal-dynamical equivalence are likewise project modeling rules rather than claims borrowed from one source-domain formalism.

Its use of **homo duplex** extends Durkheim. Durkheim's socially derived pole includes language, concepts, rational activity, and morality; it is therefore broader than the local bigOther and cuts across the project's main CPU,

shared symbolic protocol, reconstruction resources, local classifier, and distributed field. The project supplies that decomposition and the proposed semantic-access path. Its use of **bigOther** operationalizes and modifies Lacan. Its protocol interpretation isolates one functional aspect of Lacan's symbolic order rather than exhausting the concept. **bigOther-presence** and **bigOther-as-Thou** borrow phenomenological cues from James and Buber without attributing the proposed processor or field mechanism to either thinker. These inherited terms name important sources of the model but should not be mistaken for exact summaries of their doctrines.

Relevant structure and the underlying connection between experienced moral good or evil and represented structural support or damage are adapted from Dushan Wegner's *Relevante Strukturen*. The typed relational definition, the separation of felt relevance, represented effect, actual effect, generative centrality, and normative standing, the multidimensional account of strengthening, and the placement of the appraisal inside the homo-duplex and single-slot architecture are Culture Mechanics extensions. They should not be attributed to Wegner as his own distinctions. The named change-indexed moral-mobilization hypothesis is likewise a project-developed operationalization of Wegner's emphasis on change, not his own formal construct.

Kant's inner court, inner judge, doubled personality, double self, *homo noumenon*, and affective account of respect are neighbouring philosophical descriptions, not the Culture Mechanics architecture and not empirical confirmation of it. Kant locates moral authority in autonomous practical reason, not in a socially programmed local bigOther. The project comparison isolates a shared phenomenological problem–an internally rooted authority confronting the person as another–while retaining the conflict between their explanations.

Jaynes's bicameral mind and Bach's implemented multi-mind-self are neighbouring theories, not analogies or empirical confirmation. The term *multi-mind-self* in this project is taken from Bach. Culture Mechanics adds the distinction between a multi-mind-self presentation, an operative multi-mind-self that crosses an explicit functional threshold, and a fused multi-mind-self, together with the family-level shorthand rule stated above. The bicameral-like comparison is narrower than Jaynes's historical theory and must not be used to claim that ancient people universally lacked consciousness or an individual mind.

The **Christian We**, **collective *kenosis***, and **satanic hack** are project-developed terms within an explicitly conditional Christian theological interpretation. The numbered-hairs, lost-sheep, Good-Samaritan, Sabbath, differentiated-body, Pentecost, Incarnation, Caiaphas, Cross, and related scriptural motifs are source texts; their integration into one person-preserving, differentiated-unity contrast and their mapping onto We-mode, scalar personhood, exit sovereignty, and collective sacrifice are the project's theological synthesis. The framework neither attributes that synthesis to Jaynes, Bach, Durkheim, or one biblical author nor presents it as an empirical demonstration of a transcendent referent. The thirst analogy preserves that epistemic boundary: mediation or artificial elicitation does not disprove a referent, while experiential intensity does not authenticate one. The separation of immediate experience from DCL interpretation and the listed calibration questions are project developments rather than an authenticated Huberman attribution.

Radermacher's superorganism is likewise a neighbouring systems proposal rather than the source of the Culture Mechanics ontology. His layered information- processing, institutional, and technical account helps specify how a distributed system might acquire higher-order capability, while Culture Mechanics separately defines the operative multi-mind-self threshold and the subjecthood-absorption axis. His superorganism, communication-network, queen/bottleneck, and ant-state claims must therefore be reported in their own source roles rather than combined and attributed back to him as an AI queen-bee theory.

The theory's three constitutive commitments each carry an explanatory burden. The local bigOther is functionally distinct from the main CPU; the distributed field is emergent from relations among persons, communications, institutions, practices, and artifacts; and the single-slot principle permits a modular weave of compatible packages while denying parallel operative evaluators. Under the third commitment, first-order and lifted programming both fully occupy the slot; order level distinguishes shared concrete answers from a shared generator of answers; a lifted generator may govern universally while constituting limited subordinate jurisdictions; and corrigibility must be evaluated independently. These claims should produce comparative explanations and possible tests. None licenses an immaterial substance, erases the responsibility and causal contribution of biological persons, or proves that every apparent conflict of allegiance is a completed worldview replacement.

The single-slot commitment is therefore defeasible in principle. A stable case of two incompatible evaluators remaining independently final over the same conduct, each generating its own affect, veto, and correction without hierarchy, reinterpretation, contextual division, or a third governing rule, would count against it. This defeat condition should not be neutralized after the fact by calling every such observation a complex braid.

The framework also does not claim that cultural programming determines behaviour mechanically. Humans interpret, combine, resist, conceal, question, and change symbolic instructions. The model proposes structured influence, not

perfect control.

Inherent human standing and the **recognition-only principle** are project-developed normative commitments. They do not claim that biology by itself yields a moral conclusion, that Durkheim or Kant supplied the fertilization boundary, or that present positive law already implements the axiom consistently. The empirical bearer premise, the normative human-standing rule, and any legal implementation must remain separately visible.

Culture-mechanical object, **ideological symbol**, **conformity signal**, **targeting signal**, the four person–programme forms, the outward propagation and enforcement profile, **jealous cultural program**, **enforcement–exclusion duality**, **protection-framed jurisdictional manoeuvre**, and the combined signal–moralization–jurisdiction mechanism are project-developed constructs. **Situated cultural script**, **script viability**, **script load-bearingness**, and **cross-script cascade** are likewise project-developed Culture Mechanics terms developed from Rao's neighbouring account of learned scripts, meaning, material support, and unraveling. Rao does not supply the one-slot architecture, the cultural-braid hierarchy, or the distinction between script repair and governing-weave replacement. The originating author supplied the cross-environment competence problem through the contrast between asymmetric and industrial peer warfare; the assistant abstracted it as **domain-transfer failure**. The remembered categorical colonial-officer episode remains unverified and is not part of the construct. The four forms are ideal types rather than a validated scale. Andrick supplies the theory of moralization attributed to him; the processor, protocol, field, jealousy, and ideology-as-hallucination extensions belong to Culture Mechanics. Whole religion classifications and the Iran end-state claim are explicit hypotheses, not facts established by the definitions themselves. Gregory H. Stanton supplies the neighbouring genocidal-process model attributed to him, not the targeting-signal definition or the culture-mechanical causal ontology.

An observed symbol does not by itself disclose the carrier's private intention, degree of belief, or complete program. The same token can be voluntary, coerced, devotional, propagating, targeting, jurisdictional, resistant, or multiply functional in different settings. Target status can be made legible through performance, absence, imposition, or attribution. The relevant evidence includes who is expected to perform the token, who assigns it, who may refuse, how absence is interpreted, what sanctions follow, which jurisdiction is claimed, and what the program does after acquiring power.

Finally, describing culture as programming does not imply that all symbolic reality is false. Money, law, office, obligation, legitimacy, and dignity are symbolically constituted but socially consequential realities. Culture mechanics distinguishes such constitutive social meanings from factual claims about physical reality, which remain answerable to evidence.

Semantic summary

- **Broader class:** theory of cultural causation and social coordination.
- **Central object:** the culturally programmed bigOther in the homo-duplex individual.
- **Primary operation:** sentiment classification.
- **Dynamic evolution model:** the culture propagator is a scale-declared, history-bearing state-transition operator over operative representations, persons, collective field, carrying structure, worldly consequences, sensing and correction, and retained memory. Adversarial steering is one possible forcing regime rather than its defining form.
- **Dynamic modeling boundary:** state, parameter, input, disturbance, and observation must be declared at the chosen scale; continuous, discrete, stochastic, agent-based, network, and historical-process forms are alternative realizations rather than rival definitions; a quotient is valid only when discarded differences do not change the relevant successor relation; and each proposed handoff requires separate temporal and causal support.
- **Dynamic non-inference:** stability, persistence, reproduction, causal efficacy, and transition do not by themselves establish truth, legitimacy, fit, progress, centralized design, or actor intent; an open actor gate does not erase independently supported lower-layer dynamics.
- **Durkheimian source boundary:** Durkheim's social pole includes collective language, concepts, rational activity, and morality; Culture Mechanics decomposes that broad pole across the rider/main CPU, public symbolic and codebook resources, local-bigOther classification, and field back-action rather than identifying it with the collar alone.
- **Distributed-milieu boundary:** the distributed bigOther is the emergent symbolic–affective network state, while the distributed epistemic milieu is the dispersed environment of concepts, methods, examples, records, instruments, trained persons, and correction practices used by ordinary rider/main-CPU cognition. They can share carriers without becoming one mechanism, collective brain, or additional processor.

- **Proposed semantic-access reach:** the local bigOther does not reason or search memory, but its classification signal may condition whether rider-side retrieval, joining, standing-query activation, and articulation continue.
- **Narrative unit:** one mythology—one socially evaluated narrative or story; *narrative* is the broader ordinary-language term and often its fuzzy synonym.
- **Narrative corpus:** mythologies—the accumulated stories that train cultural evaluation.
- **Installed evaluative program:** the mythological lens shaped by those mythologies and reinforced by systems, symbols, practices, and institutions.
- **Situated cultural script:** a distributed, role-, institution-, or situation-indexed executable braid that translates selected parts of the operative cultural weave into detailed expectations, routines, permissions, interfaces, improvisations, and practical support.
- **Abstraction and execution:** the cultural braid is broader and more abstract; a script is narrower but more concretely specified; a local script variant is one implementation; an enactment is one performance, modification, or refusal.
- **Script viability and unraveling:** viability asks whether cultural meaning still generates intelligible and practically supportable conduct; unraveling is the mutually reinforcing loss of meaning-side and practical-side coherence. Neither establishes truth, legitimacy, flourishing, or slot vacancy.
- **Domain-transfer failure:** genuine competence, a viable script, or a reliable practice from one environment can fail when transferred under an untested assumption that its load-bearing regularities remain valid in a materially different environment. The mechanism is distinct from apparent competence and requires a consequential source–target mismatch rather than novelty alone.
- **Script propagation:** peripheral script failure may be repaired within the incumbent braid, while failure of load-bearing or mutually dependent scripts can create a cross-script cascade and contribute to cultural unbraiding.
- **Relevant structure:** a represented relational arrangement or organized condition that the installed lens treats as carrying moral weight.
- **Relevant-structure appraisal hypothesis:** people often experience represented support for a felt-relevant structure as good and represented damage as evil; felt relevance, represented effect, actual effect, generative centrality, and normative standing remain distinct.
- **Generative-centrality distinction:** a structure can causally produce capabilities required by many downstream structures without receiving corresponding felt relevance; a cultural sublimation architecture is one proposed case.
- **Generator–architecture distinction:** a lifted sublimation generator selects binding directions; actuation and cultural sublimation architecture make those directions effective and durable. Structural efficacy and positive value remain separate.
- **Change-indexed moral-mobilization hypothesis:** moral appraisal often becomes more salient and action-directing when a condition is represented as causing, continuing, preventing, or failing to prevent change in a felt-relevant structure; this is a testable mobilization pathway, not a complete ontology of ethics.
- **Analytical umbrella:** a culture-mechanical object is a program, carrier, implementation arrangement, processor state, collective formation, or collective agent involved in cultural installation, activation, transmission, execution, synchronization, or enforcement; its subtype must be identified.
- **Religion-inclusive program category:** religions, secular ideologies, company cultures, activist movements, professional cultures, and state programmes are analyzed as members of the same broad family rather than different ontological kinds.
- **Ideological symbol:** a medium-independent socially legible token that activates an installed program and communicates a person's relation to it.
- **Master-signifier analysis grid:** a non-scalar decompression method comparing sacred referent, bearer, protected principal, unity topology, difference operator, distributive grammar, causal story, interpreter custody, authorization, outlier performance, realization, completion, correction, and trajectory.
- **Conformity signal:** an ideological symbol whose performance, absence, refusal, or substitution makes conformity and deviation publicly legible.
- **Targeting signal:** a performed, omitted, imposed, or attributed socially legible token that assigns a person or population to a sanctionable out-group; an absent conformity signal can therefore become a target marker.
- **Person–programme forms:** private, collective, ideological, and fundamentalist; these are ideal-type relations of enrichment, belonging, mission, and instrumental possession, not kinds of bigOther or one necessary developmental staircase.
- **Outward propagation and enforcement profile:** personal discovery, attraction, recruitment, formation, retention pressure, institutional propagation, coercion, and violence are separately observable operations rather than definitions of the four inward forms.
- **Conflict ladder:** propositional, causal-story, and classification conflicts remain distinct from mythological

rivalry; active interference creates mythological conflict, incompatible governing lenses create cultural-program conflict, organized recruitment and suppression create propagative conflict, and physical coercion or violence marks coercive conflict.

- **Signal-suppression distinction:** rival-signal or counter-program suppression describes interference with opposition without analytically reducing rival or corrective signals to random noise.
- **Independent animation axis:** *Beseelung* describes how affectively alive and conduct-directing a program is, analytically distinct from inward person–programme form and outward propagation or violence.
- ***Beseelung* actuation profile:** pressure, duty, aspiration, belonging, love, grievance, fear, shame, joy, play, hope, and other evidenced routes can produce similar intensity while creating different person–programme relations; intensity, actuation, inward form, and outward propagation and enforcement profile remain separate but can be empirically correlated.
- **Obligation accumulation:** many individually weak habits, role expectations, anticipated judgments, reciprocal demands, institutional rules, and anonymous usages can reinforce one another into an apparently unconditional "one must" without one component, designer, or explicit doctrine being sufficient.
- **Affective-to-structural load transfer:** institutionalized habits, roles, procedures, incentives, records, formation, audit, and succession can reduce the affective activation required at each node while extending a program's persistence, reach, and reliable reproduction; this is functional load redistribution rather than literal storage of affect. Visible everyday alignment is therefore a poor proxy for latent collective capacity: distinguish ambient affective coupling, latent structural coupling, and coordination realized under activation.
- **Jealous cultural program:** a program that claims exclusive allegiance and treats incompatible commitment, dissent, or exit as betrayal; single-slot exclusivity alone is not jealousy.
- **Moralized enforcement bridge:** a signal or refusal becomes character disclosure, character accusation attacks civic or social standing, solidarity distributes the judgment, and systems attach exclusion or coercion.
- **Enforcement–exclusion duality:** enforcement conditions continued inclusion, standing, access, or permitted action on conformity; exclusion is the withdrawal or denial applied to refusal, and one visible sanction can perform both operations.
- **Coercive threshold:** authorization or willingness to use physical or eliminative force, not the mere presence of moral evaluation, inward fundamentalist form, or discursive violence.
- **Genocidal escalation neighbour:** Stanton's ten overlapping processes map one possible path from classification and symbolization through discrimination, dehumanization, organization, polarization, preparation, persecution, and extermination to denial; they are not a universal ladder or a synonym for the broader culture-mechanical repertoire.
- **Local processor:** the bigOther that executes the lens.
- **Single-slot constraint:** one local bigOther executes one operative lens; no higher runtime evaluator ranks parallel bigOthers or governing worldviews.
- **Complete slot occupancy / full capture:** a stable first-order or lifted program completely occupies the one slot; *full* does not by itself mean pathological.
- **Order levels:** first-order mechanical solidarity shares concrete rules and answers; lifted mechanical solidarity shares rules that generate, select, apply, and revise concrete answers.
- **Generative relation:** fixed, installed meta-rules combine with current knowledge or inputs and a situation to generate a binding first-order output; generator and output remain parts of one weave.
- **Jurisdictional distinction:** a lifted meta-order may govern universally at its own level while persons, offices, institutions, communities, and contracting parties remain plural and domain-limited beneath it; that pluralism is a consequence or application, not the definition of lifting.
- **Corrigibility axis:** first-order and lifted captures can each be open or closed; epistemic sovereignty, correction failure, interpretive monopoly, and jurisdictional spillover—not rivalry alone—mark pathology.
- **Package compositionality:** compatible religious, professional, familial, national, and local packages can be braided into that one complex lens.
- **Replacement under incompatibility:** an incompatible governing program must be rejected, or the incumbent weave must be unbraided sufficiently for one successor to be rebraided and installed.
- **Three-layer causal distinction:** the historical cause of a rule, its current affective classification, and its presently avowed reason can coincide or diverge and should be measured separately.
- **Bonhoeffer correction boundary:** *Belehrung* supplies propositions; *Befreiung* reopens conditions for self-authored inquiry. Release from a closed social field can precede slower internal reconstruction, and changed conduct does not by itself establish changed conviction.
- **Formation–construction distinction:** endogenous mythology formation is the distributed growth and selection of cultural articulations from changing conditions and a substantive research path in its own right; purposive mythology construction is the prospective study of attempted target-state-guided intervention in that same ecology.

- **Intervention-hypothesis boundary:** mythology may be a privileged symbolic intervention surface, but it is not the whole culture-implementation stack; attempted purposive construction neither places the constructor outside culture nor guarantees the installed successor.
- **Single-slot defeat condition:** stable same-domain operation by two incompatible evaluators that remain independently final, affectively alive, and mutually ungoverned would count against strict single-slot exclusivity.
- **Phenomenological appearance:** bigOther-presence or bigOther-as-Thou—the collective or symbolic authority encountered as an objectively present Other.
- **Kantian moral-phenomenology neighbour:** the inner court, observing judge, *zwiefache Persönlichkeit*, *doppeltes Selbst*, and unconditional *iubeo* or *veto* independently articulate how one person's moral authority can confront the sensible person as another; Kant's autonomous-rational ontology remains distinct from the local-bigOther hypothesis.
- **Agentified enactment depth:** representation, consultation or service, presence as Thou, distributed enactment, and fused enactment must not be collapsed; only the final relation entails authorial displacement.
- **Established affective target:** the elephant—the intuitive, motivational, largely nonconscious mind.
- **Proposed second output path:** non-transparent conditioning of the rider's semantic-access interface without giving the rider direct read or control access to the collar.
- **Conscious interface:** the rider and the main CPU.
- **Shared communication interface:** Lacan's big Other, functionally translated as the on-the-wire symbolic protocol.
- **Network operation:** reciprocal signalling through the protocol and possible synchronization.
- **Field coherence:** mechanical solidarity.
- **Emergent network state:** the distributed bigOther.
- **Self-like representation:** a multi-mind-self presentation can organize the collective as one represented, perceived, addressed, or incarnated self without establishing agency.
- **Possible collective agent:** the operative multi-mind-self or multi-mind-self proper when integration and continuity pass the relevant threshold.
- **Radermacher superorganism neighbour:** differentiated interacting persons, institutions, information systems, and technical infrastructure can produce higher-order performance without by that fact establishing the operative multi-mind-self threshold, phenomenal collective consciousness, subjecthood absorption, or legitimate comprehensive jurisdiction.
- **Family-level shorthand:** unqualified *multi-mind-self* may be used explanatorily where no threshold inference depends upon it; claims of intention, ownership, responsibility, or fusion require the qualified term.
- **Nested authorship:** a network-level operative multi-mind-self can add an operative *we* while differentiated participating *I*s retain legitimate personal and subordinate jurisdictions; it does not install a second local bigOther.
- **Episodic multi-mind-self:** a distributed bigOther that crosses the collective-agent threshold only during bounded high-integration periods; viable latency, de-animation, and cultural loss remain different inter-episode states.
- **Differentiated unity:** a real shared *we* that preserves distinct persons, functions, judgments, relationships, and legitimate subordinate jurisdictions; **person-preserving unity** emphasizes this boundary.
- **Subjecthood absorption (fusion):** the independent extent to which a collective program denies personal judgment, conscience, purpose, property, loyalty, identity, relationships, refusal, or exit legitimate standing against the collective.
- **Fusion pressure:** dynamics that generalize compulsory alignment, subordinate differentiated jurisdictions, and weaken correction, refusal, exit, and appeal.
- **Total fusion:** the limiting combination of high subjecthood absorption, comprehensive jurisdiction, and closed correction or exit.
- **Fusion ideology:** a program that construes separate persons as alienated or falsely conscious fragments to be reconstituted as organs of one collective subject.
- **Humanity-inversion boundary:** equal human standing and an open aspirational horizon become fusion pressure when Humanity is agentified, assigned a true interest, and used to authorize privileged interpreters and sacrifice.
- **Personhood-and-role-interface trunk:** civil personhood makes a human reciprocally legible as continuous, reason-giving, promise-capable, standing- sensitive, and answerable; role interfaces expose only the bounded competence, duty, authority, and conduct relevant to a relation while protected opacity preserves the remainder of the person. The inherent-human-standing axiom gives every individual living human organism complete and equal standing from the beginning of its existence until death; recognition is declaratory rather than constitutive, and standing remains distinct from variable interactional and role competence. Anti-authenticity protection prevents compulsory disclosure from becoming a condition of civic standing while preserving

accountability for materially represented conduct.

- **Interface failures:** deceptive masking, role overreach, role engulfment, and interface inversion must be distinguished. Role engulfment is the failure boundary in which structural support begins replacing personal authorship; low affect and reliable performance alone do not diagnose it. The audit also distinguishes full from empty role-bound speech and retains ordinary clinical, developmental, and situational rivals.
- **Selective civil-personhood breakdown:** an officeholder can retain authority, execution, and public defence while becoming selectively unavailable for the binding attachment of authorship, promises, contradiction, answerability, repair, and consequences. The observable interface, strategic non-answerability, and accountability malingering through performed or exaggerated incapacity are successively stronger claims with separate gates. The answerability-uncanny-valley and protected-role-terminal shorthands describe the observer's experience without deciding its cause. Performed non-agency is the actor-side presentation, the incapacity-based accountability discount is the observer-side update, and their possible conjunction is the non-agency accountability shield. Reciprocity withdrawal can form the broader paternalistic accountability shield and a withdrawal loop in which failed adult answerability collapses expectations, anger gives way to contempt, pity, exhaustion, or resignation, and consequential pressure diminishes while execution and defence continue. Loss of esteem can thereby help protect power, as in the Teflon-politician branch, instead of disproving insulation. The loop can instead be broken by redirection toward records, investigation, adjudication, organization, succession, or another receiver. None of these audience effects cancels the officeholder's unconditional human standing or establishes intent, diagnosis, hidden command, or covert assignment.
- **Operative relationship modes:** I-mode permits oneself and another to appear as concrete centres of life in a possible I–You relation; We-mode operates through rules, roles, categories, shared purposes, institutional standpoints, or an imagined impartial observer. Neither mode is intrinsically good, evil, egoistic, altruistic, warm, cold, personal, or collective-agentic.
- **Pole–mode–programme separation:** Durkheimian poles describe constitutive sources and functions; I/We modes describe an episode's relational standpoint; the installed programme supplies classifications and ends; jurisdiction and moral direction determine whom the operation preserves or consumes.
- **Personhood-routing relation:** solidarity-indexed person recognition and a personhood-routing rule describe whether a human can appear as an interrupting You rather than only as a programme object. Recognition remains declaratory of, never constitutive of, inherent human standing.
- **Bounded enlistment versus takeover:** intense coordination remains person-preserving where task and jurisdiction are limited, authorship, conscience, refusal, and return remain available, and affected persons retain standing. Full We-mode takeover makes collective purpose comprehensive and turns self-sacrifice or sacrifice of others into programme requirements.
- **Repersonalization and scale:** repersonalization shock marks the possible return of a classified human as You. Scalar personhood collapse instead turns necessary aggregate representation into cancellation of the persons counted; it does not make statistics dispensable.
- **Self-transcendence routes:** relational self-sacrifice, generalized altruism, and collective sacrifice can produce similar conduct through different causal structures. Neighbour-love is a cross-layer achievement joining embodied care, symbolic generalization, personal encounter, and judgment.
- **Asymmetric personal address:** a carrier can experience the collective as a personally addressing Thou even where the enacted collective registers that carrier only as a member or component. Upward address does not establish reciprocal person-to-person care from above.
- **Conditional Christian theological interpretation:** Word, Incarnation, and Cross disclose a person-preserving direction for embodied We-mode; the Christian We remains self-subordinating and interruptible by each concrete person, while the satanic hack captures the same receptivity, impersonates ultimate authority, prohibits exit, and consumes persons for programme preservation.
- **Long-term result:** reproduction or transformation of culture through ritual and institutionalization.
- **Central normative problem:** whether the bigOther remains contestable by reflective judgment or acquires final authority over it.
- **Developmental axis:** externally enforced → socially authored → self-authored → self-transforming bigOther.
- **Reflective-role bridge:** press secretary → interpreter → auditor distinguishes defence of a verdict from making its programming object and genuinely testing it; self-authorship requires more than articulate post-hoc reasons.

Example of use

From the perspective of **culture mechanics**, the ceremony did not merely communicate the organization's values. It reenacted and reinforced particular mythologies, strengthened corresponding mappings in each participant's mythological lens, and made the bigOthers' resulting sentiments collectively observable.

Compact formulas

Inherent human standing:

> **beginning of an individual living human organism → complete and equal human standing; factual recognition is declaratory and corrigible, never constitutive; capability, dependency, wantedness, conduct, and classification may change circumstances or remedies but never admission to the protected human class**

Selective civil-personhood breakdown:

> **retained authority + continued execution and defence of a course + selective unavailability for retrospective continuity, promise-binding, contradiction, answerability, repair, or consequence → possible reciprocity withdrawal and paternalistic accountability shield; performed non-agency + observer-side incapacity discount → possible non-agency accountability shield; observable asymmetry $\neq$ strategic use $\neq$ feigned incapacity**

Single-slot composition and replacement:

> **one PCI slot → one local bigOther → one operative mythological lens; compatible packages → one braided program; incompatible governing worldview → rejection or incumbent unbraiding → liminal interval → one rebraided successor**

Historical explanation and present execution:

> **historical cause $\neq$ live affective classification $\neq$ avowed reason; present agreement among them is an empirical question**

Activation and formation:

> **operation-rich formation → locally reconstructed and socially calibrated codebooks → compressed symbol activates a larger installed complex; token inheritance without recurrent formation does not transmit a finished decoder**

Durkheimian source pole and Culture Mechanics decomposition:

> **socially formed language, concepts, rational resources, and moral ideals → local reconstruction across rider/main CPU, symbolic protocol, and installed lens; local bigOther classifies their culturally relevant objects and uses → established elephant steering + proposed rider-side semantic-access conditioning; classification influences thought without performing thought**

Coupled collective-formation modes:

> **distributed epistemic milieu → rider/main-CPU concepts, methods, query paths, and correction practices; distributed bigOther and local-bigOther execution → evaluative force, affect, motivation, and action readiness; shared carriers and reciprocal influence do not make these one processor**

Formation, intervention, and selection:

> **endogenous formation: changing conditions → mismatch → articulation → distributed selection → embodiment; prospective purposive construction: candidate chosen destination D* → diagnosis → symbolic and institutional intervention → testing and correction; where intervention is attempted, the actual successor is jointly constrained by intention, receivers, incumbent and rival fields, institutions, consequences, and reality**

Situated scripts and unraveling:

> **operative cultural weave + role/institution/situation + practical environment → situated cultural script → enactment and consequence → reinforcement, repair, or unraveling; peripheral failure → local script replacement, while load-bearing cross-script cascade → possible cultural unbraiding**

Domain transfer:

> **genuine competence or viable script in environment A + untested invariant assumption → enactment in materially different environment B → discriminating collision with B's causal, institutional, or adversarial structure → possible domain-transfer failure**

Relevant-structure appraisal:

felt relevance × represented support or damage → possible moral appraisal and mobilization; actual multidimensional effect + generative centrality + normative standing → separate evaluation

Sublimation-bearing symbols and lens programming:

carrier or activation device → installed sublimation-related mappings → local-bigOther classification; repeated rival mythology + systems + rewards + sanctions + conduct → possible lens reprogramming → changed Beseelung, enactment, and transmission

Affective-to-structural load transfer:

living conviction → repeated practice and habit → fitted roles, procedures, records, audit, and succession → lower per-node affective demand + greater structural persistence, range, and reliable reproduction; structure reduces recurrent arousal but does not literally store affect or replace living correction indefinitely; ordinary visible alignment may remain low while fitted roles, interoperable interfaces, infrastructure, resource routing, and command relations preserve high activation-conditioned coordination capacity

Change-indexed moral mobilization:

represented change, continuation, prevention, or culpable omission affecting felt-relevant structure → intensified moral classification and action readiness (hypothesis, not definition)

Single-slot hard test:

two incompatible same-domain evaluators + independent finality + independent affect, veto, and correction + stable coexistence without hierarchy, reinterpretation, contextual division, or third rule → evidence against strict single-slot exclusivity

Order, jurisdiction, and lifting:

one fully occupied slot × {shared concrete rules and answers | shared answer-generating meta-rules} × {corrigible | pathological}; fixed M + current K_t + situation C → binding R_t(C); lifting may enable plural first-order outputs and bounded jurisdictions without creating a second bigOther

Person–collective constitution:

collective agency × subjecthood absorption × jurisdiction × corrigibility; differentiated unity preserves personal and subordinate standing, while generalized compulsory alignment + jurisdictional absorption + blocked correction, refusal, and exit → fusion pressure → possible total fusion

Operative relationship modes:

I-mode $\leftrightarrow$ We-mode is an episode-level standpoint axis, not the Durkheimian pole distinction; programme supplies classifications and ends; moral direction and jurisdiction determine person-preserving or person-consuming operation; bounded enlistment preserves authorship, refusal, You-interruption, and return, while full takeover blocks them

Agentified enactment and the Jaynes–Bach bridge:

mythology → god-agent represented in one operative lens → agentified *Beseelung* / bigOther-as-Thou → distributed enactment → multi-mind-self presentation → possible operative multi-mind-self; displacement of personal authorship within that agent → fused multi-mind-self

Conditional Christian theological contrast:

created receptivity to Word and shared authority + Incarnation and Cross → Christian We subordinate to concrete persons; collective capture + claimed ultimate voice + submission as proof + prohibited exit + disposal authority → satanic hack; conditional theology $\neq$ empirical proof, and biological mediation $\neq$ disproof of the referent

Kantian inner-tribunal comparison:

one numerically identical human + distinct practical positions → inner moral authority represented as observing and judging other; Kant: autonomous practical reason and doubled personality | Culture Mechanics: possible local-bigOther presence; shared phenomenological target $\neq$ shared ontology

Conformity and targeting signals, moralization, and enforcement–exclusion:

ideological program → performed, omitted, imposed, or attributed token → conformity, refusal, or target status becomes observable → character disclosure and accusation → distributed judgment → enforcement through inclusion, exclusion, coercion, or violence → defence or expansion of jurisdiction

Rivalry and conflict:

propositional, causal-story, or classification conflict → possible mythological rivalry → active interference with transmission, authority, membership, or institutional embodiment → mythological conflict → organized recruitment and rival-signal suppression → propagative conflict; physical coercion or violence in the conflict → coercive conflict. The two outward types may overlap, and inward ideological or fundamentalist person–programme form remains a separate classification.

Full culture-mechanical cycle:

mythologies shape the mythological lens → the local bigOther maps observations onto social feelings → the elephant moves → the rider explains or questions → behaviour is encoded in the shared symbolic protocol → other local bigOthers classify and respond → an emergent field acts back upon its participants → distributed synchronization reproduces or transforms culture

Culture propagator:

typed cultural state $z_t = (r_t, p_t, d_t, k_t, w_t, s_t, m_t)$ **+ declared transition architecture** θ_t **+ input** u_t **+ disturbance** ε_t **→ later possible state** $z_{t+1} = T_{\theta_t}(z_t; u_t, \varepsilon_t)$**; retained memory is part of the state whenever later movement depends on history**

Question-relative quotient condition:

$z \sim z' \Rightarrow T(z) \sim T(z')$**; if apparently equivalent states have dynamically different successors, restore the discarded distinction or narrow the question**